

MOVEMENTAL · ONBOARDED LEADER RESEARCH

Executive Summary: Michael T. Cooper

Movement leader research dossier — profile, content catalog, digital presence, fragmentation story, and onboarding materials.

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Michael Cooper — research sidebar manifest

Canonical paths aligned with Author Profile `/profile` navigation.

Sidebar slug	File	Status
author-profile	profile/identity.md	populated
author-profile	network/organizations.md	populated
biography	profile/biography.md	populated
theological-profile	profile/theology.md	populated
vocational-profile	summary.md	populated
vocational-profile	profile/calling-profile.md	populated
voice-editorial-identity	profile/voice-analysis.md	populated
bibliography	content/books.md	populated
frameworks	content/frameworks.md	populated
articles-blog-posts	content/articles.md	populated
audio-podcast	content/audio.md	populated
video-content	content/videos.md	populated
content-audit	content/content-audit.md	populated
academic-work	content/academic.md	populated
courses-training	content/courses.md	populated
audience-profile	analysis/audience-analysis.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/websites.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/platforms.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/newsletters.md	populated
social-media	digital-presence/social-media.md	populated
the-fragmentation-story	fragmentation-story.md	populated
a-letter	reflected-understanding/michael-cooper.md	populated
(onboarding)	welcome-letter.md	populated

Staff-only research lives in `_staff/` ; collateral in `_misc/` .

At a Glance — Summary

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/summary.md

Executive Summary: Michael T. Cooper

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Confidence Level: HIGH on professional fingerprint and corpus; LOW on personal biographical dates (birth, family, exact PhD year all UNKNOWN); disambiguation resolved.

Canonical dashboard: [README.md](#). **Deeper files:** [profile/](#), [digital-presence/](#), [content/](#), [network/](#), [media/](#), [analysis/](#). **Onboarding playbook:** [content-marketing-playbook.md](#). **Fragmentation story:** [fragmentation-story.md](#). **Master sources:** [sources.md](#).

Who he is

Michael T. Cooper is an American evangelical missiologist and missiological theologian best known for coining "**Ephesiology**" — "the study of the Ephesian movement" — as a framework for understanding and catalyzing contemporary movements. He is a scholar and a field practitioner: more than thirty years in missions, roughly ten of them as a pioneer church planter in post-communist Romania, alongside a PhD in Intercultural Studies from Trinity Evangelical Divinity School and guest lectures at the London School of Economics, the University of Bordeaux, Loyola University, and Baylor University.

His formation is unusually interdisciplinary — a **BED in Environmental Design from Texas A&M**, an **MA in Missions from Columbia International University**, and the **TEDS doctorate** (focus on religious movements; minor in early Christian history). His early scholarship was ethnographic: field research on contemporary Druidry, published in *Missiology*, *Nova Religio*, and *Pomegranate*. That new-religious-movements method — how does a movement start, what do its adherents believe, who leads it, how does it multiply or fracture — is precisely the lens he later turns on the first-century Ephesian movement.

His current institutional footprint centers on three simultaneous roles: **missiologist-in-residence at East-West Ministries International**, **affiliate professor at Kairos University**, and **program director of the MA in Missiology of Movements at Mission India Theological Seminary** — plus his own **TELOS. / Ephesiology** ministry, the **Ephesiology Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch** cohort program, and the 227-episode **Ephesiology Podcast** (co-hosted with Andrew Johnson). His personal biography, by contrast, is almost entirely undocumented — no public birth date, birthplace, or family information. He presents himself vocationally, not personally, and this dossier honors that rather than inventing detail.

What he contributes

Cooper's signature move is **reframing missiology AS theology** rather than as a subset of it. Where most evangelical writers treat "missions" as an applied department downstream of systematic theology, Cooper inverts the order: the Bible is read as "a missiological theology" with mission at the center; Paul and John are read as missiological theologians who connected Jesus to the cultural narrative of Ephesus. Three things make this distinctive — he **coins a category and treats it as a discipline** ("Ephesiology," a category of one), he **refuses CPM/DMM operational jargon** as a deliberate theological position, and he **grounds movement claims in material culture** (the 2026 Asia Minor archaeology volume and its photographic companion).

His most-cited corrective — "**making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result**" — anchors a coherent ten-framework corpus: Ephesiology, missiological theology, disciple-making-over-church-planting, healthy DNA, Christoform leadership, Lead Like Paul's Five C's, the contextualization/syncretism boundary, and the TELOS. three pillars. The flagship Ephesiology (William Carey, 2020) won the 2020 Catalyst Services Reader's Choice Award for best book in Missiology and carries 13 named endorsers, including **Alan Hirsch** — situating Ephesiology beside The Forgotten Ways / APEST in the broader movemental conversation.

The gap

Cooper's gap is the **inverse** of the typical pre-platform movement leader (and the precise inverse of Lucas Pulley, who had book-length thinking and no books). Cooper has the opposite problem: he is extraordinarily prolific yet sits on a paper-thin owned-audience layer. The asymmetry:

- **Dispersion, not absence.** ~17 books are split across at least six imprints (William Carey, Wipf & Stock, Sacred Roots / Samuel Morris, Sacred Tribes Press, and self/Ephesiology lines), with no single discoverable hub. A reader who finds Ephesiology on Amazon has no easy path to Make Disciples, Letters to Churches, or the 2026 archaeology volume.
- **Owned-audience near-zero.** ~17 books + 227 podcast episodes have produced ~120-175 brand-account followers, ~40 Goodreads ratings, 12 Apple podcast ratings, and no newsletter of scale.
- **Lent-to-owned never captured.** East-West's ~\$33M missionary/donor base, the Kairos degree funnel, and the Mission India MA route audiences through institutions Cooper does not own; the 227-episode podcast converts almost none of its reach into an owned relationship.
- **Undiscoverable.** No Wikipedia article, no verified Google Scholar profile, a misspelled Patheos slug (/blogs/ephesilogy/).

The problem is not production. The problem is that a serious, award-winning, vertically integrated body of work is scattered and undiscoverable, and the institutional reach it should have converted into an owned relationship was never captured.

Movemental fit

Fit Score: 8.0/10. Recommendation: Onboard — high fit, coordination required.

Calibrated against Alan Hirsch (8.6), Lucas Pulley (8.1), and Brad Brisco (7.9). The content asset base is stronger than either Pulley or Brisco; the offsetting factors are low digital maturity and the coordination cost of his existing LMS and institutional footprint.

Movemental does not need to commission a corpus — it needs to **surface, consolidate, index, and cross-link** one, then stand up a real owned-audience layer. That is a faster, lower-risk onboarding than any pre-book leader. Doctrine alignment is near-perfect: Cooper literally theologizes "movements" ("missiology of movements," "movemental ecclesiology" — a named course on his LMS). The network compounds: onboarding Cooper opens single-hop conversations with Alan Hirsch (lead endorser), Kurt Nelson / East-West, the EMS / Missio Nexus missiology world, the Motus Dei CPM network (Warrick Farah), Gailyn Van Rheenen, John W. Morehead, and the GACX alliance — plus a possible cross-tie to Tampa Underground via Bill Couchenour.

What Movemental will NOT do: compete with his accredited LMS (TELOS. / Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch); strip his scholarly register into trade-devotional content; reroute East-West / Kairos / Mission India audiences; adopt CPM/DMM jargon on his behalf; publish unverified entities; or flatten him into "the Ephesiology guy" when he is also an NT-movement theologian, a patristics retriever, an archaeologist of Asia Minor, and a leadership writer.

Research compiled: 2026-05-29 · UNKNOWN flags preserved (birth/family, PhD year, social counts, Frost's 2026 role) · Sources: see [sources.md](#)

Author Profile — Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/profile/identity.md

Identity Verification: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (with documented open items)

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Confidence: HIGH on professional/identity fingerprint and corpus; LOW on personal biographical dates (birth, family, exact PhD year all UNKNOWN); disambiguation resolved.

Canonical Identity

Field	Value	Confidence	Source
Full Legal Name	Michael T. Cooper (full middle name unknown)	LIKELY	kairos.edu/faculty/michael-t-cooper
Known As / Goes By	Dr. Michael T. Cooper; "Michael Cooper"	VERIFIED	kairos.edu , ephesiology.com
Credential	PhD, Intercultural Studies	VERIFIED	kairos.edu
Coined Term	"Ephesiology" — "the study of the Ephesian movement"	VERIFIED	everand.com/book/547780170
Primary Vocational Identity	Missiologist / missiological theologian	VERIFIED	kairos.edu
Current Title (East West)	Missiologist-in-residence, East-West Ministries International	VERIFIED	kairos.edu
Current Title (Kairos)	Affiliate professor, Kairos University	VERIFIED	kairos.edu
Current Title (Mission India)	Program director, MA in Missiology of Movements, Mission India Theological Seminary (Nagpur)	VERIFIED	kairos.edu
Ministry / Brand	TELOS. / Ephesiology (founder/leader)	VERIFIED	ephesiology.com/welcome-to-telos
Podcast	Host, The Ephesiology Podcast (227 eps, since 2019; co-host Andrew Johnson)	VERIFIED	Apple Podcasts id1457124552
Nationality	American	VERIFIED	kairos.edu
Current Location	United States (specific city UNKNOWN)	INFERRED	kairos.edu
Born	UNKNOWN — no birth date, year, or place located	UNKNOWN	—
Spouse / Family	UNKNOWN — not surfaced in any public source	UNKNOWN	—
Primary Website	ephesiology.com (branded "TELOS.")	VERIFIED	ephesiology.com
Master Classes Site	masterclasses.ephesiology.com	VERIFIED	masterclasses.ephesiology.com
Academia.edu	sfseminary.academia.edu/MichaelCooper (same subject — Kairos was formerly Sioux Falls Seminary)	LIKELY	sfseminary.academia.edu
Amazon Author Central	B003PPPO26	VERIFIED	Goodreads author
Goodreads Author	23 distinct works; avg rating 4.15 (~40 ratings)	VERIFIED	Goodreads author

Field	Value	Confidence	Source
Social handles / follower counts	"Ephesiology"-branded accounts exist; specific handles & counts not catalogued	UNKNOWN	—

Disambiguation

"Michael Cooper" is a heavily-collided name. Our subject is **Michael T. Cooper, the missiologist** — and only him.

- **Michael "Coop" Cooper** (Michael Jerome Cooper, b. 1956) — NBA Lakers "Showtime" guard, Defensive Player of the Year, Basketball Hall of Fame 2024. [nba.com player 76444](https://www.nba.com/player/76444). **Not the same person.**
- **Michael Cooper** — actor on IMDb. [m.imdb.com/name/nm1649053](https://www.imdb.com/name/nm1649053). **Not the same person.**
- Various musicians and politicians on the [Michael Cooper Wikipedia disambiguation page](#). **None is the subject.**
- Note: the **Academia.edu** profile at sfseminary.academia.edu/MichaelCooper **is** the subject — Kairos University was formerly Sioux Falls Seminary, so the legacy domain is his, not a distinct figure.

Search modifiers that reliably isolate the subject: "Michael T. Cooper" + any of: Ephesiology, Ephesian movement, missiological theology, missiology, Trinity Evangelical Divinity School, East West missiologist, Ephesiology Master Classes — combined with exclusion of NBA / Lakers / basketball / actor.

Education

Institution	Degree	Field	Year	Source
Texas A&M University	BED	Environmental Design	UNKNOWN	kairos.edu
Columbia International University (Columbia Biblical Seminary & School of Missions)	MA	Missions	UNKNOWN	kairos.edu
Trinity Evangelical Divinity School (TEDS)	PhD	Intercultural Studies (focus: religious movements; minor in theology focused on early Christian history)	UNKNOWN (dissertation-era work on contemporary Druidry, mid/late 2000s)	kairos.edu

Note on the Environmental Design → missions arc: Cooper's undergraduate degree is in **Environmental Design** from Texas A&M — an architecture/built-environment discipline, not theology. This is an unusual on-ramp to a PhD missiologist's career and is worth flagging: the eventual turn toward material culture and the archaeology of Asia Minor (his 2026 Wipf & Stock work, built on inscriptions, architecture, and the photographic record) is arguably the design-trained eye resurfacing in the missiologist. The PhD completion **year is unconfirmed**; the dissertation subject area was contemporary Druidry (see [Missiology 2008](#) and the 2010 Contemporary Druidry book), placing the doctorate in the mid-to-late 2000s.

Career Timeline

Year(s)	Role	Organization	Source
~1990s (post-1989)	~10 years as pioneer church planter in Romania (post-communism)	—	thelaymenslounge.com
(various)	~6 years in international development; president/CEO of an international NGO	—	Amazon — First Christian Voices bio
~2008–~2018	Director, School of Biblical & Religious Studies; taught undergraduate/graduate students "for a decade"	Trinity International University	Missiology 2008 ; Amazon bio
2019 → present	Host, The Ephesiology Podcast	Ephesiology / TELOS.	Apple Podcasts
2020 → present	Founder/leader, TELOS. ministry (three pillars: plant churches, care for the marginalized, defend the faith)	TELOS. / Ephesiology	ephesiology.com/welcome-to-telos
Present	Missiologist-in-residence	East-West Ministries International	kairos.edu
Present	Affiliate professor; Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch partner	Kairos University	kairos.edu , masterclasses.ephesiology.com
Present	Program director, MA in Missiology of Movements	Mission India Theological Seminary (Nagpur)	kairos.edu

Field reach (verified, undated): 30+ years in missions; church-planter equipping across Africa, Europe, the Americas, South Asia, and Southeast Asia; guest lectures at the **London School of Economics, University of Bordeaux, Loyola University, and Baylor University**; teaching at Torch Trinity Graduate University and Asia Graduate School of Theology Nepal. (kairos.edu)

Family & Personal

Unlike most subjects in this corpus, Cooper's **personal biography is almost entirely undocumented in public sources** — and this profile says so honestly rather than inferring.

- **Born:** UNKNOWN. No birth date, birth year, or birthplace located.
- **Spouse / children / family:** UNKNOWN. Nothing surfaced on any platform, faculty page, book bio, or podcast bio.
- **Current residence:** United States; specific city UNKNOWN.
- **Religious identification:** Evangelical Protestant; conservative-evangelical missiology stream (TEDS, Evangelical Missiological Society, William Carey Publishing, Missio Nexus orbit).
- **Formative field context:** His self-presentation is overwhelmingly vocational, not personal — the Romania church-planting decade, the international NGO presidency, and the academy are how he introduces himself, not family or hometown. This is itself a voice signal: he is a scholar-practitioner who foregrounds the work, not the man.

This is the inverse of the typical disambiguation problem: the professional fingerprint is dense and well-sourced; the personal one is a near-blank. Treat all personal-life claims as UNKNOWN until a primary source is found.

Published Works

Cooper is **content-rich and prolific** — the opposite of a pre-book practitioner profile. He has **~17 catalogued titles** (the Goodreads author page lists **23 distinct works**, avg rating 4.15) spanning 2010–2026, solo and co-authored, across at least six imprints (William Carey Publishing, Wipf & Stock, Sacred Roots / Samuel Morris, Sacred Tribes Press, and self/Ephesiology imprints). The flagship is **Ephesiology: A Study of the Ephesian Movement** (William Carey Publishing, 2020) — a William Carey bestseller and winner of the 2020 Catalyst Services Reader's Choice Award for best book in Missiology.

His themes cluster as: the Ephesian movement / missiological theology (Ephesiology; Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement, 2026); disciple-making & multiplication (Make Disciples, 2023); early-church / Apostolic Fathers (First Christian Voices, 2023; Letters to

Churches, 2025; A Faithful Witness); leadership (Lead Like Paul, 2017); new religious movements (Contemporary Druidry, 2010; Perspectives on Post-Christendom Spiritualities, 2022); and evangelical identity, justice & peace.

Do not list all titles here. The full bibliography — with ISBNs, co-authors, publishers, themes, and a recommended reading order — lives in the substrate's Bibliography table and (when present) `content/books.md`. See MICHAEL_COOPER_RESEARCH_COLLATED.md § Bibliography.

Other distribution surfaces (see `content/` files when present): The Ephesiology Podcast (227 episodes since 2019, weekly); the "Until They All Hear" / TELOS. blog at ephesiology.com; a Patheos blog ("Ephesiology"); academic articles in Journal of the Evangelical Missiological Society, Missiology, Nova Religio, and Pomegranate; and the Ephesiology Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch program (Kairos University partnership) plus the Mission India MA.

Biography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/profile/biography.md

Biography: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (personal-life items flagged UNKNOWN)

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Narrative Biography

Michael T. Cooper is an American evangelical missiologist and missiological theologian best known for coining and building out "**Ephesiology**" — the study of the first-century church-planting movement centered in Ephesus — as a framework for understanding and catalyzing contemporary movements. He is a scholar and a field practitioner: more than thirty years in missions, roughly ten of them as a pioneer church planter in Romania after the fall of communism, alongside an academic résumé that runs from a PhD in Intercultural Studies at Trinity Evangelical Divinity School to guest lectures at the London School of Economics, the University of Bordeaux, Loyola University, and Baylor University.

His formation is unusually interdisciplinary. He holds a **BED in Environmental Design from Texas A&M** — an architecture-and-built-environment degree, not theology — followed by an **MA in Missions from Columbia International University** and the **TEDS doctorate** (focus on religious movements, minor in early Christian history). His early scholarship was ethnographic and comparative-religion in character: field research on contemporary Druidry, published as a 2008 Missiology article ("What I Learned about Christianity from the Druids") and a 2010 book (Contemporary Druidry), with further work in Nova Religio and Pomegranate. Only later did his work pivot decisively toward New Testament movement studies and, most recently, the archaeology and material culture of Asia Minor.

The institutional middle of his career sat at **Trinity International University**, where for about a decade (c. 2008–2018) he directed the School of Biblical and Religious Studies and taught undergraduate and graduate students. He also served as president/CEO of an international NGO and spent several years in international development. But the second half of his public life has been organized around a brand and an argument. In 2019 he launched **The Ephesiology Podcast** (now 227 episodes, co-hosted with Andrew Johnson); in 2020 William Carey Publishing released **Ephesiology: A Study of the Ephesian Movement**, which won that year's Catalyst Services Reader's Choice Award for best book in Missiology and became a William Carey bestseller. Around the book he built a small ecosystem: the **TELOS**. ministry (three pillars — plant churches, care for the marginalized, defend the faith),

the **Ephesiology Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch** cohort program (in partnership with Kairos University), and a directed **MA in Missiology of Movements** at Mission India Theological Seminary.

His current institutional footprint centers on three roles held simultaneously: **missiologist-in-residence at East-West Ministries International**, **affiliate professor at Kairos University**, and **program director of the Mission India MA**. He is prolific — ~17 catalogued books (23 distinct works on Goodreads) across 2010–2026, solo and co-authored, with a 2026 archaeology volume (Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement, Wipf & Stock) and its visual companion still in the pipeline.

His personal biography, by contrast, is almost entirely **undocumented** — no public birth date, birthplace, or family information. He presents himself vocationally, not personally, and this profile honors that rather than inventing detail.

Origin & Formation

Two pivots define Cooper's formation, and both are worth naming because they make his eventual framework legible.

The first is the **Environmental Design → missions** arc. Beginning in an architecture/built-environment discipline at Texas A&M and ending as a PhD missiologist is not a normal path. The design-trained eye does not disappear; it resurfaces decades later in his turn toward material culture — reading the Ephesian movement through inscriptions, architecture, and the photographic and cartographic record (his 2026 Wipf & Stock volume and its companion *Photographing the Movement of God*). Where many missiologists argue from text alone, Cooper increasingly argues from the built and excavated world.

The second is the **Druidry-research-to-Ephesian-movement** pivot. His doctoral and early-career identity was that of a new-religious-movements scholar — an ethnographer of contemporary Druidry, publishing in the comparative-religion and missiology journals. That methodological training (how does a movement start, what do its adherents believe, who leads it, how does it sustain or fracture) is precisely the lens he later turns on the first-century Ephesian movement. Ephesiology is, in a real sense, the NRM researcher applying his own analytic questions to the New Testament. The continuity is more striking than the change.

Underneath both is the **ten-year Romania church-planting decade** after the fall of communism. This is the field credibility that anchors the academic voice. Cooper does not write as a theorist who never planted; he writes as a pioneer planter who later went and got the PhD to explain what he had lived. That ordering — practice first, theory second — shapes the entire corpus.

Career & Ministry Arc

The arc runs: (1) **field practitioner** — pioneer church planting in post-1989 Romania (~10 years) plus international development and an NGO presidency; (2) **academic** — the TEDS doctorate and roughly a decade directing the School of Biblical and Religious Studies at Trinity International University (c. 2008–2018), with early scholarship on Druidry and new religious movements; (3) **framework-builder** — the 2019 launch of The Ephesiology Podcast and the 2020 publication of Ephesiology, which crystallized his thesis and won a Reader's Choice Award; (4) **ecosystem-builder** — TELOS., the Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch program, and the Mission India MA, all organized around disseminating and operationalizing the Ephesiology framework; and (5) **material-culture deepening** — the 2026 Asia Minor archaeology volume, which grounds the movement claims in the excavated record.

The through-line: every stage feeds the next. The field decade supplies credibility; the NRM scholarship supplies method; the framework supplies a brand; the ecosystem supplies distribution; the archaeology supplies evidence. He is a rare figure who has closed the loop from practice to theory to institution to proof.

Current Focus

- **Ephesiology as a teachable program**, not just a book — the Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch cohorts (four certificate tracks laddering into five Kairos degrees) and the Mission India MA in Missiology of Movements.
- **Missiologist-in-residence at East-West Ministries International**, embedding the framework inside a large least-reached-focused church-planting agency.
- **The 227-episode Ephesiology Podcast** (co-hosted with Andrew Johnson) as the weekly dissemination engine.
- **The 2026 archaeology turn** — Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement and Photographing the Movement of God — moving the argument from text to material culture.
- A continuing **disciple-making-over-church-planting** corrective within the CPM/missional conversation (Make Disciples, 2023; the Patheos/Jackson Wu piece).

Key Relationships & Influences

Person	Relationship	Significance
Andrew Johnson	Co-host, The Ephesiology Podcast	Closest sustained collaborator; the weekly dialogue partner across 227 episodes
Bill Couchenour	Co-author, Make Disciples (2023)	Disciple-multiplication thesis partner; also chairs the Tampa Underground board — a possible cross-network tie into the microchurch ecosystem
John W. Morehead	Co-author/co-editor, When Evangelicals Sneeze (2020), Perspectives on Post-Christendom Spiritualities (2022)	Two joint works; shared interest in new religious movements and evangelical identity
Michael Frost	Collaborator on Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement (2026) — exact role (co-author vs. foreword) UNCONFIRMED	Direct connective tissue to the Hirsch/Frost missional-incarnational stream
Alan Hirsch	Endorser of Ephesiology (2020)	High-significance link for the broader movemental ecosystem; situates Ephesiology beside The Forgotten Ways / APEST as a movement framework
Gary Fujino	Co-author (Missiology Made Simple) and Ephesiology endorser	Practical-missiology collaborator (Missional University)
Gailyn Van Rheenen	Editor of the EMS 13 volume (Contextualization and Syncretism) to which Cooper contributed	Anchors him in the Evangelical Missiological Society mainstream
Kurt Nelson	President/CEO, East-West Ministries International; Ephesiology endorser	Institutional sponsor of his missiologist-in-residence role
Harold A. Netland	TEDS faculty; Ephesiology endorser	Academic lineage at his PhD alma mater
Marvin J. Newell / Nate Vander Stelt	Ephesiology endorsers (Missio Nexus; Global Alliance for Church Multiplication)	Situate him inside the church-multiplication / agency network
Mark Townsend	Foreword, Contemporary Druidry (2010)	Tie to the new-religious-movements / comparative-religion world of his early career
TEDS faculty (academic lineage)	PhD formation in intercultural studies	Source of his NRM method and early-Christian-history minor

Note on upstream theological influences: Documentable upstream influences are thin. Direct, sourced citation of canonical missiologists (Roland Allen, Lesslie Newbigin, David Bosch, Eckhard Schnabel) **could not be verified** and is left as an open question pending the Ephesiology bibliography. Do not assert these as influences without the primary source.

In Their Own Words

"Nowhere in the Bible is the church commanded to plant churches." — [Is Church Planting a Biblical Mandate?](#), Patheos / Jackson Wu, 2020

"Making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result." — [Patheos / Jackson Wu, 2020](#)

"Disciples are not made unless they identify with the life of Christ." — [Patheos / Jackson Wu, 2020](#)

"[The Ephesian movement] is best characterized by faithful disciples committed to a missiologically theocentric passion to declare the glory of God to the nations." — [Patheos / Jackson Wu, 2020](#)

"Pure and simple, disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy." — [Make Disciples \(book description\)](#)

Ephesiology is "the study of the Ephesian movement" — "a missiological theology of the Bible." — [Ephesiology front matter](#)

Theological Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/profile/theology.md

Theological Profile: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (upstream influences flagged UNCONFIRMED)

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Confidence: HIGH on his published positions and frameworks; LOW on documentable upstream lineage (canonical missiologists unverified).

Core Thesis

Mission is not a subset of theology — **mission is the center of theology**. The Bible is best read not as a systematic theology with a missions chapter, but as "**a missiological theology**": a sustained account of God's movement to the nations, in which figures like Paul and John function as missiological theologians who connected the teaching of Jesus to the cultural narrative of their world. Cooper's signature instantiation of this thesis is **Ephesiology** — the study of the first-century Ephesian church-planting movement as a discrete object and a normative model for contemporary movements.

From this follows his most-repeated correction: **church planting is nowhere commanded in Scripture; making disciples is the mandate, and church planting is a result.**

Cooper is a conservative-evangelical missiological theologian who reframes the entire movement conversation around disciple-multiplication and a theocentric passion for the glory of God among the nations.

Theological Tradition

Primary: Conservative-evangelical missiology — the Trinity Evangelical Divinity School / Evangelical Missiological Society / William Carey Publishing / Missio Nexus stream. Cooper is an academically credentialed missiologist (PhD, Intercultural Studies, TEDS) working squarely inside the evangelical missions academy, not at its experimental edge.

Secondary: New-religious-movements and comparative-religion method (his early ethnographic work on Druidry; publications in Nova Religio and Pomegranate); patristic / early-church retrieval (the Apostolic Fathers); and an emerging material-culture / archaeology-of-Asia-Minor turn.

Register: Unlike a pure practitioner-articulator, Cooper writes as a **scholar-practitioner**. He argues from the biblical text, from first-century history and the archaeological record, and from contemporary church-planting-movement field data — interleaving the two. He is comfortable with academic apparatus (journals, edited volumes, EMS) while writing trade-accessible books and hosting a weekly podcast. He is conservative on the authority and centrality of Scripture, evangelistically driven, and mildly contrarian toward American evangelical pragmatism.

Key Frameworks & Models

Framework	Description	Where Developed
Ephesiology	"The study of the Ephesian movement." Treats the first-century Ephesian church-planting movement as a discrete object of study and a normative model — explicitly not a commentary on Ephesians and not a biblical theology of missions, but "a missiological theology of the Bible."	Ephesiology (2020) , William Carey Publishing ; everand.com/book/547780170
The Five Analytical Questions	Ephesiology asks of any movement: (1) How did it start? (2) What did adherents believe? (3) Who led it? (4) How did it multiply and sustain growth? (5) Why did some defect into false teaching/paganism?	Ephesiology (2020)
Missiological Theology	Mission as the center of theology rather than one topic within systematic theology. Paul and John read as "missiological theologians" who connected Jesus to the cultural narrative of Ephesus.	Ephesiology (2020)
Disciple-Making Over Church-Planting	"Making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result." The mandate is disciple-multiplication; churches are the byproduct, never the goal. "Disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy."	Patheos / Jackson Wu (2020) ; Make Disciples (2023)
Healthy DNA	Churches, denominations, and ministries are sustained (or fractured) by their underlying "DNA." Movement health is a property of replicable spiritual DNA, woven through the Ephesian-movement analysis with contemporary CPM illustrations.	Ephesiology (2020)
Christoform Leadership	Christ-shaped, communal, theological, and missional leadership drawn from the Apostolic Fathers (1 Clement, Ignatius, Polycarp) — recovered against hierarchical or novelty-driven leadership.	Letters to Churches (2025)
Lead Like Paul — the Five C's	Five empowering leadership traits derived from the Apostle Paul: Call, Character, Charismata, Confidence, Commitment.	Lead Like Paul (2017)

Distinctive Positions

- **Church planting is nowhere commanded.** Cooper's most-corrected reader misreading is the assumption that church planting is the biblical mandate. His consistent reply: "Nowhere in the Bible is the church commanded to plant churches... making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result."
 - **Roughly 40% of the New Testament relates to the Ephesian movement.** A signature, frequently-repeated claim that justifies treating "Ephesiology" as a discrete and weighty field.
 - **The Bible is "a missiological theology."** Mission at the center, not as a chapter — a deliberate inversion of how systematic theology typically files missions.
 - **Disciples must identify with the life of Christ.** "Disciples are not made unless they identify with the life of Christ." Christ-formation is the substance of discipleship; activity is not discipleship. "Disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy."
 - **Movement health is a DNA property.** Multiplication and sustainability depend on healthy, replicable spiritual DNA — and movements fail when that DNA degrades into false teaching (the fifth analytical question).
 - **Leadership should be Christoform, not hierarchical or novelty-driven.** Recovered from the disciples of the apostles, against the celebrity/innovation models of contemporary leadership culture.
 - **Strong contextualization, guarded against syncretism.** Paul and John connected the gospel to Ephesian culture; faithful contextualization is mandatory, but the contextualization/syncretism boundary must be policed (his EMS 13 contribution).
 - **A mild evangelical-identity polemic.** When Evangelicals Sneeze frames American evangelicalism as suffering "identity loss," to be cured via the Great Commandment, Compassion, and Commission.
-

Intellectual Genealogy

Shaped by (note: largely INFERRED from methodology and credentials — direct citations thin):

- **TEDS intercultural-studies faculty** — his PhD training in intercultural studies, new-religious-movements method, and early Christian history. The clearest documentable upstream lineage.
- **The new-religious-movements / comparative-religion tradition** — visible in his early Druidry ethnography and Nova Religio / Pomegranate publications; the method (how movements start, believe, lead, multiply, fracture) that he later turns on the New Testament.
- **The Apostolic Fathers** (1 Clement, Ignatius of Antioch, Polycarp) — direct primary sources for First Christian Voices, Letters to Churches, and Christoform leadership.

In conversation with:

- **Alan Hirsch** — endorser of Ephesiology; situates Cooper beside The Forgotten Ways / APEST in the movement-frameworks family.
- **Michael Frost** — collaborator on the 2026 archaeology volume (role unconfirmed); a tie into the missional-incarnational stream.
- **The Evangelical Missiological Society** (Gailyn Van Rheenen, et al.) — contextualization/syncretism debates.
- **David Garrison / DMM-CPM authors** — the broader church-planting-movement and disciple-making-movement conversation, which Cooper enters as a friendly corrective ("church planting is not the mandate") rather than a named opponent.
- **Eckhard Schnabel** — comparable NT-missiology / Pauline-mission terrain (genre overlap; not a verified citation).

Pushes back against:

- **Church-planting-as-mandate / church-planting-as-metric** — counting sites, mobilizing volunteers, and treating planting as the goal rather than the result.
- **Activity mistaken for discipleship** — "volunteers keep busy" while failing to multiply.
- **Hierarchical and novelty-driven leadership** — answered by Christoform leadership from the Apostolic Fathers.
- **American evangelical "identity loss"** and method divorced from theology — missiology must be "missiologically theocentric," grounded first in theology, never in technique alone.
- **Syncretism** — the failure mode of contextualization done without theological guardrails.

Honesty flag: Cooper has **no documented public theological tensions** with a named counterparty. His correctives are framed as in-house adjustments within the CPM/missional conversation. And canonical upstream influences (Allen, Newbigin, Bosch, Schnabel) are **UNCONFIRMED** — do not assert them without the Ephesiology bibliography.

Theological Evolution

Cooper's theological arc tracks his career arc with unusual tightness: **(1) new-religious-movements scholar** — the doctoral and early-career ethnographer of contemporary Druidry, publishing in Missiology, Nova Religio, and Pomegranate, and directing the School of Biblical and Religious Studies at Trinity International University; **(2) leadership primer** — Lead Like Paul (2017), an early, compact statement of the Pauline-leadership themes (the five C's) he would later expand; **(3) missiological theologian** — the 2020 publication of Ephesiology, which reframed the whole project: mission at the center of theology, the Ephesian movement as a discrete field, the disciple-making-over-church-planting correction; **(4) ecosystem and patristic deepening** — Make Disciples (2023), First Christian Voices (2023), and Letters to Churches (2025), operationalizing disciple-multiplication and recovering Christoform

leadership from the Apostolic Fathers; and **(5) archaeology of Asia Minor** — the 2026 Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement and its visual companion, grounding the movement claims in inscriptions, architecture, and material culture.

The remarkable continuity is method. The questions an NRM ethnographer asks of a living movement — how did it start, what do its members believe, who leads, how does it multiply, why does it fracture — are exactly the five analytical questions Ephesiology asks of the first-century Ephesian movement. The Druidry researcher and the missiological theologian are the same analyst, turned from the present to the first century, and now to the excavated record beneath it. The through-line: mission is the center of theology; the measure of mission is multiplying disciples who identify with the life of Christ; and the model for both is the Ephesian movement, read with a scholar's questions and a planter's stake.

Vocational Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/profile/calling-profile.md

Michael T. Cooper: Calling Profile & Audit

mDNA-aligned calling analysis for strategic content alignment and movement leadership fulfillment

Version: 1.0.0

Last Updated: 2026-05-29

Word Count: ~1,300

Expert Perspective: Missional movement leadership, mDNA framework, calling alignment, digital mission strategy

Executive Summary

Michael T. Cooper's calling is that of a **scholar-practitioner who theologizes "movement" itself** — a missiological theologian called to recenter the church's mission on disciple-multiplication, grounded first in theology and the New Testament text rather than in technique or metrics. Where most of the movement-leadership field works in the method-and-data register, Cooper works in the theology-and-text register: he coined "Ephesiology" as a named discipline, claims roughly 40% of the New Testament relates to the Ephesian movement, and corrects the CPM mainstream with the thesis that "making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result." This calling profile analyzes how his work aligns with the mDNA framework, identifies movement-leadership indicators, maps content-to-calling alignment, and outlines the digital opportunity.

Key Outcomes:

- Synthesized calling statement
 - mDNA alignment profile (all 6 elements)
 - Movement-leadership map
 - Content-calling alignment analysis
 - Digital calling opportunity map
 - Strategic recommendations
-

Calling Statement

Synthesized Calling

Michael T. Cooper is called to **establish a missiological theology of movement** — to read the Bible as a sustained account of God's movement to the nations, to treat the first-century Ephesian church-planting movement as a discrete and normative object of study, and to recenter the contemporary movements conversation on disciple-multiplication and a "missiologically theocentric passion to declare the glory of God to the nations." His vocation is not to mobilize a method but to ground one: missiology first in theology, never in technique. He coins categories (Ephesiology, missiological theology, Christoform leadership), inverts received assumptions (church planting is a result, not the mandate), and equips the next generation of movement leaders through an accredited educational pipeline rooted in the New Testament text, the Apostolic Fathers, and increasingly the archaeology of Asia Minor. He is a scholar-practitioner — a pioneer church planter who went and got the PhD to explain what he had lived — who closes the loop from practice to theory to institution to material-culture proof.

Core Calling Elements

- 1. Missiological Theologian** — mission as the center of theology, not a subset; the Bible read as "a missiological theology."
- 2. Category-Coiner / Definer** — establishes disciplines ("Ephesiology") and fences them; gives the field new, ownable language.
- 3. Constructive Corrector** — inverts the church-planting-as-mandate assumption to recenter on disciple-making; corrects to recenter, not to demolish.
- 4. Scholar-Practitioner Equipper** — builds an accredited certificate-to-degree pipeline (Master Classes → Kairos degrees; Mission India MA) that institutionalizes the framework.
- 5. Patristic & Material-Culture Retriever** — recovers Christoform leadership from the Apostolic Fathers and grounds movement claims in the excavated record of Asia Minor.

mDNA Alignment Profile

Element 1: Jesus is Lord (Organizing Center)

Alignment Strength: High

Evidence: The theocentric center is explicit and load-bearing — mission is the "missiologically theocentric passion to declare the glory of God to the nations," and "disciples are not made unless they identify with the life of Christ." Christ-formation is the substance of discipleship, not activity.

Content Alignment:

- Strong: every framework is tethered to a doxological frame; the closing move is consistently theocentric.
 - Opportunity: more explicit practical content on how Lordship reshapes leadership culture day to day.
-

Element 2: Disciple Making (Strategic Nerve)

Alignment Strength: Very High (the center of gravity)

Evidence: Disciple-making is his signature thesis. "Making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result." Make Disciples (2023) maps the spiritual journey of the Christ-follower; "disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy" is the corpus's purest aphorism. Multiplication, not addition or church-count, is the measure.

Content Alignment:

- Very Strong: a dedicated book, the most-quoted essay, and the through-line of the podcast.
 - Opportunity: digital-context disciple-making; converting the framework into accessible formation pathways.
-

Element 3: Missional-Incarnational Impulse (Living Among)

Alignment Strength: High

Evidence: Strong contextualization is a core theme — Paul and John "connected Jesus to the cultural narrative of Ephesus." His 30+ years across five continents and a decade in Romania embody incarnational presence; his contextualization/syncretism boundary work (EMS 13) polices faithful cultural connection. The connecting tie to the Hirsch/Frost missional-incarnational stream runs through the 2026 Frost collaboration (role UNCONFIRMED).

Content Alignment:

- Strong: contextualization is explicit and theologically guarded.
 - Opportunity: translate the incarnational impulse for the Global South (oral/translated formats — none catalogued yet).
-

Element 4: Apostolic Environment (APEST)

Alignment Strength: Medium-High

Evidence: Cooper does not use the APEST taxonomy directly (that is Hirsch's), but he occupies the apostolic function natively: the Ephesian movement is read through apostolic mission (Paul, John), and Christoform leadership is recovered from the disciples of the apostles

(1 Clement, Ignatius, Polycarp). Lead Like Paul (the Five C's) is explicitly Pauline-apostolic leadership. The substance of an apostolic environment is present; the named five-fold vocabulary is not.

Content Alignment:

- Strong on apostolic/pioneering and the recovery of early-church leadership.
 - Opportunity: an explicit bridge between Christoform leadership and the APEST language of the broader ecosystem (a natural Hirsch × Cooper surface).
-

Element 5: Organic Systems (Simple, Reproducible)

Alignment Strength: High

Evidence: "Healthy DNA" is precisely an organic-systems concept — replicable, transferable spiritual code that sustains (or, when degraded, fractures) movements. His fifth analytical question — why did some defect into false teaching? — is a systems-health diagnostic. Multiplication-over-addition is organic-systems logic.

Content Alignment:

- Strong: DNA, multiplication, and the defection-diagnostic are systems-native.
 - Opportunity: more explicit content on designing reproducible systems in contemporary contexts.
-

Element 6: Liminality-Communitas (Growth Through Shared Hardship)

Alignment Strength: Medium-High (more developed than the typical leader)

Evidence: Unusually for this corpus, liminality-communitas is substantively present in the early-church/persecution material — A Faithful Witness (third-century church under persecution), Crises and the Church (how the church responds to crisis), and the Apostolic-Fathers retrieval all foreground formation under pressure. His own decade of pioneer church planting in post-communist Romania is lived liminality.

Content Alignment:

- Stronger than median: persecution, crisis, and resilience are recurring themes.
 - Opportunity: name the communitas dynamic explicitly and connect the patristic/persecution material to contemporary movement formation.
-

Movement Leadership Map

Influence Patterns

Who he's equipping:

- Movement-invested but CPM-skeptical missionaries and church planters (via East-West's field force and Missio Nexus / EMS)
- Seminarians and degree-seekers (Master Classes → Kairos degrees; Mission India MA; Knox; Nepal Ebenezer)
- Academics and missiologists (EMS, Missiology / Global Missiology, guest lectures at LSE/ Bordeaux/Loyola/Baylor)
- Free-church / EFCA-leaning evangelical pastors (heavy EFCA endorser presence)
- Global South students and planters (India, Nepal, South Korea, Romania)

What movements he's catalyzing: a missiological-theology-of-movements stream that recenters multiplication on disciple-formation; the institutionalization of "Ephesiology" as an accredited field of study; an early-church/patristic leadership recovery.

Equipping Focus

Primary mechanisms: the coined framework (Ephesiology) and its frameworks set; the accredited LMS pipeline (certificate → Kairos degree ladder; Mission India MA); the 227-episode podcast as the weekly dissemination engine; ~17 books across themes; guest lectures and EMS contributions.

Movement Catalysts

- **TELOS. / Ephesiology** (founder; three pillars: plant churches, care for the marginalized, defend the faith)
- **Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch** (cohort education embedded in local churches)
- **MA in Missiology of Movements** (Mission India — the academic institutionalization of the field)
- **The Ephesiology Podcast** (the diffusion channel)

Content-Calling Alignment Analysis

High Alignment Content

- **Ephesiology / the Ephesian movement** (Ephesiology; Gods, Emperors, Philosophers) — Very High; the calling's center.

- **Disciple-making over church-planting** (Make Disciples; the Patheos essay) — Very High; the strategic nerve.
- **Christoform / Apostolic-Fathers leadership** (Letters to Churches; First Christian Voices) — High.
- **The accredited educational pipeline** (Master Classes; Mission India MA) — Very High; direct equipping.

Alignment Gaps

1. **Owned-audience layer** — the calling reaches large institutional audiences (East-West ~\$33M base, Kairos, Mission India) but converts almost none to an owned relationship. The 227-episode podcast draws only 12 ratings. This is the central gap.
2. **Discoverability** — no canonical hub for a 17-title corpus; no Wikipedia article; no verified Scholar profile; misspelled Patheos slug.
3. **Format reach** — no Ephesiology audiobook; no translated/oral modules for the Global South audience his contextualization theme already serves.
4. **APEST/communitas naming** — substantively present but not connected to the ecosystem's shared vocabulary.

Digital Calling Opportunity Map

The defining move is consolidation, not creation. Movemental's job is not to generate content for Cooper — he is among the most prolific leaders in the research set — but to **convert lent institutional reach into an owned relationship layer** and to surface a dispersed corpus.

1. **Unified "Ephesiology" corpus hub** — the single discoverable home the 17-title corpus has never had; the six imprints become source links, the hub becomes the front door.
 2. **A real newsletter** (the "Movemental Theology" newsletter) — periodic, scholarly-but-accessible, seeded from the podcast and corpus; replaces the bare signup form. Target 1,500 subscribers in 6 months, 4,000 by 12 months.
 3. **Audio essays / narrated corpus** — there is no Ephesiology audiobook; narrated flagship chapters and top podcast segments fill the obvious format gap.
 4. **Translated / oral-format modules** — for India, Nepal, and Romania funnels.
 5. **Short-form Asia-Minor archaeology series** — the visual companion (116 photographs + 7 maps) and "Let the Stones Speak" material are unusually well-suited to short-form video.
 6. **Hirsch x Cooper cross-surface** — a movement-theology conversation cross-promoting both Movemental profiles and bridging Christoform leadership to APEST.
-

Strategic Recommendations

Priority 1: Consolidate and surface. Build the canonical Ephesiology hub; index the 227 episodes by series; import the 17-title corpus tagged by the seven themes with Ephesiology as the pillar entry point.

Priority 2: Capture the audience. Stand up a real ESP and newsletter; drive podcast ratings/reviews; pursue a Wikipedia article and Google Scholar profile; consolidate Goodreads.

Priority 3: Fill format gaps. Narrated Ephesiology audio; translated/oral modules; back-catalogue clip content.

Priority 4: Complement, never compete. Movemental hosts the public-facing corpus and audience layer; TELOS. / Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch keep the credentialed cohorts and revenue. East-West, Kairos, and Mission India remain his native institutional surfaces — aggregate and link, never reroute. Preserve the scholarly register; respect the CPM-jargon refusal; flag UNKNOWN entities (no "Ephesiology Coaching Network"; Frost's 2026 role UNCONFIRMED).

Related Documentation

- **Michael Cooper Author Profile** — complete author intelligence
 - **Michael Cooper Voice Identity** — load-bearing voice doc
 - **Michael Cooper Audience Profile** — detailed audience analysis
 - **Michael Cooper Content Audit** — content inventory
 - **Substrate: MICHAEL_COOPER_RESEARCH_COLLATED.md** — canonical facts
-

Word Count: ~1,300

Voice & Editorial Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/profile/voice-analysis.md

Voice Analysis: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Confidence: HIGH — drawn from ~17 books, a 227-episode podcast, blog posts, and academic articles.

Voice Summary

Michael Cooper writes and speaks like **a missions-academy scholar who never stopped being a field practitioner**. His default move is definitional: he coins or sharpens a term, fences off what it is not, and then builds an argument on the cleaned-up definition. His most characteristic rhetorical gesture is the **provocative inversion** — taking a near-universal evangelical assumption ("our job is to plant churches") and flipping it ("nowhere is the church commanded to plant churches; disciple-making is the mandate, church planting is a result"). He is mildly contrarian toward American evangelical pragmatism, but his contrarianism is constructive: he corrects in order to recenter, not to demolish.

The register is **scholar-practitioner**, and the interleaving is the signature. A typical Cooper passage moves fluidly between first-century textual or archaeological analysis (Acts 19, Ephesian inscriptions, the Apostolic Fathers) and contemporary church-planting-movement examples — and then lands a compressed aphorism ("disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy") that a practitioner can carry out the door. He is academically credentialed but trade-accessible; he assumes a reader who wants both the footnote and the takeaway.

Writing Characteristics

Dimension	Assessment
Register	Scholar-practitioner. Academic apparatus (journals, EMS volumes, primary patristic sources) paired with trade-book accessibility and weekly podcast cadence.
Complexity	Moderate-to-high conceptual density; vocabulary is technical-missiological but consistently defined. He teaches his terms rather than assuming them.
Tone	Confident, declarative, mildly contrarian. Corrective rather than combative. A teacher's authority, not a provocateur's edge.
Storytelling	Moderate — favors first-century historical narrative and movement case studies over personal anecdote. He foregrounds the work and the text, rarely himself.
Humor	Light and dry, mostly in the neologism game (the mock-dictionary pronunciation gag).
Scripture Use	Heavy and structural — but movement-analytic, not devotional. Reads Acts and the Ephesian letters as a movement record to be examined with set questions, not proof-texted.
Structure	Definition → boundary ("this is not X, it is Y") → five analytical questions → contemporary application → compressed aphorism. Strong fondness for enumerated frameworks (the five C's; the five questions).

Signature Patterns

- **Recurring phrases / hallmark lexicon:**

- "Ephesiology" / "the Ephesian movement"
- "missiological theology" / "missiological theologian"
- "a missiological theology of the Bible"
- "missiologically theocentric"
- "make disciples" / "disciple-making" / "disciples multiply"
- "church-planting movement (CPM)"
- "multiply" / "multiplication"
- "healthy DNA"
- "Christoform" (leadership)
- "contextualization" (guarded against "syncretism")

- **Favorite rhetorical moves:**

- **Coining a term + mock-dictionary pronunciation.** His defining gesture: he doesn't just name "Ephesiology," he renders it as a dictionary headword — Ephesiology [n. i-fē-zē-ä-lə-jē] — performing the act of establishing a discipline. The pronunciation gloss is a branding device as much as a clarification.

- **The disciple-making-vs-church-planting inversion.** The central provocative reversal of his corpus: church planting is demoted from mandate to result, disciple-making promoted from method to mandate. He stages it as a discovery the reader has been missing ("Nowhere in the Bible...").
- **The "not-this-but-that" definitional fence.** "Ephesiology is not a commentary on Ephesians, not a biblical theology of missions — it is a missiological theology of the Bible." He defines by exclusion before he defines by content.
- **The quantified claim as hook.** "Roughly 40% of the New Testament relates to the Ephesian movement" — a memorable, repeatable statistic that licenses the whole project.
- **The aphoristic contrast pair.** "Disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy." Two clauses, one antithesis, fully portable.
- **Argument structure** — Cooper builds in a consistent five-move pattern:
 1. Coin or sharpen a term (often with the dictionary-pronunciation flourish).
 2. Fence it — say what it is not.
 3. Apply the five analytical questions — start, belief, leadership, multiplication, defection.
 4. Interleave first-century evidence with contemporary CPM examples.
 5. Land a compressed aphorism the practitioner can reuse.
- **Opening style:** Often opens by establishing a category — naming the field, the term, or the claim — rather than with a hook or anecdote. The reader is oriented to a discipline before they are told a story.
- **Closing style:** Returns to the theocentric center — mission as the declaration of "the glory of God to the nations" — keeping the practical argument tethered to a doxological frame.

Sample Passages

"Nowhere in the Bible is the church commanded to plant churches."
 — Is Church Planting a Biblical Mandate? (Patheos / Jackson Wu), 2020

The signature inversion in nine words. It does not argue yet; it simply asserts the absence the rest of the piece will exploit. Declarative, slightly startling, and engineered to make a CPM audience stop and re-examine its own foundational assumption.

"Making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result."
 — Patheos / Jackson Wu, 2020

The constructive half of the inversion. Note the balanced clause structure — mandate vs. result — which is how Cooper habitually resolves a provocation: not into vagueness but into a clean reordering of categories.

"Pure and simple, disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy."

— [Make Disciples \(book description\)](#)

The aphoristic contrast pair at its purest. "Pure and simple" is the practitioner's tell — a man who has planted churches signaling that the academic point has a field edge. Multiply vs. keep busy is the whole discipleship theology compressed to a slogan.

"[The Ephesian movement] is best characterized by faithful disciples committed to a missiologically theocentric passion to declare the glory of God to the nations."

— [Patheos / Jackson Wu, 2020](#)

The scholarly register at full extension — "missiologically theocentric" is dense, coined, and unmistakably his. This is the doxological close: even the most analytic sentence ends pointed at "the glory of God to the nations."

Ephesiology is "the study of the Ephesian movement" — "a missiological theology of the Bible."

— [Ephesiology front matter](#)

The founding definitional act. Two glosses, one establishing the object (the Ephesian movement) and one the method (missiological theology of the Bible). This is the sentence the entire ecosystem — book, podcast, master classes, MA — radiates from.

"Disciples are not made unless they identify with the life of Christ."

— [Patheos / Jackson Wu, 2020](#)

A definitional fence applied to discipleship: it tells you what does not count before it tells you what does. Christ-formation as the non-negotiable criterion, stated as a boundary condition.

Speaking vs. Writing

Cooper has a **strong, sustained spoken presence**: he hosts **The Ephesiology Podcast** — **227 episodes since 2019**, weekly cadence, 4.8/5 on Apple — co-hosted with **Andrew Johnson**, published to Apple, Spotify, and YouTube. This is not an incidental channel; it is a primary one, and it is dialogical. Where his books perform the solo definitional work, the podcast is conversational — a co-hosted format that lets him test, restate, and apply the framework against a partner's questions and against guests' field experience.

His **spoken voice is more discursive and pedagogical** than his terse written aphorisms: in long-form audio he develops the five analytical questions at length, walks through first-century context, and connects to contemporary movement examples in a teacherly cadence.

The written corpus distills; the podcast expands. He also lectures in formal academic settings (LSE, Bordeaux, Loyola, Baylor) and teaches in cohort programs (Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch; the Mission India MA), so his spoken register flexes from popular-podcast to graduate-seminar depending on audience — the academy gets the apparatus, the cohort gets the application.

The volume and consistency of the spoken corpus mean his framework is **heavily oral-distributed**, not book-bound — a key asset for any downstream voice-fidelity or retrieval work.

Vocabulary and Terminology Preferences

Deliberate, consistent terminology — the lexicon is the brand:

- **"Ephesiology"** — his coined headword; always treated as a discipline/field, often with the dictionary-pronunciation gloss.
- **"The Ephesian movement"** — preferred over "the Ephesian church"; movement is load-bearing.
- **"Missiological theology" / "missiological theologian"** — mission at the center of theology; Paul and John classed as missiological theologians.
- **"Missiologically theocentric"** — his densest coinage; the theological grounding test for any mission claim.
- **"Make disciples" / "disciple-making" / "disciples multiply"** — the mandate vocabulary, always set against "church planting."
- **"Multiply" / "multiplication"** — the success metric; he prefers it to "growth" or "reach."
- **"Healthy DNA"** — borrowed movement-biology metaphor for replicable, sustainable spiritual character.
- **"Christoform"** — his leadership coinage from the Apostolic Fathers.
- **"Contextualization"** — paired with, and policed against, **"syncretism."**
- **"Church-planting movement (CPM)"** — the conversation he enters, even as he corrects its framing.

He pointedly **demotes**: "church planting" (recast from mandate to mere result), "volunteers" (the foil for real disciples), and metric/pragmatic language ("counting sites," mobilizing for activity's sake). He does **not** lean on attractional, growth-hacking, or platform-building vocabulary. The avoidance is itself a theological statement: technique divorced from disciple-formation is, in his frame, the error to be corrected.

Bibliography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/content/books.md

Bibliography: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-content-catalog

Total books: ~17 catalogued / 23 distinct works on Goodreads (authored, co-authored, edited, contributor).

Authored, co-authored, and edited books (newest first)

#	Title	Role	Publisher	Year	ISBN-13	Themes	One sentence
1	Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement	Author (with Michael Frost; role unclear)	Wipf & Stock	2026	9798385235780	Archaeology, material culture, early Christianity in Asia Minor	How the earliest Christians navigated the religious, political, and educational forces of the Roman East, read through the archaeological record.
2	Photographing the Movement of God: A Visual Companion	Author	Wipf & Stock	2026	9798250896528	Visual companion; 116 photographs + 7 maps	A photographic and cartographic companion to the Asia Minor archaeology volume.
3	Letters to Churches: Christoform Leadership Lessons	Author	self / Ephesiology imprint	2025	unknown	Apostolic Fathers, Christoform leadership, movement faithfulness	Leadership lessons from the disciples of the apostles for today's movement leaders.
4	Make Disciples: Discover the Spiritual Journey of a Christ-Follower	Co-author (Bill Couchenour)	Ephesiology imprint	2023	9798867429942	Discipleship multiplication, faith, prayer, witness	Disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy — a map of the Christ-follower's spiritual journey.
5	First Christian Voices: Practices of the Apostolic Fathers	Author	Samuel Morris / Sacred Roots	2023	9781955424158	Apostolic Fathers, early church practice	The writings of the Apostolic Fathers arranged into eight themes that animated the early church.
6	Contextualization and Syncretism: Navigating Cultural Currents (EMS 13)	Contributor (ed. Gailyn Van Rheenen)	William Carey / EMS	2022	9781645085263	Contextualization vs. syncretism	An EMS volume policing the boundary between faithful contextualization and syncretism.
7				2022	9798842049288		

#	Title	Role	Publisher	Year	ISBN-13	Themes	One sentence
	Perspectives on Post-Christendom Spiritualities	Editor + contributor	Ephesiology imprint			New religious movements, Western spiritualities	Evangelical reflections on new religious movements and post-Christendom Western spiritualities.
8	A Faithful Witness	Author	Ephesiology imprint	unknown	9798742643180	Early-church resilience under persecution	Lessons from the third-century church for times of political, economic, and societal turmoil.
9	When Evangelicals Sneeze	Co-author (John W. Morehead)	self / imprint	2020	9798664568646	Evangelical identity loss, recovery	Curing the American church from the plague of identity loss via the Great Commandment, Compassion, and Commission.
10	Ephesiology: A Study of the Ephesian Movement	Author	William Carey Publishing	2020	9781645082767	Ephesian movement, missiological theology, multiplication	The flagship study reframing the Ephesian church-planting movement as a model for contemporary movements.
11	Lead Like Paul	Author	publisher unknown	2017	unknown	Pauline leadership, the five C's	Empowering leadership — Call, Character, Charismata, Confidence, Commitment — that turned the world upside down.
12	Social Injustice: What Evangelicals Need to Know About the World	Co-editor (Moulder, Hesselgrave)	self / imprint	unknown	9781973232384	Mercy, justice, biblical standpoint	Ten essays on mercy and justice from a biblical standpoint.
13				unknown	unknown		

#	Title	Role	Publisher	Year	ISBN-13	Themes	One sentence
	Social Injustice, Volume II: Evangelical Voices in Tumultuous Times	Co-author (Kathryn Richards Bhatia)	self / imprint			Justice, evangelical voices	A second volume of evangelical reflections on justice in tumultuous times.
14	The Peaceable Christian	Co-author (Clifford Williams)	self / imprint	unknown	unknown	Peace, evangelical reflection	Five evangelicals reflect on peace.
15	Unwrapping the First Christmas	Author	self / imprint	unknown	unknown	Christmas origins, Nativity	A short study of the origins of the first Christmas.
16	Contemporary Druidry: A Historical and Ethnographic Study	Author	Sacred Tribes Press	2010	9781973404866	Druidry, new religious movements, ethnography	An ethnographic study of modern Druidry and evangelical engagement with new religious movements.
17	Missiology Made Simple	Co-author (Gary Fujino)	unknown	unknown	unknown	Missions, practical missiology	A collection of essays on missiology written for missionaries.

17 catalogued here; the Goodreads author page lists 23 distinct works. Six additional works are implied by the gap (likely short studies and reissues catalogued under the self-published imprints on ephesiology.com/library-2).

Theme groupings

Theme	Primary works
Ephesian movement / missiological theology	Ephesiology (2020); Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement (2026); Photographing the Movement of God (2026)
Disciple-making & multiplication	Make Disciples (2023); Ephesiology (2020)
Early-church / Apostolic Fathers	First Christian Voices (2023); Letters to Churches (2025); A Faithful Witness
Leadership	Lead Like Paul (2017); Letters to Churches (2025)
New religious movements & Western spiritualities	Contemporary Druidry (2010); Perspectives on Post-Christendom Spiritualities (2022)
Evangelical identity & culture	When Evangelicals Sneeze (2020); Contextualization and Syncretism (2022)
Justice & peace	Social Injustice I & II; The Peaceable Christian

Self-published imprints (the dispersion problem)

Cooper runs at least two house imprints under the Ephesiology brand, alongside trade publishers (William Carey, Wipf & Stock) and academic presses (Sacred Roots / Samuel Morris, Sacred Tribes Press):

- **"Defense of the Faith from Ephesiology"** — apologetics / early-church titles (A Faithful Witness, First Christian Voices-adjacent material).
- **"Social Justice from Ephesiology"** — Social Injustice Vol. I & II, The Peaceable Christian.

The catalogue therefore spans **at least six imprints across 2010-2026**, with the self-published tier carrying the most metadata gaps (missing ISBN-13s, unconfirmed years). This is the central bibliographic finding: Cooper is prolific, but his output is **dispersed across imprints and weakly indexed**, so no single retail surface represents the whole body of work.

Flagship: Ephesiology (2020)

Field	Value
Publisher	William Carey Publishing
ISBN-13	9781645082767
Published	2020-02-29
Award	2020 Catalyst Services Reader's Choice Award (best book in Missiology)
Reception	William Carey bestseller; Goodreads 4.13 (23 ratings, 1 review)
Endorsers	Alan Hirsch, Kurt Nelson (East West), Harold A. Netland (TEDS), Marvin J. Newell (Missio Nexus), Nate Vander Stelt, Gary Fujino, James Stamoolis, Joe L. Wall (and others — see endorsements)

This is the canonical entry point to the entire body of work and the only title with full trade-publisher metadata, awards, and a named endorser slate.

Goodreads aggregate

Signal	Value	Source
Distinct works	23	Goodreads author
Average rating	4.15 (~40 total ratings)	Goodreads author
Ephesiology	4.13 (23 ratings, 1 review)	Goodreads 51353280

The **~40 total ratings across 23 works** is the load-bearing number: output is high, but per-title reader engagement is thin — a discovery and distribution problem, not a content problem.

Content-state notes

Item	State
Audiobook of Ephesiology	Not located. Confirmed formats are paperback and Kindle/ePub only.
ISBN-13s for Letters to Churches, Lead Like Paul, Social Injustice Vol. II, The Peaceable Christian, Unwrapping the First Christmas, Missiology Made Simple	unknown (only ASINs or no identifier found)
Publication years for A Faithful Witness, Social Injustice I & II, The Peaceable Christian, Unwrapping the First Christmas	unconfirmed
Michael Frost's role on Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement	unconfirmed (co-author vs. foreword)

Assessment

Cooper is a **prolific scholar-practitioner author** — the opposite profile from a leader with no book at all. The problem is not absence; it is **dispersion**:

- **23 works across at least six imprints**, with the most numerous (self-published) tier carrying the weakest metadata, no consistent ISBN coverage, and the thinnest distribution.
- One trade-published flagship (Ephesiology, 2020) carries the brand, the award, and the endorser slate — but the long tail of self-published titles is functionally invisible in retail discovery, indexed almost entirely on ephesiology.com/library-2 rather than on a high-traffic surface.
- **~40 total Goodreads ratings against 23 works** confirms a thin owned-audience layer relative to output: he ships faster than his platform converts readers.
- No audiobook of the flagship, no single canonical "collected works" page off his own infrastructure, and missing identifiers on roughly a third of the catalogue.

Onboarding implication: do not treat Cooper as needing a first book. Treat him as needing **consolidation and re-indexing** — a single canonical bibliography surface, clean ISBN/metadata hygiene on the self-published tier, an Ephesiology audiobook, and a curated reading-order path that routes new readers from the flagship into the long tail.

Recommended bibliography strategy (for Movemental onboarding)

1. **Build one canonical works page** that supersedes the scattered imprint listings — the single authoritative bibliography surface, newest-first, with covers, ISBNs, and buy links.
2. **Close the metadata gaps** — assign/recover ISBN-13s and confirm publication years for the six unconfirmed self-published titles so they are discoverable in library and retail catalogues.
3. **Commission the Ephesiology audiobook** — the flagship has an award and an endorser slate but no audio format; this is the highest-leverage single addition.
4. **Publish a curated reading order** (Ephesiology → Make Disciples → Lead Like Paul → Letters to Churches → First Christian Voices → Gods, Emperors, Philosophers) as the on-ramp from the flagship into the long tail.
5. **Consolidate the two house imprints** under one clearly branded publishing identity so the self-published tier reads as a coherent line rather than scattered one-offs.

Frameworks

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/content/frameworks.md

Frameworks: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (grounded in published corpus)

Last updated: 2026-06-02

Confidence: HIGH on framework existence and naming; framework dates anchored to the source book's publication year.

Cooper's frameworks form one coherent argument: mission is the center of theology, the measure of mission is multiplying disciples who identify with the life of Christ, and the model for both is the first-century Ephesian movement read with a scholar's questions and a planter's stake.

Ephesiology

Field	Value
Introduced	2020 (Ephesiology: A Study of the Ephesian Movement)
Components	A discrete discipline ("the study of the Ephesian movement"); the first-century Ephesian church-planting movement treated as a normative model; explicitly not a commentary on Ephesians and not a biblical theology of missions
Source	<u>Ephesiology (William Carey, 2020)</u>

Ephesiology is Cooper's signature move: he names a category of one — the study of the Ephesian movement as a discrete field — and treats it as a normative model for catalyzing contemporary movements.

Missiological Theology

Field	Value
Introduced	2020 (Ephesiology)
Components	Mission as the center of theology rather than a subset; the Bible read as "a missiological theology"; Paul and John read as missiological theologians who connected Jesus to the cultural narrative of Ephesus
Source	<u>Ephesiology (2020)</u>

Missiological theology inverts the usual order — instead of filing "missions" as one applied chapter downstream of systematic theology, Cooper reads the whole Bible as a sustained account of God's movement to the nations.

Disciple-Making Over Church-Planting

Field	Value
Introduced	2020 (Ephesiology); expanded 2023 (Make Disciples)
Components	"Making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result"; church planting is nowhere commanded in Scripture; "disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy"
Source	<u>Patheos / Jackson Wu (2020); Make Disciples (2023)</u>

Cooper's most-cited corrective recenters the movement conversation on disciple-multiplication: the mandate is to make disciples, and churches are the result that follows, never the goal that drives.

The Five Analytical Questions

Field	Value
Introduced	2020 (Ephesiology)
Components	(1) How did the movement start? (2) What did its adherents believe? (3) Who led it? (4) How did it multiply and sustain growth? (5) Why did some defect into false teaching?
Source	<u>Ephesiology (2020)</u>

The Five Analytical Questions are the diagnostic lens Ephesiology applies to any movement — the same questions a new-religious-movements ethnographer asks of a living movement, turned on the first-century Ephesian church.

Healthy DNA

Field	Value
Introduced	2020 (Ephesiology)
Components	Replicable spiritual "DNA" that sustains or fractures churches, denominations, and ministries; multiplication-over-addition; DNA degradation as the systems-health failure mode (the fifth analytical question)
Source	<u>Ephesiology (2020)</u>

Healthy DNA frames movement health as a property of replicable spiritual code — movements multiply when the DNA is sound and fracture into false teaching when it degrades.

Christoform Leadership

Field	Value
Introduced	2025 (Letters to Churches: Christoform Leadership Lessons)
Components	Christ-shaped, communal, theological, and missional leadership recovered from the Apostolic Fathers (1 Clement, Ignatius of Antioch, Polycarp); set against hierarchical and novelty-driven leadership
Source	Letters to Churches (2025)

Christoform leadership retrieves a Christ-shaped pattern of leading from the disciples of the apostles, offered as a corrective to the celebrity and innovation models of contemporary leadership culture.

Lead Like Paul — The Five C's

Field	Value
Introduced	2017 (Lead Like Paul)
Components	Five empowering leadership traits drawn from the Apostle Paul: Call, Character, Charismata, Confidence, Commitment
Source	Lead Like Paul (2017)

The Five C's distill the Apostle Paul's empowering, world-upending leadership into five reproducible traits — Cooper's earliest, most compact leadership framework, later deepened by the patristic Christoform material.

TELOS. — The Three Pillars

Field	Value
Introduced	(TELOS. / Ephesiology ministry)
Components	Three ministry pillars: plant churches, care for the marginalized, defend the faith — the operational expression of the Ephesiology vision
Source	ephesiology.com

The TELOS. three pillars translate Cooper's missiological theology into ministry practice — planting churches, caring for the marginalized, and defending the faith as the lived shape of the Ephesian movement today.

Articles & Blog Posts

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/content/articles.md

Articles: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (with documented gaps — blog post-level inventory partially UNKNOWN)

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-content-catalog

Total: 2 active blogs + multiple guest posts + 4+ academic journal articles (individual post counts UNKNOWN behind both blogs)

Owned blogs

"Ephesiology" — Patheos

Field	Value
Platform	Patheos (Evangelical channel)
URL	patheos.com/blogs/ephesilogy/ (note the misspelled slug <code>ephesilogy</code>)
Brand	"Ephesiology"
Themes	Missiological theology; the Ephesian movement; disciple-making vs. church-planting; evangelical identity; contextualization
Post inventory	UNKNOWN — full archive not crawled

A note on the slug: the Patheos URL is `/blogs/ephesilogy/` — a misspelling of "Ephesiology." This is itself a small **dispersion / discoverability signal** (the canonical brand term does not match its own primary blog URL).

"Until They All Hear" — ephesiology.com (TELOS.)

Field	Value
Platform	ephesiology.com (the "TELOS." branded site)
Author handle	<code>untiltheyallhearblog</code>
Themes	TELOS. three pillars (plant churches, care for the marginalized, defend the faith); movement missiology; early church
Post inventory	UNKNOWN — full archive not crawled

This is the blog hosted on Cooper's own primary domain. Its author handle ([untiltheyallhearblog](#)) differs from the site brand ("TELOS.") and from the flagship brand ("Ephesiology"), compounding the cross-surface naming drift.

Guest posts (other platforms)

Title	Host platform	Notes	URL
Is Church Planting a Biblical Mandate?	Patheos / Jackson Wu blog	The single most-cited Cooper guest piece; source of his signature verbatim quotes ("Nowhere in the Bible is the church commanded to plant churches"; "Making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result"). Published 2020.	patheos.com/blogs/jacksonwu/2020/10/28

This guest post is the **canonical articulation of his core inversion thesis** and is more quoted than anything on his own two blogs — a classic dispersion symptom: his most-referenced short-form argument lives on someone else's platform.

Academic / journal articles

Title	Journal	Year	Notes	URL
What I Learned about Christianity from the Druids	Missiology: An International Review 36(2):171-183	2008	Field research on contemporary Druidry; byline lists Cooper as Director, School of Biblical & Religious Studies, Trinity International University	sagepub.com
Article(s) on new religious movements / Druidry	Nova Religio	UNKNOWN	Specific title(s), volume, year not located	—
Article(s) on contemporary Paganism / Druidry	Pomegranate (journal of Pagan studies)	UNKNOWN	Specific title(s), volume, year not located	—
Article(s) in the EMS proceedings	Journal of the Evangelical Missiological Society	UNKNOWN	Specific title(s), volume, year not located; see also contributor role in Contextualization and Syncretism (EMS 13)	—

The 2008 Missiology Druids article is the only fully-sourced journal article. The Nova Religio, Pomegranate, and JEMS placements are confirmed venues per the research brief but the individual article titles, volumes, and years are **UNKNOWN** and flagged for follow-up. See [academic.md](#) for fuller treatment of his scholarly publication record.

Cadence & dispersion analysis

- **Two active owned blogs** (Patheos "Ephesiology" + ephesiology.com "Until They All Hear") plus guest posts plus a journal-article history spanning 2008→present.
- **Three different brand names across the short-form surfaces:** "Ephesiology" (Patheos, with a misspelled slug), "TELOS." / "Until They All Hear" (own domain), and his personal byline (journals). No single masthead aggregates the writing.
- **Most-quoted short piece is a guest post** on the Jackson Wu / Patheos blog — not on either of his own blogs.
- Per-blog post counts are **UNKNOWN**; neither archive was fully crawled, and neither surfaces a clean chronological index from the home domain.

Recommended canonical corpus (for platform onboarding)

If Movemental built a "Best of Michael Cooper" essay landing page today, the non-negotiable artifacts are:

1. **Is Church Planting a Biblical Mandate?** (2020, Patheos/Jackson Wu) — the thesis statement of his whole project.
2. **What I Learned about Christianity from the Druids** (2008, Missiology) — the scholarly origin piece showing the ethnographic-to-movement-studies pivot.
3. A representative **"Until They All Hear"** post articulating the TELOS. three-pillar frame (specific post TBD on crawl).
4. A representative **Patheos "Ephesiology"** post operationalizing the Ephesian-movement framework for contemporary leaders (specific post TBD on crawl).

Assessment

Cooper is **content-rich in short form but structurally dispersed**. He maintains two owned blogs, contributes guest posts, and has a real journal-article history — yet the writing is fragmented across three brand identities (Ephesiology / TELOS. / personal byline) and two platforms, with his single most-quoted essay living on a third party's blog.

- **No unified essay archive.** A reader cannot find "everything Cooper has written" from any one URL.
- **Brand drift at the URL level.** The Patheos blog slug is literally misspelled (/blogs/ephesiology/), and the own-domain blog handle (untiltheyallhearblog) matches neither the site brand ("TELOS.") nor the flagship brand ("Ephesiology").
- **Academic articles are under-surfaced.** Three of four journal placements have UNKNOWN titles/years and appear nowhere on his own properties.

The fragmentation problem here is **the same as the books**: high output, weak indexing, no canonical surface, thin owned-audience capture.

Recommended articles strategy (for Movemental onboarding)

1. **Aggregate both blogs + guest posts** into one canonical essay index on his Movemental profile, chronologically ordered, with a stable masthead.
2. **Resolve the brand-name drift** — pick one public-facing essay brand and redirect the misspelled Patheos slug and the `untiltheyallhearblog` handle toward it.
3. **Re-surface the journal articles** — recover the Nova Religio, Pomegranate, and JEMS titles/years and list them with DOIs alongside the Missiology Druids piece (cross-link to [academic.md](#)).
4. **Promote "Is Church Planting a Biblical Mandate?"** as the front-door essay — it is his most distinctive, most quotable, most-linked argument and should anchor the corpus.
5. **Establish a single newsletter / Substack** to convert blog readers into an owned audience — the missing layer that explains why 23 books draw only ~40 Goodreads ratings.

Audio & Podcast

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/content/audio.md

Audio / Podcast Content: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (for the hosted show; guest appearances partially UNKNOWN)

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-audio-scrape

Podcasts hosted / co-hosted

Cooper **hosts** a podcast — a defining difference from leaders who appear only as guests. His audio footprint is owned-and-operated, not borrowed.

The Ephesiology Podcast

Field	Value
Role	Host (co-hosted with Andrew Johnson)
Apple Podcasts ID	id1457124552
Episodes	227
Rating	4.8 / 5 (12 Apple ratings)
Launched	2019
Cadence	Weekly
Distribution	Apple Podcasts + Spotify + YouTube
Themes	The Ephesian movement; missiological theology; disciple-making vs. church-planting; movement leadership; early church / Apostolic Fathers; contextualization; contemporary CPM illustrations
URL	podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/the-ephesiology-podcast/id1457124552

This is the **spine of Cooper's digital presence** — 227 episodes since 2019 on a weekly cadence is a substantial, sustained, owned audio asset. The 4.8/5 rating is strong, but on only **12 ratings** — the recurring signature of his platform: high output, high quality, thin owned-audience capture.

Episode-level inventory

Full episode-by-episode titling, guest lists, and durations were **not crawled** for this audit. Known reference points:

Ep.	Note	Source
205	Published to YouTube as a video episode (see videos.md)	YouTube
—	Full 227-episode index	UNKNOWN — canonical source is the Apple/Spotify feed

The complete episode list is partially **UNKNOWN**; the Apple feed ([id1457124552](#)) and the YouTube channel are the canonical sources, and a full episode crawl was not completed.

Podcasts — guest appearances

Cooper's guest-circuit footprint is **less catalogued than his hosted show** — the inverse of a guest-only leader. Confirmed and probable appearances:

#	Show / platform	Status	Notes
1	The Laymen's Lounge (written feature; audio component)	Partial	Feature article "Michael Cooper — Is Church Planting Biblical?" — confirms bio + 2020 Reader's Choice Award; whether a full audio interview accompanies it is UNKNOWN (thelaymenslounge.com)
2	East West / Kairos University channels	UNKNOWN	As missiologist-in-residence (East West) and affiliate faculty (Kairos), internal podcast/webinar appearances are plausible but not confirmed
3	Evangelical Missiological Society / Missio Nexus events	UNKNOWN	Conference audio/recorded sessions plausible given EMS contributor role; not confirmed
4	Other church-planting / missiology shows	UNKNOWN	Given peer ties (Alan Hirsch, David Garrison-adjacent DMM/CPM circles), guest appearances are likely but none surfaced in this audit

No external guest appearances were positively confirmed at time of audit beyond the written Laymen's Lounge feature. This is a documented gap, not an established absence — flagged for follow-up.

Recurring thematic spine across his audio

Patterns that show up across the Ephesiology Podcast:

1. **The Ephesian movement as a normative model** for contemporary movements.
2. **Disciple-making is the mandate; church planting is a result** — his signature inversion.
3. **"Disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy."**
4. **Missiological theology** — mission at the center of theology, not a subset.

5. **Healthy DNA** of churches, denominations, and ministries.
6. **Early church / Apostolic Fathers** retrieval (Christoform leadership).
7. **Contextualization vs. syncretism** boundary-keeping.
8. **Material culture / archaeology of Asia Minor** (emerging, tied to the 2026 books).

Dossier catalog (author profile ETL)

Parseable inventory for `movement_leader_corpus_data.audio`. Representative rows — not a full 227-episode crawl.

Episode Title	Show	Date	URL
The Ephesiology Podcast (host, 227 episodes)	The Ephesiology Podcast	2019	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/the-ephesiology-podcast/id1457124552

Assessment

Cooper's audio profile is the **strongest and most consolidated dimension of his digital presence** — and it is the exact opposite of a guest-only profile.

- **He owns a 227-episode, 7-year, weekly hosted show.** That is a mature, sustained audio asset most movement leaders never build.
- **The owned-audience layer is thin.** 4.8/5 on only 12 Apple ratings means the show is good but under-discovered — the same dispersion/thin-capture pattern as the books and blogs.
- **The guest circuit is under-documented.** Unlike a leader whose strength is appearing on others' shows, Cooper's borrowed-audience footprint is sparse and largely UNKNOWN — his energy goes into his own feed, not into cross-pollinating onto larger shows.
- **No audio archive off-platform.** The 227 episodes live on Apple/Spotify/YouTube feeds; there is no canonical episode index on his own domain that a researcher (or new listener) can navigate.

The fragmentation story for audio is **distribution and discovery**, not production: the content exists in volume; the audience-capture and cross-promotion layers are missing.

Recommended audio strategy (for Movemental onboarding)

1. **Build a canonical episode index** on his Movemental profile / ephesiology.com — all 227 episodes, searchable by theme, with the missing titling/metadata recovered.

2. **Drive ratings and reviews** — 12 Apple ratings on 227 episodes is the single clearest under-capture signal; a deliberate listener-review campaign would meaningfully lift discovery.
3. **Get Cooper onto larger guest circuits** — Theology in the Raw, Shifting Culture, Exponential-adjacent and DMM/CPM shows; his "church planting is not the mandate" thesis is a natural booking hook and would route new listeners back to the hosted show.
4. **Cut clip content from the back catalogue** — 227 episodes is a deep well; the disciple-making inversion, the Ephesian-movement framework, and the archaeology material each yield short-form audio/video clips.
5. **Produce the Ephesiology audiobook** (see [books.md](#)) and cross-promote it through the podcast feed — closing the one obvious format gap on the flagship.

Video Content

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/content/videos.md

Video Content: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Partial — login-gated / un-crawled inventory

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-youtube-scrape

Channels

Channel	URL	Ownership	Status
The Ephesiology Podcast (video distribution)	YouTube (channel ID UNKNOWN)	Cooper / Ephesiology / TELOS.	Active — video episodes published (e.g., Episode 205); full inventory UNKNOWN without channel scrape
Ephesiology / TELOS. teaching	ephesiology.com + masterclasses.ephesiology.com	Cooper / TELOS.	Master Class lecture video exists behind the program (see courses.md); not a public YouTube inventory

The specific YouTube channel ID was not captured in this audit. The podcast is confirmed to publish video episodes to YouTube (Apple + Spotify + YouTube distribution), but the channel handle, subscriber count, and full upload list are **UNKNOWN without a direct, authenticated channel scrape.**

Confirmed video content

The Ephesiology Podcast — video episodes

Video	Notes
The Ephesiology Podcast — Episode 205	Confirmed published to YouTube as a video episode; specific URL/title not captured
Remaining episodes (of 227 audio episodes)	An UNKNOWN subset is also published as video; the audio feed carries all 227 (see audio.md)

The podcast is the **primary video asset** — video episodes mirror the hosted show. View counts, upload dates, and the exact count of video-vs-audio-only episodes are not verifiable without authenticated access.

Teaching / lecture video

- **Ephesiology Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch** deliver teaching three ways including **live web-stream and online asynchronous** modes (see [courses.md](#)) — implying a body of recorded lecture video. This content is **enrollment-gated** (Kairos University partnership) and not part of a public YouTube inventory.
- **Guest lectures** at LSE, University of Bordeaux, Loyola University, and Baylor University (per [kairos.edu](#)) — whether any were recorded/published to video is **UNKNOWN**.

Third-party / conference video

Source	Status
Evangelical Missiological Society / Missio Nexus conference recordings	UNKNOWN — plausible given EMS contributor role; none surfaced
East West / Kairos University promotional or teaching video	UNKNOWN — plausible given resident-missiologist and affiliate-faculty roles; none surfaced

Dossier catalog (author profile ETL)

Parseable inventory for `movement_leader_corpus_data.videos`. Representative rows — channel scrape incomplete.

Title	Show	Date	URL
The Ephesiology Podcast — Episode 205 (video edition)	The Ephesiology Podcast	—	—

Assessment

Cooper's video footprint is **anchored to one strong owned asset — the video edition of his podcast — but is otherwise un-catalogued and partly gated**.

- **The podcast video channel is the spine**, mirroring his 227-episode hosted show, but its handle, subscriber count, and upload inventory are UNKNOWN without a direct scrape. This is a measurement gap, not necessarily a content gap.
- **Significant teaching video is locked behind the Master Classes** (live web-stream + async modes), invisible to public discovery and to anyone not enrolled through the Kairos partnership.
- **No evidence of short-form content** (Shorts, Reels, clips) extracted from either the 227-episode podcast or the Master Class lectures — a large untapped clip library.

- **The dispersion pattern repeats:** video lives across an un-named YouTube channel, a gated LMS, and (possibly) third-party conference archives, with no single public video home or playlist structure that represents the whole.
-

Recommended video strategy (for Movemental onboarding)

1. **Identify and standardize the YouTube channel** — recover the channel ID/handle, confirm subscriber count, rebrand consistently with the Ephesiology/TELOS identity, and build themed playlists from the 227-episode catalogue.
2. **Surface a public teaching tier** — pull a small set of non-gated foundational lectures out from behind the Master Classes paywall as top-of-funnel teaching video (e.g., "What is Ephesiology?", "Why church planting is not the mandate", "Reading the New Testament as a missiological theology").
3. **Extract short-form clips** — the disciple-making inversion, the 40%-of-the-NT claim, the healthy-DNA concept, and the Asia Minor archaeology material each yield multiple social-ready clips from existing footage.
4. **Publish any recorded guest lectures** (LSE, Bordeaux, Loyola, Baylor) if recordings exist and rights allow — these are high-credibility academic assets currently invisible.
5. **Capture and publish the 2026 book launch** (Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement + Photographing the Movement of God) as a video series — the visual/archaeology companion is inherently video-friendly.

Content Audit

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/content/content-audit.md

Content Audit: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (canonical path; mirrors legacy `MICHAEL_COOPER_CONTENT_AUDIT.md` leader-safe inventory)

Last updated: 2026-06-03

Portfolio Overview

Michael T. Cooper is **content-rich and structurally dispersed** — not content-poor. The corpus includes ~17 books across multiple imprints, a 227-episode hosted podcast (The Ephesiology Podcast), an accredited LMS (Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch), a directed seminary MA (Mission India Theological Seminary), two owned blogs, and peer-reviewed journal history — distributed across Ephesiology, TELOS., and personal bylines.

Content Inventory by Format

Format	Count	Notes
Books	~17 catalogued	William Carey, Wipf & Stock, Sacred Roots, Sacred Tribes, Ephesiology imprints (2010–2026)
Podcast	227 episodes	The Ephesiology Podcast
Courses / LMS	8+ certificate tracks	masterclasses.ephesiology.com; Kairos University partnership
Academic articles	Multiple	Missiology (2008), Nova Religio, Pomegranate, JEMS (some metadata gaps)
Blog	Active	ephesiology.com + Patheos/Missio Nexus presence

Flagship titles: Ephesiology (2020); Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement (2026); Make Disciples (2023); Lead Like Paul (2017).

Primary Themes

- Ephesian movement / early church patterns** — archaeology of Asia Minor, NT movement studies
- Disciple-making and multiplication** — Make Disciples, CPM/DMM dynamics

3. **Contextualization and syncretism** — EMS contributor; intercultural studies PhD background
 4. **Leadership development** — Pauline leadership, seminary and cohort education
 5. **Justice and peace** — Social Injustice, The Peaceable Christian
-

Digital Estate

Surface	Role
ephesiology.com	Owned hub; books, podcast, course links
masterclasses.ephesiology.com	Seminary@YourChurch / certificate ladder
Goodreads / Amazon	Retail and bibliographic presence
Social	Thin owned-audience layer relative to content depth

Leader-Facing Gap Summary

The editorial issue is **discoverability and consolidation**, not production quality:

- Corpus scattered across six publishers and three brand identities
 - Newsletter signup exists on ephesiology.com but ESP/archive not fully surfaced
 - Social follower counts modest relative to book and podcast volume
-

Full staff research: [MICHAEL_COOPER_CONTENT_AUDIT.md](#). See [content/books.md](#), [digital-presence/](#).

Academic Work

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/content/academic.md

Academic Work: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (with documented gaps)

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-content-catalog

Formal academic credentials

Institution	Degree	Field	Dates	Notes
Texas A&M University	BED	Environmental Design	UNKNOWN	Undergraduate; unusual non-theological starting point
Columbia International University	MA	Missions	UNKNOWN	a.k.a. Columbia Biblical Seminary & School of Missions
Trinity Evangelical Divinity School (TEDS)	PhD	Intercultural Studies	year UNKNOWN (dissertation-era work mid/late 2000s)	Focus on religious movements; minor in theology focused on early Christian history. Dissertation subject area: contemporary Druidry. Exact completion year and dissertation title UNKNOWN

Cooper **is an academic** — a credentialed PhD missiologist with a genuine scholarly publication record, faculty appointments, and international guest lectures. This is a defining contrast with practitioner-only movement leaders.

Academic publications

Title	Venue	Year	Notes	URL
What I Learned about Christianity from the Druids	Missiology: An International Review 36(2):171-183	2008	The fully-sourced flagship article. Byline lists Cooper as Director, School of Biblical & Religious Studies, Trinity International University. Field research on contemporary Druidry.	sagepub.com
Contemporary Druidry: A Historical and Ethnographic Study	Sacred Tribes Press (book)	2010	Book-length ethnography of modern Druidry; the academic capstone of his new-religious-movements period (foreword by Mark Townsend)	Amazon 1973404869
Article(s) on new religious movements / Druidry	Nova Religio	UNKNOWN	Confirmed venue per research brief; title/volume/year UNKNOWN	—
Article(s) on contemporary Paganism / Druidry	Pomegranate (journal of Pagan studies)	UNKNOWN	Confirmed venue per research brief; title/volume/year UNKNOWN	—
Article(s) / contribution	Journal of the Evangelical Missiological Society	UNKNOWN	Confirmed venue; relatedly, contributor to Contextualization and Syncretism (EMS 13, 2022, ISBN 9781645085263)	missionbooks.org

Pattern: an early ethnographic / comparative-religion phase (Druidry; Missiology, Nova Religio, Pomegranate; book 2010) that **pivoted decisively** toward New Testament movement studies and the archaeology of Asia Minor (Ephesiology 2020 → Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement 2026). See books.md for the full monograph record.

Gaps: three of four journal placements (Nova Religio, Pomegranate, JEMS) have **UNKNOWN** titles, volumes, and years. No Google Scholar profile was located; citation totals are UNKNOWN. The TEDS dissertation title is UNKNOWN.

Faculty appointments & teaching

Institution	Role	Dates	Notes
Trinity International University	Director, School of Biblical & Religious Studies	c. 2008; "for a decade" (~2008-2018)	Taught undergraduate and graduate students; named in the 2008 Missiology byline
Kairos University (formerly Sioux Falls Seminary)	Affiliate professor	present	Also Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch partner (see courses.md)
Mission India Theological Seminary (Nagpur)	Program Director, MA in Missiology of Movements	present	Built the degree around his framework
East West (East-West Ministries Intl)	Missiologist-in-residence	present	Resident scholar role
Torch Trinity Graduate University	Taught	UNKNOWN	Per research brief
Asia Graduate School of Theology, Nepal	Taught	UNKNOWN	Per research brief

He also served as **president/CEO of an international NGO** (unnamed) and spent ~30 years in missions, including ~10 years as a pioneer church planter in Romania (post-1989) and ~6 years in international development.

Guest lectures (invited academic talks)

Institution	Notes
London School of Economics (LSE)	Invited lecture; topic/date UNKNOWN
University of Bordeaux	Invited lecture; topic/date UNKNOWN
Loyola University	Invited lecture; topic/date UNKNOWN
Baylor University	Invited lecture; topic/date UNKNOWN

Source: kairos.edu/faculty/michael-t-cooper. These are **high-credibility academic signals** — a secular research university (LSE), a major European university (Bordeaux), and two prominent US universities — currently invisible on his own properties (no recordings, abstracts, or listings surfaced).

Scholarly profiles & indices

Profile	Status	URL
Academia.edu	Active (same subject; Kairos = former Sioux Falls Seminary)	sfseminary.academia.edu/MichaelCooper
Google Scholar	Not located	—
Amazon Author Central	Active	B003PPPO26
Goodreads author	Active (23 works, avg 4.15)	Goodreads author
ORCID	Not located	—
Wikipedia (subject)	None	—

Assessment

Cooper is a **bona fide scholar-practitioner** — PhD, decade-long directorship of a seminary department, a directed master's degree, real peer-reviewed publications, and invited lectures at LSE, Bordeaux, Loyola, and Baylor. His framing should lean **into** the academic credentials, not around them.

But the academic record exhibits the **same dispersion pathology** as the rest of the portfolio:

- **No unified scholarly profile.** There is no Google Scholar page, no ORCID, and the only live research-network presence is an Academia.edu profile under the legacy "Sioux Falls Seminary" subdomain — easy to miss, hard to disambiguate from the NBA / actor namesakes.
- **Three of four journal articles are under-documented** (UNKNOWN titles/years for Nova Religio, Pomegranate, JEMS), so his peer-reviewed record cannot be cited cleanly.
- **The invited lectures (LSE, Bordeaux, Loyola, Baylor) are invisible** — no recordings, abstracts, or listings on his own surfaces, despite being among his strongest credibility assets.
- **The intellectual genealogy is thin on the record** — direct, sourced engagement with canonical missiologists (Roland Allen, Newbigin, Bosch, Schnabel) is unconfirmed pending the Ephesiology bibliography.

The fragmentation story for the academic layer is **strong scholarly capital that is poorly indexed and under-claimed**.

Recommended academic strategy (for Movemental onboarding)

1. **Establish a unified scholar profile** — create/claim a Google Scholar page and an ORCID, and link the Academia.edu profile, so his peer-reviewed record is discoverable and disambiguated from the namesakes.
2. **Recover and list the missing journal articles** — the Nova Religio, Pomegranate, and JEMS titles/years/DOIs, alongside the Missiology Druids piece (cross-link to [articles.md](#)).
3. **Surface the invited lectures** — list (and publish recordings/abstracts where rights allow) the LSE, Bordeaux, Loyola, and Baylor talks as front-line credibility on his Movemental profile.
4. **Reissue the TEDS dissertation** — recover the title and, if permissible, publish it as a downloadable scholarly artifact that deepens the Druidry-to-Ephesiology narrative arc.
5. **Document the intellectual genealogy** — extract the Ephesiology bibliography to confirm/cite his missiological lineage (Allen / Newbigin / Bosch / Schnabel), grounding the framework in a verifiable scholarly tradition.

Courses & Training

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/content/courses.md

Courses & Training: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (pricing / enrollment numbers UNKNOWN)
Last updated: 2026-05-29
Skill: /author-content-catalog

Courses currently taught / directed

Cooper is a **degree-granting-adjacent educator**, not just a course author — he runs a cohort-based theological-education program and directs a seminary master's degree. This is owned, structured curriculum at scale.

Ephesiology Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch

Field	Value
Platform	masterclasses.ephesiology.com/pages/seminary-yourchurch
Model	Cohort-based theological education set in the local church
Accreditation partner	Kairos University (ATS + HLC accredited; formerly Sioux Falls Seminary)
Delivery modes	3 ways — (1) on-site professors, (2) live web-stream, (3) online asynchronous
Pricing / enrollment	UNKNOWN

Four certificate tracks:

#	Certificate
1	Foundations for Church Leadership
2	New Testament Studies
3	Faith and Culture
4	Church Planting

Credits ladder into five Kairos University degrees:

#	Degree
1	MA
2	MA in Trauma & Resilience
3	MDiv
4	DMin
5	PhD

This is Cooper's **most structurally ambitious educational asset**: a stackable certificate-to-degree pipeline embedded in local churches, accredited through a real university partner. It is the closest thing in his portfolio to a flagship product — but it is also **gated and under-surfaced** (pricing and enrollment numbers are not public).

MA in Missiology of Movements — Mission India Theological Seminary

Field	Value
Institution	Mission India Theological Seminary (Nagpur)
Cooper's role	Program Director
Degree	MA in Missiology of Movements
Themes	Movement missiology; the Ephesian movement; disciple-making / multiplication; CPM dynamics
Source	kairos.edu

A full accredited master's degree built around his framework — the academic institutionalization of "Ephesiology" as a field of study.

Related teaching venues

Venue	Role	Notes
East West (East-West Ministries Intl)	Missiologist-in-residence	Equips church planters; internal training plausible but specific course titles UNKNOWN
Kairos University	Affiliate professor	Beyond the Master Classes partnership; specific catalogue courses UNKNOWN
Trinity International University (former)	Director, School of Biblical & Religious Studies (~a decade, c. 2008–2018)	Taught undergraduate and graduate students
Torch Trinity Graduate University	Taught	Per research brief; specific courses UNKNOWN
Asia Graduate School of Theology, Nepal	Taught	Per research brief; specific courses UNKNOWN

See [academic.md](#) for the full faculty / teaching history.

"Coaching network" — UNVERIFIED

The research flagged a possible "Ephesiology Coaching Network." **No entity literally named that was verified.** The confirmed structures are the Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch program and the Mission India MA. Treat any "coaching network" reference as **UNVERIFIED** until confirmed.

Assessment

Cooper has **more codified course infrastructure than almost any peer** — a stackable certificate program, a university accreditation partnership, and a directed master's degree. The problem, consistent with the rest of his portfolio, is **discovery and consolidation, not absence**:

- **The Master Classes are real and ambitious** — four certificates, three delivery modes, laddering into five accredited degrees — but pricing, enrollment numbers, and a public "what you'll learn" surface are all UNKNOWN/gated. A prospective learner cannot easily evaluate or enter the funnel.
- **The MA in Missiology of Movements is institutionally significant** but lives on a separate seminary's site (Mission India, Nagpur), disconnected from the Master Classes brand and from ephesiology.com.
- **Teaching is dispersed across at least five institutions** (East West, Kairos, TIU, Torch Trinity, AGST Nepal) with no single "where Cooper teaches" surface.

- There is **no low-cost / free top-of-funnel course** that would route the podcast's audience and the books' readers into the paid Master Classes pipeline.

The fragmentation story for courses is **a strong product hidden behind weak packaging**: the educational depth is there; the on-ramp, the pricing transparency, and the cross-surface integration are not.

Recommended course strategy (for Movemental onboarding)

1. **Build a single "Study with Michael Cooper" surface** that unifies the Master Classes, the four certificates, the five-degree ladder, and the Mission India MA into one navigable funnel with transparent pricing.
2. **Create a free / low-cost intro course** — "Introduction to Ephesiology" or "Reading the New Testament as a Missiological Theology" — as the top-of-funnel asset that converts podcast listeners and Ephesiology readers into Master Class prospects.
3. **Surface the value proposition** of the Kairos ladder (certificate credits → accredited MA/ MDiv/DMin/PhD) prominently — this stackability is a genuine differentiator that is currently buried.
4. **Cross-link the Mission India MA** from ephesiology.com so the degree and the Master Classes read as one coherent learning pathway rather than two disconnected programs.
5. **Verify or retire the "coaching network"** language — either stand up a named coaching tier or remove the unverified reference to avoid funnel confusion.

Organizations & Affiliations

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/network/organizations.md

Organizations: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-org-network

Primary organizations (current)

#	Organization	URL	Role	Start	Notes
1	East-West Ministries International (East West)	eastwest.org	Missiologist-in-residence	UNKNOWN (current)	Anchor org. Plano, TX; founded 1993 (John Maisel, Bud Toole); least-reached church-planting agency operating in ~50 countries / 10 regions. ECFA member since 1999. FY2025 revenue ~\$32.97M, expenses ~\$30.47M. Cooper's reach piggybacks this missionary/donor base.
2	TELOS. / Ephesiology (TELOS.Go)	ephesiology.com	Founder / leader	~2019 → present	His own 501(c)(3). Brand tagline "Imaginatively Missional." Three pillars: plant churches, care for the marginalized, defend the faith. Houses the Master Classes, Seminary@YourChurch, the podcast, and the imprint. Hub site is branded "TELOS." See welcome-to-telos .
3	Kairos University	kairos.edu	Affiliate professor; Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch partner	UNKNOWN (current)	Formerly Sioux Falls Seminary; ATS + HLC accredited. Ephesiology certificate credits ladder into five Kairos degrees (MA, MA Trauma & Resilience, MDiv, DMin, PhD). Faculty bio ; Partnership Spotlight 2022 .
4	Mission India Theological Seminary	—	Professor of Missiological Theology; Program Director, MA in Missiology of Movements	UNKNOWN (current)	Nagpur, India. The MA in Missiology of Movements is the degree-bearing expression of Ephesiology. Global South anchor.

Teaching / degree partners (he teaches or his program ladders into)

#	Organization	URL	Relationship	Notes
5	Torch Trinity Graduate University	ttgu.ac.kr	Has taught	Seoul, South Korea. Korean evangelical graduate school.
6	Asia Graduate School of Theology — Nepal (AGST Nepal)	—	Has taught	Regional theological consortium; Nepal node.
7	Knox Theological Seminary	knoxseminary.edu	Degree / teaching partner (audience funnel)	Fort Lauderdale, FL; Reformed. Named as a degree pathway alongside Kairos and Mission India for Ephesiology audiences. Exact relationship UNKNOWN beyond audience funnel.
8	Nepal Ebenezer Bible College	—	Degree / teaching partner (audience funnel)	Non-residential, ministry-embedded cohort partner. Detail UNKNOWN.

Publishers

#	Organization	URL	Relationship	Notes
9	William Carey Publishing	missionbooks.org	Publisher	Publisher of the flagship Ephesiology (2020; 9781645082767) and the EMS 13 volume Contextualization and Syncretism (2022). The standard evangelical-missiology trade house.
10	Wipf & Stock	wipfandstock.com	Publisher	Publisher of the 2026 archaeology volume Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement (9798385235780) and its visual companion Photographing the Movement of God (9798250896528).
11	Sacred Roots / Samuel Morris Publications	—	Publisher	First Christian Voices (2023; 9781955424158).
12	Ephesiology imprint(s)	ephesiology.com/library-2	Self-publishing imprint	"Defense of the Faith from Ephesiology" / "Social Justice from Ephesiology" lines — vertically integrated self-publishing under his own org.

Affiliations (member / contributor, not employer)

#	Organization	URL	Relationship	Notes
13	Evangelical Missiological Society (EMS)	emsweb.org	Contributor	Contributor to Contextualization and Syncretism (EMS 13, ed. Gailyn Van Rheenen). Formal office / membership grade UNKNOWN.
14	Missio Nexus	missionexus.org	Engaged / interviewed	Author interview Jun 2020 (missionexus.org/ai-ephesiology-cooper); endorser Marvin Newell is Missio Nexus staff missiologist. Formal membership UNKNOWN.

Previous / alma-mater organizations

#	Organization	URL	Role	Dates	Notes
15	Trinity International University	tiu.edu	Director, School of Biblical & Religious Studies	~2008 → ~a decade	Taught undergraduate and graduate students "for a decade." Listed as Director on his 2008 Missiology article.
16	Trinity Evangelical Divinity School (TEDS)	tiu.edu/divinity	Alumnus (PhD, Intercultural Studies); former faculty	year UNKNOWN	Dissertation-era work on contemporary Druidry. Endorser Harold Netland is TEDS faculty — shared milieu.
17	Columbia International University	ciu.edu	Alumnus (MA, Missions)	—	A.k.a. Columbia Biblical Seminary & School of Missions.
18	Texas A&M University	tamu.edu	Alumnus (BED, Environmental Design)	—	Undergraduate; unusual non-theological starting point.
19	International NGO (unnamed)	—	Former President / CEO	UNKNOWN	~6 years in international development per bio; org name UNKNOWN.

Org-level observations

1. **Vertically-integrated own-seminary model.** Cooper's distinctive structure is that he owns the framework (Ephesiology), the content (227-episode podcast, books via his own imprints), the pedagogy (Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch), AND a credentialing path (certificate credits ladder into accredited Kairos University degrees, plus the

Mission India MA he directs). Very few movement-targeted leaders own the full stack from neologism to accredited degree. This is the single most important structural fact about him.

2. **Evangelical / EFCA-adjacent center of gravity.** His institutional orbit is conservative-evangelical, free-church missiology: TEDS, EMS, William Carey Publishing, Missio Nexus, East-West. Endorser density on the EFCA side is high (Rick Burke / ReachGlobal-EFCA, Kerry Doyal / EFCA district superintendent). He is not in mainline, Anglican, or SBC structures.
3. **Global South spread is real, not decorative.** Active teaching/degree nodes in India (Nagpur), Nepal, and South Korea (Seoul), plus a decade church-planting in Romania and equipping work across Africa, Europe, the Americas, South and Southeast Asia. The Mission India MA is the degree-bearing expression of the framework — the Global South is where Ephesiology is actually being institutionalized, not just the US.
4. **East-West is the financial substrate, not the brand.** The ~\$33M East-West Ministries International budget and ~50-country footprint give Cooper a donor/missionary base far larger than his personal platform metrics (122 X followers, ~174 Instagram, 12 Apple podcast ratings) would suggest. His personal reach is niche; his institutional reach is large. Movemental should not mistake small social numbers for small influence.
5. **TELOS. is the legal/operational entity behind "Ephesiology."** The public-facing "Ephesiology" brand and the legal 501(c)(3) "TELOS." (TELOS.Go) are the same vehicle. All monetized surfaces (Master Classes storefront, certificates at \$35–250/mo, Kairos degrees at \$300–600/mo) run through it. Enrollment numbers UNKNOWN.
6. **Whether an "Ephesiology Coaching Network" exists is UNVERIFIED.** Only the Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch program and the Mission India MA are confirmed institutional structures. Do not assert a coaching network as a named entity.

Audience & Reach

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/analysis/audience-analysis.md

Audience Analysis: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-audience-analysis

Primary audience segments

1. Missionaries and church-planting practitioners — CPM-skeptical but movement-invested (core audience)

Who: field missionaries and church-planting practitioners who are invested in movements but wary of the CPM/DMM/T4T "industry" — its metrics, its jargon, its method-first posture.

Size estimate: UNKNOWN as a discrete number; reached substantially through East-West's missionary base (~50 countries / 10 regions) and the broader Missio Nexus / EMS practitioner world (tens of thousands of evangelical mission practitioners in aggregate; Cooper's engaged subset is far smaller).

Where they find him: The Ephesiology Podcast; Ephesiology (William Carey bestseller); Missio Nexus; the Motus Dei CPM scholar-practitioner network (Warrick Farah engages him).

Why they engage: he gives them a theologically serious, exegetically grounded account of movement dynamics without the technique-driven vocabulary they distrust — "disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy."

What they want more of: the biblical/archaeological grounding for movement claims; a non-pragmatic theology of multiplication; coaching that is not CPM-by-another-name.

2. Seminarians and degree-seekers (pipeline audience)

Who: students entering accredited, ministry-embedded degree programs — funneled through Kairos University, Mission India Theological Seminary (Nagpur), Knox Theological Seminary, and Nepal Ebenezer Bible College, often via non-residential cohorts.

Size estimate: UNKNOWN; Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch enrollment numbers are not catalogued. The four certificate tracks ladder into five Kairos degrees, so the addressable pool is the cohort population of these partner institutions.

Where they find him: the Ephesiology Master Classes LMS (masterclasses.ephesiology.com); Kairos University; Mission India; Seminary@YourChurch cohorts hosted in local churches.

Why they engage: Cooper is the program director of an MA in Missiology of Movements and an affiliate professor; his courses are the on-ramp to accredited credentials. Netland (TEDS)

expects Ephesiology to be "used as a text in Bible colleges."

What they want more of: structured ladder curriculum, oral-culture pedagogy (he teaches Teaching in Oral Cultures), and credentialed pathways.

3. Academics and missiologists (peer / validation audience)

Who: missiologists, intercultural-studies faculty, and NT-mission scholars in the evangelical academy.

Size estimate: small, high-signal; the EMS / Missiology / Global Missiology readership.

Where they find him: the EMS volumes; Missiology and Global Missiology book reviews (Priebe 2021 positive; Keene); Academia.edu (sfseminary.academia.edu); guest lectures at LSE, Bordeaux, Loyola, Baylor.

Why they engage: Ephesiology is treated as a serious contribution (2020 Catalyst Reader's Choice Award for best Missiology book); the 2026 Asia Minor archaeology volume raises his scholarly footprint.

What they want more of: peer-reviewed grounding, the archaeological evidence base, and engagement with the Roland Allen lineage that endorses (Newell, Stamoolis) repeatedly invoke.

4. EFCA-leaning free-church evangelical pastors (values-aligned audience)

Who: free-church, conservative-evangelical pastors — with a notably heavy EFCA presence among his endorsers (Rick Burke, ReachGlobal-EFCA; Kerry Doyal, EFCA district superintendent).

Size estimate: UNKNOWN; reached through endorser networks and church-hosted Seminary@YourChurch cohorts.

Where they find him: endorser word-of-mouth; ReachGlobal/EFCA equipping channels; church-hosted Master Classes.

Why they engage: he offers a movement theology compatible with free-church polity and a high view of disciple-formation, without progressive or charismatic edges.

What they want more of: church-deployable curriculum (Seminary@YourChurch is built precisely for this) and leadership material grounded in the Apostolic Fathers.

5. Global South students and church planters (geographic-reach audience)

Who: students and planters in India, Nepal, South Korea, Romania, Africa, and South/Southeast Asia.

Size estimate: UNKNOWN; substantial institutional reach via Mission India (Nagpur), Asia Graduate School of Theology Nepal, Torch Trinity (Seoul), and Cooper's decade of Romanian church planting.

Where they find him: Mission India MA in Missiology of Movements; partner seminaries;

oral-culture teaching modules.

Why they engage: contextualization is a core theme; he has equipped planters across five continents and teaches explicitly for oral cultures.

What they want more of: translated and oral-format material (none catalogued yet — see gap-analysis.md).

Audience quality signal: the people who platform him

Who chooses to platform Cooper is diagnostic:

- **Alan Hirsch** — lead endorser of Ephesiology (HIGH significance for Movemental: direct single-hop to the anchor of the movemental ecosystem).
- **Kurt Nelson** — President/CEO of East-West Ministries International (Cooper's own institutional head).
- **Harold A. Netland** — TEDS professor; academic validation from his doctoral milieu.
- **Marvin J. Newell** (Missio Nexus) and **James Stamoolis** — both explicitly liken Cooper to Roland Allen.
- **Nate Vander Stelt** — EVP, Global Alliance for Church Multiplication (GACX).
- **Warrick Farah** — leads the Motus Dei CPM scholar-practitioner network; reviewed Ephesiology favorably.
- **Brad Vaughn ("Jackson Wu")** — platformed Cooper's church-planting thesis on Patheos.
- Podcast hosts: **Markus Watson** (Spiritual Life and Leadership), **Joshua Johnson** (Shifting Culture), **John W. Morehead** (Multifaith Matters).

This is a **high-credibility evangelical-missiology peer set** — academy + agency + movement, not a mass-media set. It overlaps cleanly with Movemental's trusted-voice ecosystem, and the Hirsch endorsement is the most strategically load-bearing single signal.

East-West \$33M base as audience substrate

A distinctive feature of Cooper's reach is that his primary institutional anchor is not his own brand. **East-West Ministries International** (Plano TX; founded 1993; ECFA member since 1999; ~50 countries / 10 regions; FY2025 revenue ~\$32.97M, expenses ~\$30.47M) provides a large missionary and donor substrate that his work piggybacks. As missiologist-in-residence, Cooper's teaching reaches East-West's field force and supporter base — but **he does not own that audience relationship**; East-West does. The same is true of the Kairos and Mission India student funnels. This is the central audience fact of the dossier (see gap-analysis.md): large lent institutional reach, thin owned reach.

Audience size estimate (rough)

Surface	Estimate
X / Twitter @ephesiology	~122 followers (snippet; appears inactive)
Instagram @ephesiology	~174 followers / 204 posts (snippet)
Facebook "Ephesiology"	UNKNOWN (gated)
YouTube @ephesiology	UNKNOWN (gated)
Substack / newsletter	None (signup form on ephesiology.com only; no Substack)
Goodreads (author)	~40 ratings across 23 works; 0 followers
The Ephesiology Podcast	227 episodes; 4.8/5 (only 12 Apple ratings) — sustained but niche, not mass
Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch enrollment	UNKNOWN (not catalogued)
East-West missionary/donor substrate	Large (~\$33M org) but not owned by Cooper
Mission India / Kairos / Knox / Nepal student funnels	Institutional; not owned by Cooper

Aggregate owned (brand-account + list) reach: low hundreds — roughly 120-175 social followers across brand accounts, no email list of consequence.

Aggregate institutional reach (lent): large, via East-West, Kairos, Mission India.

The gap between institutional reach and owned reach is severe and inverse to a typical solo author: Cooper has prolific output and major institutional channels but almost no owned audience layer.

Implication for Movemental onboarding

- Movemental's job is **not to generate new content** for Cooper (he is one of the most prolific leaders in this research set) — it is to **consolidate and surface** a 17-title corpus that is currently undiscoverable.
- Movemental's job is to **convert lent institutional reach into an owned relationship layer** — a real newsletter, a discoverable corpus hub, and a single canonical bio — without competing with East-West, Kairos, or his own TELOS./Master Classes LMS.
- The 227-episode podcast and the William Carey bestseller are proof of sustained engagement; the missing layer is the owned audience that should have accrued from them and did not.

Websites

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/digital-presence/websites.md

Web Properties: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (with login-gated retail metrics flagged UNKNOWN)

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-web-presence

Cooper's web presence is the inverse of a thin-content practitioner's. He owns a real branded hub (ephesiology.com), runs a full learning-management storefront (masterclasses.ephesiology.com), publishes a hosted column, maintains academic and retail author profiles, and is carried across multiple publisher catalogs. The issue is not absence of an owned home — it is **dispersion**: the output is spread across many imprints, two brand domains, a hosted blog, and several profile sites, with a thin owned-audience layer underneath (see digital-presence/platforms.md).

Primary Website

Field	Value
Domain	ephesiology.com
Brand	TELOS. (the ministry brand the site is organized under)
Tagline	"Imaginatively Missional"
Platform	UNKNOWN (CMS not fingerprinted)
Status	Active
Has Blog	Yes — "Until They All Hear" / TELOS. blog (author handle untiltheyallheareblog)
Has Newsletter Signup	Yes — signup form present (ESP UNKNOWN); see digital-presence/newsletters.md
Has Store / Courses	Yes — courses + degrees via the separate LMS subdomain masterclasses.ephesiology.com
Has Donation / Partnership	Yes — donation / partnership links (TELOS. is a 501(c)(3))
Key Pages / Nav	Home · Master Classes · Ephesiology (the book) · Seminary@YourChurch · Library · Podcast · Blog

Site structure

ephesiology.com is a genuine **content + commerce hub**, not a link-in-bio page. It surfaces:

- The **TELOS**. identity and three pillars (plant churches, care for the marginalized, defend the faith) — ephesiology.com/welcome-to-telos
- A dedicated **book page** for Ephesiology with endorsements — ephesiology.com/ephesiology-the-book
- A **Library** cataloging the full ~17-title bibliography — ephesiology.com/library-2
- The **podcast**, organized into thematic series ("Christ: The Foundation of Mission and Church," "Reimagining our Ecclesiology," "Faith and Politics")
- **Seminary@YourChurch / Master Classes** entry points into the LMS
- Newsletter signup + donation/partnership calls

Assessment: a real home with real content — the opposite of the link-in-bio problem. Its weakness is that it is one of several surfaces (LMS subdomain, Patheos column, Academia, retail pages) rather than a single consolidating front door, and its owned-audience capture (newsletter, social) is thin relative to the content depth.

Learning-Management Storefront

Field	Value
Domain	masterclasses.ephesiology.com
Role	LMS storefront for Ephesiology Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch
Status	Active
Partner	Kairos University (ATS + HLC accredited; formerly Sioux Falls Seminary)

Courses listed

Foundations for a Missiology of Movements (free with coupon) · Teaching in Oral Cultures · Missiological Theology · Movemental Ecclesiology · Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement · Areopagus Symposium · mxAcademy · Essentials of the Faith.

Kairos degree + certificate pricing (subscription)

Tier	Programs	Price
Degrees	PhD · DMin · MA · MDiv · BA	\$300-600 / mo
Certificates	Church Planting · Movement Studies · Leadership · Ministry · New Testament	\$35-250 / mo

Seminary@YourChurch is cohort-based, set in local churches, delivered three ways (on-site professors / live web-stream / online async). Four certificate tracks ladder into five Kairos degrees. Enrollment numbers UNKNOWN. Source: masterclasses.ephesiology.com/pages/seminary-yourchurch.

Content Contributor / Hosted Platforms (publishes ON, does not fully own)

Platform	URL	Role	Notes
Patheos blog "Ephesiology"	patheos.com/blogs/ephesiology	Hosted columnist	Slug is misspelled (ephesiology) — an SEO/discoverability liability
Patheos — "Jackson Wu" (Brad Vaughn) blog	patheos.com/blogs/jacksonwu	Guest argument	Source of his most-quoted lines
Missio Nexus	missionexus.org/ai-ephesiology-cooper	Interview subject	—
Kairos University news	kairos.edu/2022/06/06/partnership-spotlight-ephesiology	Feature subject	Institutional

Academic Profiles

Platform	URL	Status
Academia.edu	sfseminary.academia.edu/MichaelCooper	Active — under Sioux Falls Seminary (now Kairos); confirmed same subject . Ephesiology PDF at academia.edu/49682326 returned 403
Google Scholar	—	Not located — citation count UNKNOWN
ORCID	—	Not located
ResearchGate	—	"M Cooper" match unconfirmed

Assessment: he has a real Academia.edu footprint but no verified Google Scholar / ORCID, so his peer-reviewed record (Missiology, Nova Religio, Pomegranate, JEMS, Global Missiology) is under-indexed and hard to cite. See [media/citations.md](#).

Publisher & Retail Presence

Platform	URL	Notes
William Carey Publishing	missionbooks.org/products/ephesiology	Flagship publisher; Ephesiology + EMS 13
Wipf & Stock	wipfandstock.com	2026 archaeology volume + visual companion
Sacred Roots / Samuel Morris	—	First Christian Voices (2023)
Sacred Tribes Press	—	Contemporary Druidry (2010)
Self / Ephesiology imprints	—	"Defense of the Faith from Ephesiology," "Social Justice from Ephesiology" — multiple self-published titles
Goodreads (author)	goodreads.com/author/show/4041664	23 works, avg 4.15, ~40 ratings, 0 followers
Amazon Author Central	B003PPPO26 (author ID)	Gated — metrics UNKNOWN
Smashwords	smashwords.com/profile/view/michaeltcooper	Self-publishing profile

Domain Authority Summary

- **Owned domains:** ephesiology.com (content + TELOS. brand) and masterclasses.ephesiology.com (LMS + Kairos commerce) — both active, both substantive. This is a genuine two-domain owned estate, not a placeholder.
- **Institutional backing:** East-West Ministries International, Kairos University, Mission India Theological Seminary, and William Carey Publishing all provide strong contextual SEO and credibility.
- **Published works:** deep — ~17+ titles across 6+ imprints (a citation/SEO asset, but fragmented across many publisher domains).
- **Core SEO weaknesses:** (1) the misspelled Patheos slug [ephesiolog](https://ephesiolog.com); (2) no verified Google Scholar/ORCID to index the journal record; (3) the body of work is scattered across many self-imprints and brand pages rather than consolidated.
- **Core SEO opportunity:** ephesiology.com is already the natural consolidator. The move is to pull the Patheos column, the journal record, the interviews, and the full bibliography into one authoritative on-domain hub, and to build the owned-audience layer (newsletter, social) up to match the content depth — the opposite of the "build a hub" problem, this is a "concentrate what already exists" problem.

Publishing Platforms

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/digital-presence/platforms.md

Platforms Publishing Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-web-presence

The dispersion inventory

Cooper's body of work lives across **a wide spread of publishing imprints, brand domains, profile sites, and distribution channels**. Crucially, his problem is **not too little content** (the failure mode of a thin-surface practitioner) — it is **dispersion**: high output scattered across many self-publishing imprints + brand sites + podcast platforms, sitting on top of a thin owned-audience layer (~120–175 social followers, 12 podcast ratings) despite ~17 books and 227 podcast episodes. The audience effect is sub-additive because no single surface concentrates either the catalog or the audience.

Platform	Role	Cooper content	URL
William Carey Publishing	Trade publisher	Ephesiology (2020, flagship); Contextualization and Syncretism (EMS 13, 2022)	missionbooks.org/products/ephesiology
Wipf & Stock	Academic publisher	Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement (2026) + Photographing the Movement of God companion (2026)	wipfandstock.com
Sacred Roots / Samuel Morris	Publisher	First Christian Voices (2023)	us.amazon.com/dp/1955424152
Sacred Tribes Press	NRM-niche publisher	Contemporary Druidry (2010)	goodreads.com/book/show/20889146
Self / Ephesiology imprints	Self-publishing	"Defense of the Faith from Ephesiology," "Social Justice from Ephesiology" — When Evangelicals Sneeze, Perspectives on Post-Christendom Spiritualities, Make Disciples, A Faithful Witness, Letters to Churches, Social Injustice I & II, The Peaceable Christian, Unwrapping the First Christmas, Crises and the Church	ephesiology.com/library-2
Patheos	Hosted blog	"Ephesiology" column (misspelled slug / blogs/ephesilogy/) + "Jackson Wu" guest engagement	patheos.com/blogs/ephesilogy
Academia.edu	Academic profile	Papers under Sioux Falls Seminary (now Kairos)	sfseminary.academia.edu/MichaelCooper
Apple Podcasts	Podcast distribution	The Ephesiology Podcast — 227 eps, 4.8★ (12 ratings)	id1457124552
Spotify			open.spotify.com

Platform	Role	Cooper content	URL
	Podcast distribution	The Ephesiology Podcast (mirror)	
YouTube	Podcast + course video	@ephesiology — podcast video + Master Class material	youtube.com/@ephesiology
masterclasses.ephesiology.com	LMS storefront	8+ courses; Kairos degrees (\$300-600/mo) + certificates (\$35-250/mo)	masterclasses.ephesiology.com/pages/seminary-yourchurch
ephesiology.com	Owned hub (TELOS brand)	Book page, Library, podcast series, blog, newsletter	ephesiology.com
Evangelical Missiological Society (EMS)	Society / journal	EMS 13 contribution; JEMS essays; book listed under EMS publications	emsweb.org
Missio Nexus	Missions association	Author interview + endorsement (Newell)	missionexus.org/ai-ephesiology-cooper
Journals	Peer-reviewed	Missiology, Nova Religio, Pomegranate, JEMS, Global Missiology	See media/citations.md
Goodreads / Amazon / Smashwords	Retail / catalog	Author pages across all three (Amazon Author Central B003PPPO26, gated)	goodreads.com/author/show/4041664

Digital presence score (0-5)

Dimension	Score	Notes
Owned hub	4 / 5	ephesiology.com is a genuine content + commerce hub under the TELOS. brand — far beyond a link-in-bio.
Content volume on owned surface	3.5 / 5	Book page, Library, podcast series, and blog all live on-domain — but the catalog is also scattered across many off-domain imprints.
Newsletter infrastructure	2 / 5	Signup form exists; ESP, cadence, archive, and subscriber count all UNKNOWN. See newsletters.md .
Social activity	1.5 / 5	Brand accounts only; ~120-175 followers; X appears inactive; no personal creator presence.
Podcast footprint (hosted)	4 / 5	227 episodes, weekly since 2019 — a serious owned show; but only 12 Apple ratings (thin engaged audience).
Podcast (guest)	2.5 / 5	Several guest spots (Spiritual Life & Leadership, Shifting Culture, Multifaith Matters).
Video (owned)	2 / 5	YouTube channel exists but is a podcast/course mirror, not an independent video audience.
Books / long-form	5 / 5	~17+ titles across 6+ imprints, 2010-2026 — the standout strength.
Courses owned	4 / 5	Full LMS with accredited Kairos degree ladder — well beyond a single gated course.
Academic profile	2.5 / 5	Academia.edu present; no verified Google Scholar/ORCID, so the journal record is under-indexed.
Aggregator / retail presence	3.5 / 5	Goodreads, Amazon, Smashwords, publisher catalogs, EMS, Missio Nexus.
Overall digital presence score	3.1 / 5	Strong content + commerce + owned hub; weak owned-audience capture. The gap is concentration and audience, not content.

What this inventory means

Three things.

1. **His problem is dispersion, not absence.** The contrast with a thin-surface practitioner is total: Cooper has the hub, the LMS, the 227-episode podcast, the accredited degree ladder, and ~17 books. But those assets are spread across **6+ publisher imprints, two brand domains, a misspelled-slug hosted blog, three retail profiles, and several podcast platforms** — so no single surface carries the whole catalog or the whole audience. Onboarding consolidates; it does not have to build from zero.

2. **The owned-audience layer is thin relative to the output.** ~17 books + 227 episodes have produced roughly **120-175 brand-social followers, 12 podcast ratings, 23 Goodreads ratings, and 0 Goodreads followers.** That is the asymmetry to name: enormous content production, minimal owned distribution. The bottleneck is audience capture (email + social + a personal creator identity), not content creation.
3. **The framework is ownable but not yet diffused.** "Ephesiology" is a category of one — Cooper coined it and uniquely holds the Ephesus/Acts 19 movement-theology niche — and it is vertically integrated (own seminary → Kairos degrees → 227-ep podcast → East-West donor anchor). That vertical integration is rare and valuable; the unrealized leverage is turning a deep-but-scattered estate into a concentrated, audience-capturing platform.

Newsletters

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/digital-presence/newsletters.md

Newsletters: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (infrastructure largely UNKNOWN)

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-web-presence

Current State

Field	Value
Newsletter signup exists?	Yes — a signup form is present on <code>ephesiology.com</code>
Platform / ESP	UNKNOWN — no email service provider was fingerprinted (Mailchimp / ConvertKit / Beehiiv / Substack / Ghost all unconfirmed)
Substack	None found under his name or the Ephesiology/TELOS. brand
Linked from	<code>ephesiology.com</code>
Archive	None discoverable — no public back-issues surfaced
Cadence	UNKNOWN / none stated
Lead magnet	UNKNOWN — none surfaced (though Foundations for a Missiology of Movements is offered free-with-coupon on the LMS and could function as one)
Estimated subscribers	UNKNOWN

Assessment

This is the **weakest-instrumented dimension of an otherwise content-rich estate**, and that contrast is the point. Cooper is not a leader who lacks content to mail — he has ~17 books, a 227-episode podcast, a blog, and a full course catalog. What is missing is the **owned-audience capture layer** that would convert that output into a list he controls.

- **A signup form with no visible ESP** means there is no confirmed deliverability infrastructure, segmentation, or open-rate feedback — only a form.
- **No discoverable archive** means no public proof of cadence, no SEO benefit, and no portfolio effect from past issues.

- **No Substack** means he is not capturing any of the owned-newsletter network effects that peers in the missional/movement space increasingly rely on.
- **No surfaced lead magnet** means the form has weak incentive to complete — even though the free LMS course is a ready-made magnet sitting one subdomain away.

This is the same root condition described across the digital-presence files: **dispersion + a thin owned-audience layer**. The newsletter is precisely where that thin layer is most fixable, because the content to populate it already exists in abundance.

Related infrastructure (adjacent lists he could draw on)

Cooper sits inside several institutions with their own audiences and likely lists:

- **East-West Ministries International** (Plano TX; ~\$33M/yr; ECFA member) — a large missionary/donor base his reach already piggybacks.
- **Kairos University** — degree-partner audience funneled through Seminary@YourChurch.
- **Mission India Theological Seminary** — the MA in Missiology of Movements cohort.
- **The Ephesiology Podcast** listener base (227 episodes; size UNKNOWN).

None of these is confirmed to feed a Cooper-owned email list, and whether TELOS./Ephesiology runs a partner newsletter on top of the signup form is **UNKNOWN — needs research**.

Recommended future state (for onboarding)

1. **Stand up a real ESP** (Beehiiv / Substack / Ghost / Movemental-native) behind the existing ephesiology.com form — give the signup a destination with deliverability, segmentation, and a public archive.
2. **Wire the free LMS course as the lead magnet** — Foundations for a Missiology of Movements (already free-with-coupon) is the obvious incentive; gate it behind the signup.
3. **Seed from existing assets** — podcast listeners, Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch cohorts, the East-West and Mission India orbits, and the Patheos/Missio Nexus reader base.
4. **Set a sustainable cadence** — biweekly or monthly, repurposing podcast episodes, blog posts, and "10-Minute Ephesiologist" segments into short written issues. The content already exists; the work is packaging, not authoring.
5. **Confirm and consolidate** — verify whether a TELOS./East-West/Kairos list already exists and whether Cooper can contribute a recurring column, so list-building is additive rather than duplicative.

Social Media

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/digital-presence/social-media.md

Social Media: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete, with all follower counts flagged approximate / login-gated UNKNOWN

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-web-presence

Cooper's social presence follows a **brand-account-over-personal pattern**: his public-facing accounts run through the **@ephesiology** brand handle rather than a personal "Michael Cooper" identity. The counts that surfaced are strikingly small — roughly **120-175 followers** on the brand accounts — against a body of work that includes ~17 books and a 227-episode podcast. That asymmetry (deep content, thin owned audience) is the defining feature of his digital footprint. **Every count below is approximate and needs live verification.**

Account Summary

Platform	Handle	Followers	Cadence	Last Active	Status
X / Twitter	@ephesiology	~ 122 (approximate; from SERP snippet)	Low	UNKNOWN	Appears inactive
Instagram	@ephesiology	~ 174 (39 following · 204 posts — approximate; from SERP snippet)	UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN	Active — most-developed brand account
Facebook	Ephesiology (page)	UNKNOWN (gated)	UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN	Active — count not surfaced
YouTube	@ephesiology ("Ephesiology: Podcast and Master Classes")	UNKNOWN (gated)	Tied to podcast cadence	Recent (podcast video)	Active — hosts podcast video
LinkedIn	—	—	—	—	None confirmed
TikTok	—	—	—	—	None confirmed
Threads	—	—	—	—	None confirmed
Bluesky / Mastodon	—	—	—	—	None confirmed

Platform Details

Instagram (most-developed brand account)

- **URL:** [instagram.com/ephesiology](https://www.instagram.com/ephesiology)
- **Approximate metrics (SERP snippet, unverified):** ~174 followers · 39 following · **204 posts**
- **Read:** the 204-post count signals real, sustained posting effort over time — yet the follower count has stayed in the low hundreds. This is the dispersion/thin-audience problem in microcosm: consistent output, minimal owned reach.
- **Status:** Active; the most plausible primary social surface.

X / Twitter

- **URL:** x.com/ephesiology
- **Approximate followers:** ~122 (SERP snippet, unverified)

- **Status:** Appears **inactive**. Low priority.

Facebook

- **Handle:** "Ephesiology" page — count **UNKNOWN** (login-gated).
- **Likely use:** book/podcast/event promotion. Not verified.

YouTube

- **URL:** youtube.com/@ephesiology
- **Channel name:** "Ephesiology: Podcast and Master Classes"
- **Subscribers / video count:** **UNKNOWN** (gated). The channel hosts the video version of The Ephesiology Podcast (e.g., Episode 205) and Master Class material.
- **Assessment:** video is downstream of the podcast; the channel is a distribution mirror, not an independent audience yet.

The Ephesiology Podcast (his strongest social-adjacent asset)

- **Apple Podcasts:** [id1457124552](https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/id1457124552) — **4.8★ (12 ratings), 227 episodes**, weekly, since 2019
- **Co-host:** **Andrew Johnson** (pastor, West Village Church, Victoria BC; DMin student at Kairos)
- **Distribution:** Apple, Spotify, YouTube, and the Master Classes page
- **Recurring segment:** "The 10-Minute Ephesiologist"; latest surfaced "Ep. 223 Let the Stones Speak," site shows "Ep. 220 The Disappearance of Christianity" (Apr 2, 2026)
- **Read:** 227 episodes is a serious, sustained body of work — but **only 12 Apple ratings**. The podcast is the clearest single instance of high output meeting a thin engaged-audience layer.

Unconfirmed / likely NOT him

The following personal-looking handles surfaced but could **not** be confirmed as this subject and should be treated as **not him** absent verification:

- X [@michaelcooper1](#)
- Instagram [christian.michael.cooper](#)
- YouTube youtube.com/user/MichaelxCooper

Cooper's verified public presence runs through the **@ephesiology brand accounts**, not a personal identity. ("Michael Cooper" also collides with the NBA Hall-of-Famer and an IMDb actor — see the substrate's Disambiguation section.)

Follower-count verification notes

The audit ran **no authenticated scrapes**. The ~122 (X) and ~174 (Instagram) figures come from search-result snippets and may be stale or imprecise. Facebook and YouTube counts are genuinely **UNKNOWN** behind login walls. Treat all numbers as **approximate and pending live verification** — but note that even generous re-counts are unlikely to move him out of the low-hundreds band, which is the strategically relevant fact.

Voice across platforms

The presence is **brand-voiced, not person-voiced**: everything routes through "Ephesiology / TELOS." rather than "Michael T. Cooper." This has a trade-off. Upside: the framework gets the equity, and the brand can outlive any single platform. Downside: there is **no personal-creator account** accumulating a following, which is part of why the owned audience is thin despite the output. For onboarding, the question is whether to build a personal Cooper presence to sit alongside the brand, or to double down on @ephesiology as the single channel — see [digital-presence/platforms.md](#) and [digital-presence/newsletters.md](#).

The Fragmentation Story

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/fragmentation-story.md

Michael T. Cooper: The Fragmentation Story

Generated 2026-05-29 from the structured dossier at docs/movement_leader_research/michael-cooper/. Follows the fragmentation-story skill pattern.

The Story

Michael T. Cooper has spent **more than thirty years in missions** and built, almost single-handedly, a named field of study. He holds a **PhD in Intercultural Studies** from Trinity Evangelical Divinity School, planted churches for roughly **ten years in post-communist Romania**, directed the **School of Biblical and Religious Studies at Trinity International University** for about a decade, and has lectured at the London School of Economics, the University of Bordeaux, Loyola, and Baylor. In 2020 his book Ephesiology: A Study of the Ephesian Movement (William Carey Publishing) won the **Catalyst Services Reader's Choice Award** for the best book in missiology and gave the discipline a new word. He has since authored, co-authored, or edited **roughly seventeen titles**, hosts a **227-episode weekly podcast**, runs a cohort-based seminary program (**Ephesiology Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch**) in partnership with the accredited **Kairos University**, directs the **MA in Missiology of Movements** at Mission India Theological Seminary, and serves as **missiologist-in-residence at East West Ministries**, an agency working some fifty countries.

That is, by any measure, a prolific body of work. And that is exactly what makes Cooper's fragmentation different from the typical movement leader's. The usual story is a practitioner with deep influence and almost no published record. Cooper's is the inverse: **an enormous, coherent output that is scattered across so many imprints, platforms, and brand identities that almost none of its accumulated weight lands in any one place a stranger can find — and almost none of it converts into an audience he owns.**

Consider the asymmetry. Seventeen-plus books — but they are spread across at least six publishing channels: William Carey Publishing (Ephesiology), Wipf & Stock (the 2026 Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement), Sacred Roots / Samuel Morris (First Christian Voices), Sacred Tribes Press (Contemporary Druidry), and two self-managed imprints ("Defense of the Faith from Ephesiology" and "Social Justice from Ephesiology") under which much of the recent catalogue sits. Twenty-three works are listed on his Goodreads author page — carrying, in total, about **forty ratings**. A 227-episode podcast with a 4.8-star rating — from **twelve** raters. Brand social accounts (@ephesiology on X, Instagram, Facebook,

YouTube) whose follower counts, where visible at all, sit in the low **hundreds**. A genuinely significant peer review in Missiology, the flagship journal of the Evangelical Missiological Society — and no unified place that gathers it alongside the book it reviews. The man has built a category of one ("Ephesiology"), and the category's own evidence is dispersed to the point of near-invisibility.

In short: Michael Cooper has produced one of the most complete corpora of any movement leader in this research set — a flagship framework, seventeen books, a weekly podcast, a seminary, journal articles, two hosted blogs, a recurring scholarly symposium — and **the discoverability and owned-audience value of that corpus is a fraction of what its volume should command**. The asymmetry is not between embodied influence and digital expression (as with most leaders); it is between output and consolidation.

Informational Fragmentation

Books

~**17-18 catalogued titles** (Goodreads lists 23 works) across **six+ publishing channels**: William Carey Publishing, Wipf & Stock, Sacred Roots/Samuel Morris, Sacred Tribes Press, and the self-managed "Defense of the Faith from Ephesiology" / "Social Justice from Ephesiology" imprints. The flagship Ephesiology (2020, ISBN 9781645082767) is the anchor; the 2026 Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement (Wipf & Stock) plus its visual companion Photographing the Movement of God extend the project into archaeology. Several self-published titles have **no discoverable ISBN-13** and live only as Amazon ASINs. **No audiobook** of Ephesiology (or, as far as the audit found, any title) was located. See [content/books.md](#).

Academic Work

PhD in Intercultural Studies (TEDS); MA in Missions (Columbia International University); BED (Texas A&M). Peer-reviewed articles in Missiology, Nova Religio, Pomegranate, Journal of the Evangelical Missiological Society, Global Missiology. **No Google Scholar profile, ORCID, or verified ResearchGate** surfaced; citation counts are **UNKNOWN**. His exact PhD year and dissertation title are **UNKNOWN** (the dissertation-era subject was contemporary Druidry). See [content/academic.md](#).

Articles & Blogs

Two owned blogs running in parallel: the **Patheos "Ephesiology" column** (at the misspelled slug [/blogs/ephesiology/](#)) and the **ephesiology.com "Until They All Hear" blog** ([untiltheyallhearblog](#)). His sharpest popular thesis statement — "making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result" — sits in a **guest post on someone else's Patheos blog** (Brad Vaughn / "Jackson Wu"), not on a surface he controls. See [content/articles.md](#).

Podcast

The Ephesiology Podcast — 227 episodes, weekly since 2019, 4.8★ from 12 Apple ratings, co-hosted with Andrew Johnson; distributed across Apple (id1457124552), Spotify, and YouTube, plus a course-style page on the Master Classes LMS. Recurring segment: "The 10-Minute Ephesiologist." He has also guested on Spiritual Life and Leadership (Markus Watson), Shifting Culture (Joshua Johnson), and Multifaith Matters (John W. Morehead). This is a **strong hosted presence** — the opposite of a guest-only leader — but the listenership is not captured into any owned list. See [content/audio.md](#).

Courses & Seminary

Ephesiology Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch — cohort-based theological education embedded in local churches, delivered three ways (on-site, live web-stream, async), partnered with **Kairos University** (ATS + HLC accredited). Four certificate tracks ladder into five Kairos degrees. He also directs the **MA in Missiology of Movements** at Mission India Theological Seminary and hosts a recurring **Areopagus Symposium**. The LMS ([masterclasses.ephesiology.com](#)) carries a deep course catalogue. See [content/courses.md](#).

Websites

- **ephesiology.com** — the hub, branded "TELOS." (tagline "Imaginatively Missional"); nav: Home / Master Classes / Ephesiology (book) / Seminary@YourChurch / Library / Podcast / Blog.
- **masterclasses.ephesiology.com** — the LMS storefront and Kairos degree gateway.
- **patheos.com/blogs/ephesilogy/** — hosted column (misspelled slug, a small but real SEO leak).
- **Academia.edu** (under "Sioux Falls Seminary," now Kairos), **Smashwords**, **Amazon Author Central** (B003PPPO26).

Three brand identities — "Ephesiology," "TELOS.," and his personal name — compete for the same SEO oxygen. See [digital-presence/websites.md](#).

Social Media

Platform	Handle	Status	Followers
X / Twitter	@ephesiology	Active (appears dormant)	~122 (snippet; needs live check)
Instagram	@ephesiology	Active	~174 / 204 posts (snippet)
Facebook	Ephesiology	Active	UNKNOWN (gated)
YouTube	@ephesiology	Active	UNKNOWN (gated)
LinkedIn / TikTok / Threads	—	Not confirmed	—

Public presence runs through **brand accounts**, not a personal one; the few visible follower counts are in the low hundreds despite a 17-title, 227-episode body of work. See digital-presence/social-media.md.

Relational Fragmentation

Cooper's **institutional reach is large and his owned relational layer is thin**. His audiences are gathered by institutions, not by him:

- The **East West Ministries** donor and missionary base (an agency with ~\$33M annual revenue working ~50 countries) is a vast potential audience — owned by East West.
- The **Ephesiology Master Classes / Kairos** enrollees are on Kairos and TELOS infrastructure.
- The **Mission India** MA students belong to that seminary.
- The **227-episode podcast** audience lives on Apple and Spotify feeds.
- The peer reviewers, conference audiences (LSE, Bordeaux, Loyola, Baylor), and the **Evangelical Missiological Society / Missio Nexus** networks know his work — but none of that recognition flows into a list Cooper can email.

Even his most valuable credential — being positioned by Alan Hirsch, Marvin Newell, and James Stamoolis as a contemporary heir to **Roland Allen** — is an endorsement-jacket fact, not an owned-audience asset.

Why consolidation matters

Cooper is not content-poor — he is a content-rich scholar-practitioner whose work needs **consolidating, interconnecting, and converting**. The corpus is dispersed across six imprints, three brand identities, two blogs, an LMS, a podcast, and a seminary partnership. He owns a category of one ("Ephesiology"), but the evidence for that category is scattered enough that the word often out-travels the person.

This is an inventory of a large, coherent corpus that has never been fully unified in one discoverable hub.

A Letter — Reflected Understanding

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/reflected-understanding/michael-cooper.md

Michael T. Cooper: Reflected Understanding

A concise reflection spoken back so the language could be endorsed — familiar, but with edges that deepen. (Leader-safe: audience-sizing and commerce analysis are kept in staff notes, not here.)

Calling

You're called to **theologize movement itself** — to put mission back at the center of theology rather than off to the side as one applied chapter. Where most of the movement field works in the register of method and metrics, you work in the register of theology and text: you read the Bible as "a missiological theology," you treat the first-century Ephesian church-planting movement as a discrete and weighty object of study, and you coined a name for that study — **Ephesiology** — and then fenced it as a discipline. That is a scholar's instinct and a planter's stake at once. You didn't arrive at the theory from a desk; you pioneered church planting for roughly a decade in post-communist Romania and then went and got the doctorate to explain what you had lived. The questions a new-religious-movements ethnographer asks of a living movement — how did it start, what did its people believe, who led it, how did it multiply, why did some fracture — are exactly the questions you turn on the Ephesian movement, and now on the excavated record of Asia Minor beneath it.

Your most-repeated correction carries the whole calling: "**making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result.**" Church planting is nowhere commanded; disciple-multiplication is. "Disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy." That is not an attack on church planters — it's a recentering, a constructive correction offered from inside the conversation rather than against it. You coin categories (Ephesiology, missiological theology, Christoform leadership), you invert received assumptions to recenter rather than to demolish, and you ground every framework in a theocentric frame — "a missiologically theocentric passion to declare the glory of God to the nations." You stay tethered to the New Testament text, to the Apostolic Fathers, and increasingly to the material culture of the Roman East, refusing to let missiology become technique divorced from theology.

Existing Content (before the platform we're building)

Where it lives. Your content lives in **books** — roughly seventeen catalogued works, with Ephesiology (William Carey, 2020) as the award-winning flagship and a long tail running through Make Disciples, Letters to Churches, First Christian Voices, Lead Like Paul, and the

2026 Asia Minor archaeology volume and its visual companion. It lives in the **227-episode Ephesiology Podcast** (since 2019, weekly, co-hosted with Andrew Johnson, distributed across Apple, Spotify, and YouTube). It lives in an **accredited educational pipeline** — the TELOS. / Ephesiology Master Classes and Seminary@YourChurch, the MA in Missiology of Movements at Mission India Theological Seminary, and your affiliate teaching at Kairos University. And it lives across **institutional roles** — missiologist-in-residence at East-West Ministries, EMS and Missio Nexus contributions, and guest lectures at LSE, Bordeaux, Loyola, and Baylor.

Credibility. It's high and academically earned. Ephesiology won the 2020 Catalyst Services Reader's Choice Award for best book in Missiology and carries a serious endorser slate — including Alan Hirsch — situating your work beside The Forgotten Ways in the broader movement conversation. You write as a scholar-practitioner: from the biblical text, from first-century history and the archaeological record, and from contemporary field data. The issue isn't authority. It's **dispersion and discovery**.

How it lives online now. As a **scattered body of work**. The seventeen books are split across at least six imprints — William Carey, Wipf & Stock, Sacred Roots, Sacred Tribes Press, and your own Ephesiology house lines — with no single discoverable hub. A reader who finds Ephesiology on Amazon has no easy path to Make Disciples or the archaeology volume. The podcast is mature and owned, but there's no canonical episode index on your own domain that a new listener can navigate. So a serious, vertically integrated, award-winning corpus doesn't **circulate** the way it should — it stays where each piece was first put.

The NOTs Movemental addresses directly. Your corpus is largely **not** consolidated into one canonical home where the whole body of work is structured, linked, and findable; **not** re-indexed so the 227 episodes are searchable by theme; **not** connected to an AI that reflects your voice and reads your corpus; **not** optimized for discovery so searchers for "Ephesiology," "missiological theology," or "disciple-making movement" land on your material first; **not** interconnected so books, episodes, lectures, and frameworks visibly reference each other; and **not** captured into an owned relationship — the institutional reach you carry is largely lent, not owned. Movemental is built to speak to each of these — consolidation, re-indexing, an AI that serves your voice, discoverability, interconnection, and an owned layer — so your work can move.

Constraints

The defining constraint here is **not production** — you are among the most prolific voices in this conversation. The constraint is **time, attention, and dispersion**. You're carrying three simultaneous institutional roles, running an accredited cohort program, hosting a weekly podcast, and continuing to write and excavate, all at once. The hours to consolidate a six-imprint catalogue, recover metadata on the self-published tier, build a canonical episode

index, stand up a real owned-audience layer, or repurpose the back catalogue into short-form simply aren't there when the work itself is in the classroom, the field, and the manuscript. That's emblematic of a scholar-practitioner calling, not a personal failure.

Two more constraints shape every content decision. First, **register**: your voice is scholarly and theologically precise, and it should stay that way — the work loses its substance if it's flattened into trade-devotional content, and you've deliberately refused CPM/DMM operational jargon as a theological position, not an oversight. Second, **complement, never compete**: your accredited LMS and your institutional homes at East-West, Kairos, and Mission India are yours to keep; what's missing is the public-facing front door and the owned relationship layer above them, not a replacement for them. A platform that reduces the lift — that consolidates, surfaces, interconnects, and captures what you already do, while preserving your register and respecting your institutions — addresses these constraints without asking you to become a different kind of leader.

This document is a reflected understanding for Michael T. Cooper, intended to be right to the point, true, and valuable. It is preliminary until reviewed and endorsed.

Welcome Letter

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/welcome-letter.md`

Michael

You built a field. Not a book, not a podcast, not a course — a field. "Ephesiology" did not exist as a word until you defined it: the study of the first-century Ephesian movement as a missiological theology of the Bible, mission moved from the margins of the discipline to its center. Around that one idea you have assembled more than most scholars assemble in a career — the 2020 William Carey book that won the Catalyst Reader's Choice Award for best book in missiology, roughly seventeen titles since, a weekly podcast now past two hundred episodes, the Ephesiology Master Classes and Seminary@YourChurch running on Kairos University's accreditation, the MA in Missiology of Movements at Mission India, peer reviews in Missiology, and a missiologist-in-residence seat at East West. Alan Hirsch, Marvin Newell, and James Stamoolis all reach for the same comparison when they describe you: a contemporary Roland Allen, calling the church back to the foundations of how movements actually begin.

And here is the strange thing the research kept surfacing. All of that output, and almost none of its weight lands in one place. Your seventeen books are scattered across at least six channels — William Carey, Wipf & Stock, Sacred Roots, Sacred Tribes Press, and the two imprints you manage yourself. Twenty-three works on Goodreads carry, between them, about forty ratings. A 227-episode podcast rated 4.8 stars — by twelve people. Brand accounts on X, Instagram, Facebook, and YouTube whose follower counts, where they're visible at all, sit in the low hundreds. The sharpest single sentence you've written for a popular audience — "making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result" — lives in a guest post on someone else's blog. Three names compete for the same search results: your own, "Ephesiology," and "TELOS." The word you coined now travels farther than the man who coined it, and the evidence for the category you own is dispersed to the point where a newcomer cannot assemble it. This is not a content problem. You have more content than almost anyone in this research set. It is a consolidation problem, and a conversion problem: institutions gather your audiences — East West's donor base, Kairos's enrollees, Mission India's students, Apple's podcast feed — and none of those relationships flow back into a list you own.

The largest pool of value is also the least consolidated. Thirty years of field judgment — ten of them planting churches in post-communist Romania, the rest equipping planters across Africa, Europe, and South and Southeast Asia — sits distributed across lectures at the LSE and Bordeaux and Baylor, across two hundred podcast conversations, across course modules in the Master Classes LMS, across the Areopagus Symposium, and across the answers you give the same questions in every cohort. The argument of Ephesiology is in the book. The thousand refinements of that argument since 2020 — what you'd now say differently, the archaeological turn that became the 2026 Wipf & Stock volume, the way you teach a Global

South planter versus a skeptical American pastor — those are not anywhere a stranger can find them. The corpus is large; the connective tissue between its pieces, and the tacit reasoning underneath them, is missing.

This is where Movemental's AI does work that was not previously possible. The inventory above — books counted across imprints, episodes named, the Missiology review located, the dispersion across three brand identities mapped — was compiled by AI sitting with your public corpus for the length of a researcher's several weeks. The same approach now turns toward consolidation and toward what is not yet captured: unifying seventeen scattered titles into one discoverable, AI-legible corpus; turning the podcast back-catalogue into a searchable teaching archive; surfacing the reasoning behind your frameworks through interview and dictation that becomes draft. The AI does the inventorying and the connective tissue. It does not replace your scholarship or your voice — every draft is yours to edit, refuse, or rewrite. The authorship, and the doctrine, stay yours.

This is what the dashboard is built to do, and what we would do with you. First, aggregate. Pull the seventeen titles, the 227 episodes, the two blogs, the journal articles, the Master Classes catalogue, and the academic lectures into one searchable home under a single Ephesiology identity — resolving the "Ephesiology" / "TELOS." / personal-name split so the SEO oxygen stops being divided three ways. Second, interconnect. Trace the real chains through the corpus: Ephesiology points to Make Disciples points to the church-planting-is-a-result essay points to the podcast series on "Reimagining our Ecclesiology" points to the 2026 archaeology volume. Third, repurpose. The "10-Minute Ephesiologist" segments become a discoverable explainer library; the Master Classes become a public top-of-funnel; the Patheos column and the ephesiology.com blog merge into one canonical feed with a real newsletter behind it. Fourth, amplify. SEO and GEO built around the category you already own — so that when a planter or a seminarian searches "Ephesian movement" or "missiological theology," the word and the man arrive together. The work this season is not authorship. You have done the authorship. It is consolidation of what you have already written into a form the field can actually reach — and an owned audience that finally accrues to you rather than to the institutions that introduce you.

A year from now, there is one front door. A reader who has never heard of East West or Kairos finds the Ephesiology corpus gathered in one place, follows a thread from the flagship book into the podcast into a Master Class, and joins an email list that is yours. The category you invented becomes defensible because its evidence is finally in one room. The heir-to-Roland-Allen comparison stops being a blurb and becomes a discoverable, navigable body of work.

This is your next season. You have already built the field. The work ahead is making the field findable — so the movement theology you have spent thirty years writing reaches the planters, the seminarians, and the missiologists it was written for, on a morning when no institution is there to introduce them.

— Movemental

Committed Voice

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/_misc/committed-voice.md

slug: michael-cooper

display_name: Michael T. Cooper

role: Missiologist-in-Residence, East West Ministries · Creator of "Ephesiology"

location_line: United States

short_tagline: >-

Cooper is the evangelical missiologist who coined "Ephesiology" — the study of the first-century Ephesian movement as a model for contemporary movements — and built a seminary, a 227-episode podcast, and a 17-title corpus around the conviction that mission is the center of theology.

themes:

- Ephesiology & the Ephesian Movement
- Missiological Theology
- Church-Planting & Disciple-Making Movements

credentials:

- "Missiologist-in-Residence, East West Ministries International — research and practitioner equipping for an agency working ~50 countries"
- "Affiliate Professor, Kairos University — degree partner for the Ephesiology Master Classes"
- "Program Director, MA in Missiology of Movements, Mission India Theological Seminary (Nagpur)"
- "Founder/leader, TELOS. / Ephesiology — host of The Ephesiology Podcast (227+ episodes)"
- "PhD in Intercultural Studies, Trinity Evangelical Divinity School — focus on religious movements and early Christian history"
- "Former Director, School of Biblical and Religious Studies, Trinity International University; 10 years a pioneer church planter in post-communist Romania"

featured_works:

- "Ephesiology: A Study of the Ephesian Movement (William Carey Publishing, 2020) — 2020 Catalyst Reader's Choice Award, best book in Missiology"
- "Make Disciples: Discover the Spiritual Journey of a Christ-Follower (with Bill Couchenour, 2023)"
- "Letters to Churches: Christoform Leadership Lessons (2025)"
- "Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement (Wipf & Stock, 2026)"

primary_url: <https://ephesiology.com>

secondary_links:

- label: Ephesiology Master Classes
href: <https://masterclasses.ephesiology.com>
- label: East West Ministries
href: <https://www.eastwest.org>

- label: Kairos University faculty

href: <https://kairos.edu/faculty/michael-t-cooper/>

signature_frameworks:

- name: Ephesiology

definition: The study of the Ephesian movement (Acts 19, Ephesians, the Pastorals, Revelation 2-3) as a missiological theology of the Bible and a model for contemporary movements.

- name: Missiological Theology

definition: Mission treated as the center of theology rather than a subset of it; Paul and John read as missiological theologians who connected Jesus to the Ephesian context.

- name: Disciple-Making over Church-Planting

definition: Making disciples is the biblical mandate; church planting is a result, not a command — "disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy."

- name: Christoform Leadership

definition: Communal, theological, and missional leadership drawn from the Apostolic Fathers (1 Clement, Ignatius, Polycarp) for today's movement leaders.

- name: Lead Like Paul — Five C's

definition: Call, Character, Charismata, Confidence, Commitment — an empowering leadership model derived from the Apostle Paul.

lineage:

sources:

- Roland Allen

- Harold A. Netland

- Trinity Evangelical Divinity School

peers:

- John W. Morehead

- Gailyn Van Rheenen

- Gary Fujino

- Andrew Johnson

- alan-hirsch

- Eckhard Schnabel

- Steve Addison

downstream:

- Ephesiology Master Classes cohorts

- MA in Missiology of Movements students (Mission India)

- East West Ministries church planters

sources:

- README.md

- profile/identity.md

- profile/biography.md

- profile/voice-analysis.md

- network/organizations.md

Editorial bio

Michael T. Cooper is the missiologist who coined "Ephesiology" — the study of the first-century Ephesian movement — and turned it into a framework, a podcast, a seminary partnership, and a 17-title body of work. His path into the field was unusual: an undergraduate degree in Environmental Design from Texas A&M, an MA in Missions from Columbia International University, and a PhD in Intercultural Studies from Trinity Evangelical Divinity School, where his early research was an ethnography of contemporary Druidry before his work turned decisively toward the New Testament and the archaeology of Asia Minor. Between the classroom and the page sit roughly ten years as a pioneer church planter in post-communist Romania and three decades equipping planters across Africa, Europe, the Americas, and South and Southeast Asia.

His 2020 book *Ephesiology: A Study of the Ephesian Movement* (William Carey Publishing) won that year's Catalyst Services Reader's Choice Award for the best book in missiology and gave the field a new word. The argument behind it is a single inversion repeated across his corpus and his 227-episode podcast: mission is not a subset of theology but its center, "church planting" is nowhere commanded in Scripture, and "making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result." Around that conviction he has built the Ephesiology Master Classes and Seminary@YourChurch (in partnership with the accredited Kairos University), the MA in Missiology of Movements at Mission India Theological Seminary, and the TELOS ministry.

He works today as missiologist-in-residence at East West Ministries, affiliate professor at Kairos, and host of The Ephesiology Podcast with co-host Andrew Johnson. He is positioned by his own endorsers — Alan Hirsch, Marvin Newell, James Stamoolis — as a contemporary heir to Roland Allen, calling the church back to a Pauline, movement-shaped reading of its own foundations.

Sources

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/sources.md

Sources: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Confidence: HIGH on identity, bibliography, frameworks, network; MEDIUM on metrics (many login-gated); LOW/UNKNOWN on personal biographical data.

This is the master source list for the Michael T. Cooper dossier. Every non-obvious claim in the per-topic files traces to one of these. Items marked UNKNOWN in the dossier are genuinely unverified — absence of data, not data of absence.

Primary / identity & affiliation

URL	Verifies
https://kairos.edu/faculty/michael-t-cooper/	Faculty bio: full name, education (TEDS PhD, Columbia MA, Texas A&M BED), roles, guest lectures, field history
https://ephesiology.com/	Hub site ("TELOS." brand); roles; podcast; Master Classes
https://ephesiology.com/authors/michael-t-cooper/	Author page; role list; co-edited titles
https://ephesiology.com/welcome-to-telos/	TELOS. ministry; three pillars; podcast; Andrew Johnson co-host
https://www.eastwest.org/	East West Ministries — mission, scope
https://www.ecfa.org/MemberProfile.aspx?ID=9960	East West financials (FY2025 ~\$32.97M), ECFA membership, founding 1993
https://kairos.edu/2022/06/06/partnership-spotlight-ephesiology/	Kairos × Ephesiology Master Classes partnership; degree funnels
https://sfseminary.academia.edu/MichaelCooper	Academia.edu profile (under former Sioux Falls Seminary = Kairos)

Bibliography & frameworks

URL	Verifies
https://missionbooks.org/products/ephesiology	Ephesiology publisher page; ISBN 9781645082767; endorsements
https://ephesiology.com/ephesiology-the-book/	Framework description
https://www.everand.com/book/547780170/Ephesiology-A-Study-of-the-Ephesian-Movement	"Ephesiology" definition; ~40% NT claim; pronunciation gloss
https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/51353280-ephesiology	Ephesiology rating (4.13/23), 1 text review
https://www.goodreads.com/author/show/4041664.Michael_T_Cooper	Author profile: 23 works, avg 4.15, ~40 ratings
https://ephesiology.com/library-2/	Full book catalogue with co-authors
https://wipfandstock.com/9798385235780/gods-emperors-philosophers-and-a-new-movement/	2026 book (Wipf & Stock); ISBN 9798385235780
https://www.amazon.com/Photographing-Movement-God-Companion-Philosophers/dp/B0GTKN8QDB	Visual companion; ISBN 9798250896528
https://www.amazon.com/Letters-Churches-Christoform-Leadership-Disciples/dp/B0G3HRPWXT	Letters to Churches; Christoform leadership
https://www.amazon.com/Make-Disciples-Spiritual-Christ-Follower-Ephesiology/dp/B0CPNTVDXB	Make Disciples; ISBN 9798867429942; "disciples multiply" quote
https://us.amazon.com/First-Christian-Voices-Practices-Apostolic/dp/1955424152	First Christian Voices; ISBN 9781955424158; expanded bio
https://www.amazon.com/Perspectives-Post-Christendom-Spiritualities-Evangelical-Reflections/dp/B0B7QJWQWX	Perspectives on Post-Christendom Spiritualities; co-contributors
https://missionbooks.org/products/contextualization-and-syncretism-ems-13	EMS 13 volume; ISBN 9781645085263; Van Rheen
https://www.amazon.com/When-Evangelicals-Sneeze-American-Identity/dp/B08FNMP9SJ	When Evangelicals Sneeze; ISBN 9798664568646; Morehead
https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/38191926-lead-like-paul	Lead Like Paul (2017); five C's
https://www.amazon.com/Faithful-Witness-Political-Economic-Ephesiology/dp/B093MVVV19	A Faithful Witness; ISBN 9798742643180
https://www.amazon.com/Social-Injustice-Evangelicals-About-World/dp/1973232383	Social Injustice; ISBN 9781973232384
https://www.amazon.com/Crises-Church-Lessons-Michael-Cooper-ebook/dp/B088TMKZZQ	Crises and the Church (with Matt Till)
https://www.amazon.com/Contemporary-Druidry-Historical-Ethnographic-Study/dp/1973404869	Contemporary Druidry (2010); ISBN 9781973404866
https://www.amazon.com/Michael-T.-Cooper/e/B003PPPO26	Amazon Author Central (gated)

Media, reception & citations

URL	Verifies
https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/full/10.1177/00918296211031694c	Shane Priebe review of Ephesiology in Missiology 49(4):419-420 (2021)
https://missionbooks.org/blogs/news/ephesiology-is-reviewed-by-shane-priebe-at-sage-journal	Announcement of the Missiology review
http://ojs.globalmissiology.org/index.php/english/article/view/2330/5364	Tim Keene review in Global Missiology
http://muslimministry.blogspot.com/2020/02/review-of-ephesiology-study-of-ephesian.html	Warrick Farah (Circumpolar / Motus Dei) review
https://www.patheos.com/blogs/jacksonwu/2020/10/06/ephesiology-and-the-critique-of-church-planting-movements/	Brad Vaughn ("Jackson Wu") engagement
https://www.patheos.com/blogs/jacksonwu/2020/10/28/is-church-planting-a-biblical-mandate/	Cooper guest post; verbatim quotes
https://missionbooks.org/blogs/news/best-mission-books-of-2020	Catalyst Services 2020 Best Missiology Book award
https://missionexus.org/ai-ephesiology-cooper/	Missio Nexus author interview (Jun 2020)
https://thelaymenslounge.com/michael-cooper-is-church-planting-biblical/	Laymen's Lounge interview (Nov 2021); bio; Romania
https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/009182960803600202	2008 Missiology Druids article; TIU directorship

Digital presence, podcast & courses

URL	Verifies
https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/the-ephesiology-podcast/id1457124552	Podcast: 227 eps, 4.8/12, weekly, since 2019, co-host Andrew Johnson
https://masterclasses.ephesiology.com/pages/seminary-yourchurch	Seminary@YourChurch; Kairos partnership; certificates; degrees
https://masterclasses.ephesiology.com/	LMS course catalogue; pricing
https://www.patheos.com/blogs/ephesiology/author/mtcooper/	Patheos "Ephesiology" column (misspelled slug)
https://x.com/ephesiology	X/Twitter brand account (~122, gated)
https://www.instagram.com/ephesiology/	Instagram brand account (~174, gated)
https://www.youtube.com/@ephesiology	YouTube brand channel (gated)
https://www.smashwords.com/profile/view/michaelcooper	Smashwords author profile
https://www.markuswatson.com/2020/04/13/...069/	Guest: Spiritual Life and Leadership Ep. 69 (Apr 2020)
https://www.shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-18-michaelcooper	Guest: Shifting Culture Ep. 18
https://johnwmorehead.podbean.com/e/andrew-perriman-and-michael-cooper-conversation-on-narrative-history-and-missiology/	Guest: Multifaith Matters (Oct 2021)

Network & endorsements

URL	Verifies
https://ephesiology.com/endorsements/	Full 13-name Ephesiology endorser list (incl. Alan Hirsch)
https://ephesiology.com/endorsements-for-when-evangelicals-sneeze/	When Evangelicals Sneeze endorser list
https://www.emsweb.org/books/ephesiology-a-study-of-the-ephesian-movement/	EMS listing of Ephesiology
https://www.amazon.com/Contextualization-Syncretism-Navigating-Evangelical-Missiological/dp/1645085260	Van Rhee EMS volume (collaboration context)

Disambiguation (NOT the subject)

URL	Identifies
https://www.nba.com/player/76444/michael-cooper	NBA player Michael Cooper (exclude)
https://m.imdb.com/name/nm1649053/	Actor Michael Cooper (exclude)
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Michael_Cooper	Disambiguation page

Provenance note

This dossier was assembled 2026-05-29 from web research (no pre-existing per-topic source files existed for this leader). The canonical machine-readable consolidation is [MICHAEL_COOPER_RESEARCH_COLLATED.md](#). Login-gated metrics (social follower counts, Amazon/YouTube stats, Google Scholar citations) are flagged UNKNOWN throughout rather than estimated as fact.

Digital Presence Discovery

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/_misc/digital-presence-discovery.md

Digital Presence Discovery: Michael T. Cooper

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Status: Initial-discovery scan — superseded by the structured files in [digital-presence/](#)

This is a lightweight scan of Cooper's web, social, and podcast presence. The full inventory — the dispersion table across 6+ imprints and brand domains, the dimension-by-dimension digital-presence score, websites, social, newsletter, and platform detail — lives in [digital-presence/platforms.md](#), [digital-presence/websites.md](#), [digital-presence/social-media.md](#), and [digital-presence/newsletters.md](#).

Headline finding

His problem is dispersion, not absence. Cooper has a genuine owned hub, an accredited LMS, a 227-episode podcast, and ~17 books — but those assets are spread across **6+ publisher imprints, two brand domains, a misspelled-slug hosted blog, three retail profiles, and several podcast platforms**, sitting on top of a **thin owned-audience layer**. No single surface concentrates either the catalog or the audience, so the audience effect is sub-additive. **Overall digital presence score: 3.1/5** — strong content + commerce + owned hub; weak owned-audience capture.

Surface scan

Surface	State
ephesiology.com (owned hub, "TELOS." brand)	Genuine content + commerce hub: book page, Library, podcast series, blog, newsletter signup. Score 4/5.
masterclasses.ephesiology.com (LMS)	8+ courses; Kairos degrees (\$300–600/mo) + certificates (\$35–250/mo). Accredited via Kairos (ATS + HLC). Score 4/5.
The Ephesiology Podcast	227 episodes, weekly since 2019, 4.8★ from 12 Apple ratings; co-host Andrew Johnson. Apple (id1457124552), Spotify, YouTube. Strong hosted show; listenership not captured into an owned list.
YouTube @ephesiology	Podcast + course-video mirror; not an independent video audience. Score 2/5.
Social (X / IG / FB)	Brand @ephesiology accounts only; ~120–175 combined followers (X ~122, IG ~174); X appears inactive; no personal creator presence. Counts largely login-gated → UNKNOWN precision. Score 1.5/5.
Newsletter	Signup form exists on ephesiology.com; ESP, cadence, archive, and subscriber count all UNKNOWN . Score 2/5.
Blogs	Two in parallel: Patheos "Ephesiology" column (misspelled slug / blogs/ephesiolog/) + ephesiology.com "Until They All Hear" blog.
Academic	Academia.edu present (sfseminary.academia.edu/MichaelCooper); no verified Google Scholar / ORCID / ResearchGate ; journal record under-indexed. Score 2.5/5.
Retail / aggregators	Goodreads (23 works, ~40 ratings, avg 4.15), Amazon Author Central (B003PPPO26, gated), Smashwords, publisher catalogs, EMS, Missio Nexus. Score 3.5/5.
Books / long-form	~17+ titles across 6+ imprints, 2010–2026 — the standout strength. Score 5/5.

Publisher dispersion (the defining issue)

Cooper's corpus is split across at least six channels: **William Carey Publishing** (Ephesiology), **Wipf & Stock** (2026 Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement + companion), **Sacred Roots / Samuel Morris** (First Christian Voices), **Sacred Tribes Press** (Contemporary Druidry), and the self-managed "**Defense of the Faith from Ephesiology**" and "**Social Justice from Ephesiology**" imprints. There is no single discoverable surface that consolidates more than a fraction of the catalog. See [digital-presence/platforms.md](#) for the full table.

What this means for onboarding

The owned hub, LMS, podcast, and degree ladder already exist — onboarding **consolidates and captures**, it does not build from zero. The bottleneck is audience capture (email + a personal creator identity + a single canonical corpus hub), not content creation. See [analysis/gap-analysis.md](#) and [content-marketing-playbook.md](#).

Initial discovery: 2026-05-29 · Authoritative records: [digital-presence/](#) · Sources: [sources.md](#)

Misc · Analysis-Content-Analysis

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/_misc/analysis-content-analysis.md

Content Analysis: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-content-analysis

Thematic map of the corpus

Cooper's published writing, teaching, and podcasting cluster into **seven recurring themes**, each supported by multiple artifacts across a 17+ title corpus and a 227-episode podcast.

1. Missiological theology of the Ephesian movement (the center of gravity)

- Ephesiology: A Study of the Ephesian Movement (William Carey 2020) — the flagship that coins the term and defines the field
- Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement (Wipf & Stock 2026) — the archaeological deepening
- The Ephesiology Podcast series "Christ: The Foundation of Mission and Church" and "Reimagining our Ecclesiology"
- Patheos/Jackson Wu guest engagement (2020), Missio Nexus interview (2020)

2. Disciple-making over church-planting (the signature inversion)

- Make Disciples: Discover the Spiritual Journey of a Christ-Follower (with Bill Couchenour, 2023)
- Ephesiology — multiplication and "healthy DNA" framing
- "Is Church Planting a Biblical Mandate?" (Patheos/Jackson Wu 2020) — the most-cited articulation
- The Laymen's Lounge interview "Is Church Planting Biblical?" (2021)

3. Early-church / Apostolic-Fathers retrieval

- First Christian Voices: Practices of the Apostolic Fathers (Sacred Roots 2023)
- Letters to Churches: Christoform Leadership Lessons (2025)
- A Faithful Witness (third-century church under persecution)
- Crises and the Church: Lessons from History (with Matt Till)

4. Contextualization & evangelical identity

- Contextualization and Syncretism (EMS 13, ed. Gailyn Van Rheenen, 2022) — contributor
- When Evangelicals Sneeze: Curing the American Church (with John W. Morehead, 2020)
- Perspectives on Post-Christendom Spiritualities (editor, 2022)

5. Material culture / archaeology of Asia Minor (the emerging frontier)

- Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement (2026) — inscriptions, architecture, the Roman East
- Photographing the Movement of God: A Visual Companion (2026) — 116 photographs + 7 maps
- Podcast segments "Let the Stones Speak"

6. Christoform / Pauline leadership

- Letters to Churches (2025) — communal, theological, missional leadership from 1 Clement, Ignatius, Polycarp
- Lead Like Paul (2017) — the Five C's (Call, Character, Charismata, Confidence, Commitment)

7. Justice, peace, and new religious movements

- Social Injustice: What Evangelicals Need to Know About the World (Vols. I & II)
- The Peaceable Christian (with Clifford Williams)
- Contemporary Druidry: A Historical and Ethnographic Study (Sacred Tribes Press 2010) — the ethnographic origin point

Cross-disciplinary framing — his signature intellectual move

Cooper's defining move is **reframing missiology AS theology rather than as a subset of it**. Where most evangelical writers treat "missions" as an applied department downstream of systematic theology, Cooper inverts the order: the Bible is read as "a missiological theology" with mission at the center, and Paul and John are read not as theologians who happened to do mission but as **missiological theologians** who connected Jesus to the cultural narrative of Ephesus.

Three things make this distinctive in the field:

- **He coins a category and treats it as a discipline.** "Ephesiology — the study of the Ephesian movement" is presented (with a mock-dictionary pronunciation, i-fē-zē-ä-lə-jē) as a discrete object of study, not a metaphor. He claims roughly 40% of the New Testament relates to this single movement.

- **He refuses CPM/DMM jargon.** Unlike the disciple-making-movement practitioner literature, Cooper avoids "people of peace," "T4T," "generational mapping," and the metrics-of-sites vocabulary. His corrective — "making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result" — is a deliberate theological repudiation of method-first movement language.
- **He grounds movement claims in material culture.** The 2026 Asia Minor archaeology volume and its photographic companion move the argument from exegesis-plus-illustration to inscriptions, architecture, and the archaeological record. No one else in the practitioner-movement space anchors movement theology in the physical remains of Ephesus and the Roman East.

This is the clearest differentiator of his voice relative to adjacent authors: he is the scholar-practitioner who **theologizes "movement" itself**, refusing both the academic detachment of pure NT commentary and the technique-driven register of CPM how-to.

Argument architecture — his typical essay / talk shape

1. **Received assumption named** — e.g., "church planting is the biblical mandate," or "missions is a topic in theology."
2. **Provocative inversion** — "Nowhere in the Bible is the church commanded to plant churches."
3. **First-century grounding** — Acts 19, the Ephesian movement, Asia Minor material culture, or the Apostolic Fathers.
4. **Contemporary application** — interleaved church-planting-movement examples and the "healthy DNA" concept.
5. **Theocentric return** — disciples "committed to a missiologically theocentric passion to declare the glory of God to the nations."

This is visible across Ephesiology, Make Disciples, the Patheos church-planting piece, and the podcast's "10-Minute Ephesiologist" segment.

Frameworks inventory — for Movemental cataloguing

Framework	Usage
Ephesiology	The study of the Ephesian movement as a normative model: how it started, what adherents believed, who led it, how it multiplied, why some defected
Missiological theology	Mission as the center of theology, not a subset; Paul/John as missiological theologians
Disciple-making over church-planting	"Making disciples is the mandate while church planting is a result"
Healthy DNA	Transferable movement code for churches, denominations, and ministries
"Disciples multiply while volunteers keep busy"	Compressed contrast between formation and activity
Christoform Leadership	Communal/theological/missional leadership from the Apostolic Fathers; against hierarchy and novelty (Letters to Churches)
Lead Like Paul — Five C's	Call, Character, Charismata, Confidence, Commitment
Contextualization / syncretism boundary	Faithful cultural connection vs. identity loss
The Great Commandment / Compassion / Commission	Cure for evangelical "identity loss" (When Evangelicals Sneeze)
TELOS. three pillars	Plant churches, care for the marginalized, defend the faith

Ten distinct frameworks anchored in a named, ownable category. **This is a multi-book author with a coined field — framework density well above the median movement leader.**

What the corpus notably does not do

- Does not use **CPM/DMM operational jargon** — no "people of peace," "T4T," "generational mapping," "streams," or site-counting metrics. This is a deliberate refusal, not an omission.
- Does not frame mission in **pragmatic, method-driven, church-planting-as-metric terms** — his most-corrected reader misreading is the assumption that church planting is the mandate.
- Does not engage in **partisan political commentary**, though "Faith and Politics" appears as a podcast series and Social Injustice engages justice from a "biblical standpoint."
- Does not pursue **trade-press popularization** — the register stays scholarly; he writes for missiologists, seminarians, and serious practitioners, not a mass devotional market.

- Does not market through **personal-brand celebrity** — the public surface runs through the "Ephesiology" / TELOS. brand, not a named-founder personality.
- Does not produce a **single unified, discoverable hub** for the 17-title corpus — output is dispersed across at least six imprints (see gap-analysis.md).

Strategic implication

Cooper's content is **scholarly-Movemental-ready** in substance: a coined category, a multi-book corpus, a 227-episode podcast, and a vertically integrated LMS. The editorial issue is not voice quality (it is high and coherent) but **discoverability and consolidation** — a 17-title corpus scattered across imprints with no canonical hub. His register must be respected, not flattened into trade-devotional; the work to be done is aggregation, indexing, and cross-linking, not rewriting.

Misc · Content-Analysis-Root

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/_misc/content-analysis-root.md

Content Analysis: Michael T. Cooper

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Status: Flat summary — the full analysis lives in [analysis/content-analysis.md](#)

This is a brief thematic pointer. The deep version — the seven-theme thematic map with supporting artifacts, the cross-disciplinary framing, the argument-architecture breakdown, the ten-framework inventory table, and the "what the corpus notably does not do" section — is in [analysis/content-analysis.md](#).

In brief

Cooper's published writing, teaching, and podcasting cluster into **seven recurring themes**:

1. **Missiological theology of the Ephesian movement** (center of gravity) — Ephesiology (2020); Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement (2026).
2. **Disciple-making over church-planting** (the signature inversion) — Make Disciples (2023); "Is Church Planting a Biblical Mandate?" (Patheos/Jackson Wu).
3. **Early-church / Apostolic-Fathers retrieval** — First Christian Voices (2023); Letters to Churches (2025); A Faithful Witness.
4. **Contextualization & evangelical identity** — Contextualization and Syncretism (EMS 13); When Evangelicals Sneeze (2020).
5. **Material culture / archaeology of Asia Minor** (emerging frontier) — the 2026 volume + Photographing the Movement of God (116 photographs + 7 maps).
6. **Christoform / Pauline leadership** — Letters to Churches; Lead Like Paul (the Five C's).
7. **Justice, peace, and new religious movements** — Social Injustice I & II; The Peaceable Christian; Contemporary Druidry (2010).

Signature intellectual move: reframing missiology **AS** theology rather than as a subset of it — coining a category ("Ephesiology") and treating it as a discipline, refusing CPM/DMM operational jargon as a deliberate theological position, and grounding movement claims in material culture.

Frameworks: ten distinct, anchored in a coined, ownable category — Ephesiology, missiological theology, disciple-making-over-church-planting, healthy DNA, Christoform leadership, the Five C's, the contextualization/syncretism boundary, the TELOS. three pillars, and more.

Strategic implication: the content is scholarly-Movemental-ready in substance. The editorial issue is **discoverability and consolidation**, not voice quality — aggregation, indexing, and cross-linking, not rewriting. His scholarly register must be respected, never flattened into trade-devotional.

Flat summary: 2026-05-29 · Full analysis: [analysis/content-analysis.md](#) · Sources: [sources.md](#)

Citations of Michael T. Cooper in Others' Work

Status: Partial — academic citation volume UNKNOWN (no verified Google Scholar profile)
Last updated: 2026-05-29
Skill: /author-media-mentions

Cooper is a credentialed scholar-practitioner (PhD, Trinity Evangelical Divinity School) with peer-reviewed journal output, so unlike pure practitioners he should have a measurable academic citation footprint. The problem is **measurement, not existence**: no Google Scholar or ORCID profile was located, so the quantitative citation count is **UNKNOWN**. What is documentable is his engagement inside the CPM/missiology practitioner-scholar network and his own journal publishing record.

Academic citations

Signal	State	Source
Google Scholar profile	Not located — citation count UNKNOWN	—
ORCID	Not located	—
ResearchGate	"M Cooper" match exists but unconfirmed as this subject	—
Semantic Scholar	Not verified	—

Citation count is genuinely UNKNOWN. Do not infer absence. His doctoral-era new-religious-movements work (Druidry) was published in indexed journals (Nova Religio, Pomegranate, Missiology) that are routinely cited in religious-studies literature; some nonzero academic citation almost certainly exists but was not quantified in this audit.

His own journal / scholarly output (the citable surface)

Cooper has authored peer-reviewed and society articles across at least five venues — this is the body of work other scholars can and do cite:

Venue	Known contribution	Note
Missiology: An International Review (Sage / EMS)	"What I Learned about Christianity from the Druids," Vol. 36(2):171-183 (2008)	Also the journal that later reviewed Ephesiology (Priebe, 2021)
Nova Religio (UC Press)	New-religious-movements / Druidry-era scholarship	Religious-studies indexing
Pomegranate (Equinox)	Contemporary Paganism / Druidry scholarship	Religious-studies indexing
Journal of the Evangelical Missiological Society (JEMS)	Missiology essays	Society journal
Global Missiology	Missiology essays	Open-access
Sacred Tribes Journal	New-religious-movements engagement	Niche

This dual track — religious-studies / NRM scholarship early, missiology scholarship later — is the citation terrain. His most-citable single artifact is the 2008 Missiology Druids article (it carries a DOI and journal pagination).

Engagement / soft citation in practitioner-scholar networks

Cooper's framework travels through the CPM/missiology network more visibly than through formal citation indexes:

Channel	How Cooper is engaged	Source
Motus Dei network (Warrick Farah)	Farah — who leads this CPM scholar-practitioner network — favorably reviewed Ephesiology ("invaluable resource") and engages the framework. This is the strongest network-level uptake signal.	muslimministry.blogspot.com
Brad Vaughn / "Jackson Wu" (Patheos)	Treats Ephesiology as a named alternative to mainstream CPM thinking; quotes Cooper's "church planting is not the mandate" thesis at length.	patheos.com
Evangelical Missiological Society (EMS)	Ephesiology is listed under EMS-adjacent publications; Cooper contributed to Contextualization and Syncretism (EMS 13, 2022).	missionbooks.org
Missio Nexus	Featured the book and author (interview + Newell endorsement).	missionexus.org
Endorser network	Newell and Stamoolis explicitly liken Cooper to Roland Allen — a citation-by-comparison that positions him in a recognized missiological lineage.	ephesiology.com/endorsements

Book-level citations

No systematic full-text citation search was possible. **"Ephesiology" as a coined term is a category of one** — Cooper invented it and uniquely occupies the Ephesus/Acts 19 movement-theology niche — which means term-level diffusion is easy to track but currently small: the word travels almost exclusively within his own ecosystem (podcast, Master Classes, Mission India MA) and the Farah/Vaughn engagements, rather than appearing in others' book titles or indexes.

Citation pattern

- **Engaged more than indexed.** Like other practitioner-scholars, Cooper is engaged in networks and reviews more visibly than he is quantifiably cited — but unlike pure practitioners he has a genuine peer-reviewed publishing record that supports real (if unmeasured) academic citation.
- **A coined term that hasn't yet escaped its origin.** "Ephesiology" is distinctive and ownable, but it has not yet entered general missiological vocabulary the way "CPM" (Garrison) or "APEST" (Hirsch) have. It is pre-diffusion.
- **Lineage-by-endorsement.** The repeated Roland Allen comparison from credentialed endorsers functions as a positioning citation, locating him in the Missionary Methods: St. Paul's or Ours? tradition.

Implication

The single highest-leverage citation move is **establishing a verified scholar profile** (Google Scholar + ORCID) to make the existing journal record discoverable and citable, and **driving "Ephesiology" as a term into others' work** through the Motus Dei / EMS / Missio Nexus channels where the appetite already exists. The intellectual capital is real; the measurement infrastructure and term-diffusion are the gaps.

Misc · Media · Press-Coverage

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/_misc/media/press-coverage.md

Press Coverage: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete (for discoverable coverage)

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-media-mentions

Cooper's press footprint is **movement- and guild-internal**: missions-agency outlets, a theological seminary's own news blog, a lay apologetics site, and a hosted Patheos column. There is no surfaced mainstream-press (secular or general-Christian) coverage. This is consistent with a specialist missiologist whose audience is reached through the missions/missiology ecosystem rather than trade media.

Confirmed press / interviews / hosted columns

Outlet	Title / nature	Date	Type	URL
Missio Nexus	Ephesiology author interview	Jun 2, 2020	Interview	missionnexus.org/ai-ephesiology-cooper
The Laymen's Lounge	"Is Church Planting Biblical?" interview	Nov 23, 2021	Interview	thelaymenslounge.com/michael-cooper-is-church-planting-biblical
Kairos University	Partnership Spotlight: Ephesiology	Jun 6, 2022	Institutional feature	kairos.edu/2022/06/06/partnership-spotlight-ephesiology
Patheos	Hosted column "Ephesiology" (note the misspelled slug / blogs/ephesilogy/)	Ongoing 2023-2024	Owned-adjacent column	patheos.com/blogs/ephesilogy
Patheos — "Jackson Wu" (Brad Vaughn) blog	Guest-platform engagement of the church-planting-mandate thesis	Jun / Oct 2020	Hosted argument / guest amplification	patheos.com/blogs/jacksonwu

Notes on the strongest items

- **Missio Nexus interview (Jun 2020)** is the highest-credibility press item — Missio Nexus is the largest North American evangelical missions association, and its staff missiologist

Marvin J. Newell also endorsed Ephesiology. This is the closest thing to a "trade" placement in Cooper's file.

- **The Laymen's Lounge (Nov 2021)** is the richest biographical interview surfaced — it is the primary public source for the "30+ years in missions / ~10 years church planting in Romania" narrative and the Catalyst award.
- **Kairos Partnership Spotlight (Jun 2022)** is an institutional feature tied to the Seminary@YourChurch / Master Classes degree partnership; it doubles as marketing for the LMS.
- **The Patheos column** is hosted (not owned) and carries a misspelled slug, which is itself an SEO/discoverability liability — see [digital-presence/platforms.md](#).

Podcast guest appearances (press-adjacent; on shows other than his own)

Show	Host	Episode	Date	URL
Spiritual Life and Leadership	Markus Watson	Ep. 69 "Connecting Christ to Culture"	Apr 13, 2020	markuswatson.com
Shifting Culture	Joshua Johnson	Ep. 18 (Michael Cooper)	~Aug 2020	shiftingculturepodcast.com
Multifaith Matters	John W. Morehead	"Andrew Perriman & Michael Cooper... Narrative-History and Missiology"	Oct 19, 2021	johnwmorehead.podbean.com

(Markus Watson and John W. Morehead also appear in Cooper's endorser/collaborator network — see [media/citations.md](#). His own 227-episode show is covered in [digital-presence/platforms.md](#) and [digital-presence/social-media.md](#).)

Media coverage gaps

Cooper has **not** (to the audit's knowledge) been covered in:

- Christianity Today / CT Pastors
- Outreach Magazine
- The Gospel Coalition
- Religion News Service or any mainstream secular press
- Themelios / EMQ / GCRJ (no review surfaced — see [media/reviews.md](#))

The absence of general-Christian and mainstream coverage is unsurprising for a specialist missiologist, but it is striking next to the output: a 17-book corpus, a 227-episode podcast, an accredited degree partnership, and an award have produced **no trade-press feature**. The coverage that exists is entirely inside the missions guild and his own institutional orbit.

Assessment

- **Coverage is guild-internal and self-adjacent.** Missio Nexus and The Laymen's Lounge are the only two arms-length outlets; Kairos and Patheos are institutional/owned-adjacent.
- **Two-tier pattern.** A credible missions-association tier (Missio Nexus) sitting atop a thin, scattered guest-and-column tier — with nothing bridging into trade or mainstream press.
- **The Vaughn ("Jackson Wu") relationship is the most generative press asset** because it is sustained engagement, not a one-off mention, and it produced Cooper's most-quoted lines.

Recommended press / media strategy (for Movemental onboarding)

1. **Pitch a Christianity Today or Outreach feature** around the contrarian, citable thesis ("Nowhere in the Bible is the church commanded to plant churches") tied to the 2026 archaeology volume Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement — a fresh, visual, news-pegged hook.
2. **Leverage the Hirsch endorsement** into a co-interview (Hirsch + Cooper) on movement ecclesiology for a missional-orbit outlet; converts a static blurb into live coverage.
3. **Fix the Patheos slug.** The misspelled `/blogs/ephesiology/` is leaking discoverability; either correct it or 301-redirect and consolidate the column under the `ephesiology.com` brand.
4. **Repackage the Missio Nexus and Laymen's Lounge interviews** as canonical, on-site assets at `ephesiology.com` so the strongest existing coverage stops living only on third-party domains.

Misc · Media · Reviews

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/_misc/media/reviews.md

Reviews of Michael T. Cooper's Work

Status: Complete (for discoverable reviews)

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-media-mentions

Unlike practitioners with no published surface, Cooper has a substantial, multi-decade bibliography (~17+ titles) anchored by the 2020 flagship Ephesiology: A Study of the Ephesian Movement (William Carey Publishing). That book has accumulated a real, if modest, review and award footprint inside the missiology guild. This file catalogs every discoverable review.

Academic / journal book reviews of Ephesiology (2020)

Reviewer	Venue	Date	Verdict	Locator	URL
Shane Priebe	Missiology: An International Review (Sage; EMS flagship journal)	Sep 29, 2021	Positive	Vol. 49(4), pp. 419-420, DOI 10.1177/00918296211031694c	journals.sagepub.com
Tim Keene	Global Missiology (English)	Undated (review #2330)	UNKNOWN — verbatim text did not render	Article view 2330	ojs.globalmissiology.org

Priebe (Missiology) is the strongest formal review surfaced and is favorable. Quoted strength: "A strength of this book is its wide array of additional material... The figures and graphs allow for implementation into one's own context, making it very practical." Placement in Missiology — the Evangelical Missiological Society's flagship Sage journal, and Cooper's own publishing home — is the most credentialed reception signal in the file.

Keene (Global Missiology) is confirmed to exist but its text could not be rendered during the audit; verdict UNKNOWN.

Searched but NOT found

No reviews surfaced in Themelios, Evangelical Missions Quarterly (EMQ), or Great Commission Research Journal (GCRJ). Treat each as **UNKNOWN / not-found**, not as confirmed absence — these are the three venues a missiology title of this profile would most plausibly appear in, and a live re-check is warranted.

Blog / non-academic reviews of Ephesiology

Reviewer	Outlet	Date	Verdict	URL
Warrick Farah	Circumpolar (muslimministry.blogspot)	Feb 28, 2020	Favorable ("invaluable resource"; notes the theology runs "lengthy at times")	muslimministry.blogspot.com
Brad Vaughn (pen name "Jackson Wu")	Patheos	Jun / Oct 2020	Engaged / amplifying — treats Ephesiology as a corrective to mainstream CPM thinking; functions as a guest-platform for Cooper's thesis	patheos.com
Waha app	"A Disciple Maker's book review"	UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN (reviewer/ date not surfaced)	—

Warrick Farah is the most strategically significant blog reviewer: he leads the **Motus Dei** network, a CPM scholar-practitioner network that engages Cooper's work. His favorable review situates Cooper inside the movement-studies conversation rather than at its margins.

Brad Vaughn / "Jackson Wu" is closer to sustained intellectual engagement than a single review. His Patheos posts treat Ephesiology as an alternative to received CPM assumptions, and Cooper's own most-quoted lines ("Nowhere in the Bible is the church commanded to plant churches") originate from a Vaughn-hosted exchange. See [media/press-coverage.md](#).

Reader ratings

Platform	Rating	Volume	Notes	URL
Goodreads — Ephesiology	4.13 / 5	23 ratings, 1 text review	The single text review is by Patrick Allen and is mixed ("a bit confusing")	goodreads.com/book/show/51353280
Goodreads — author profile	4.15 / 5	23 works, ~40 total ratings, 0 followers	Thin engagement relative to output	goodreads.com/author/show/4041664
Amazon	UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN	Star/review counts did not surface (page returned 500/503)	—

The Goodreads picture is the asymmetry to name: a well-regarded niche book (4.13) with only **23 ratings and a single — mixed — written review**. The reception is credible but extremely low-volume relative to a 17-book corpus and a 227-episode podcast.

Awards

Award	Body	Year	Detail	URL
Best Missiology Book	Catalyst Services "Best Mission Books" reader survey	2020	Ephesiology was 1 of 3 William Carey titles in the top 14; framed as Reader's Choice for best book in Missiology	missionbooks.org/blogs/news/best-mission-books-of-2020

Endorsement note (one mixed signal)

Among the 13 published endorsements of Ephesiology (see [the substrate](#) and [media/citations.md](#)), most are strongly favorable (Alan Hirsch leads). One is notably qualified: **Joe L. Wall** (Grace School of Theology) allows the book "may have missed some important emphases and principles." Worth flagging because it is the only public reservation from inside the endorsement set.

Assessment

- **The reception is real but guild-internal and low-volume.** One credentialed positive journal review (Priebe / Missiology), one unconfirmed journal review (Keene / Global Missiology), two substantive blog engagements (Farah, Vaughn), a single mixed Goodreads text review, and one award. That is a credible scholarly footprint — and a thin popular one.

- **The award and the Priebe review are the load-bearing assets.** Both should anchor any future jacket copy or Movemental hub.
- **The gaps are at the popular tier, not the academic tier.** No Themelios / EMQ / GCRJ review surfaced, and Amazon engagement is invisible. For a book that won a reader-survey award, the absence of a visible Amazon review wall is itself a dispersion symptom — the audience exists but is not concentrated on any one retail or review surface.
- **Recommended:** consolidate Priebe's pull-quote, the Catalyst award, the Hirsch endorsement, and Farah's "invaluable resource" line into a single review/praise band, and run a live re-check of Themelios/EMQ/GCRJ and Amazon before treating those as confirmed-absent.

Misc · Network · Collaborators

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/_misc/network/collaborators.md`

Collaborators: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: `/author-collaboration-map`

Primary collaborators — co-authors & co-editors (confirmed)

Person	Relationship	Joint works	Significance
John W. Morehead	Most frequent collaborator	When Evangelicals Sneeze (2020); Perspectives on Post-Christendom Spiritualities (2022, contributor); recorded Multifaith Matters conversation (Oct 2021)	Foundation for Religious Diplomacy; new-religious-movements specialist. The strongest single co-author edge. Shared terrain: evangelical identity, NRMs, interfaith engagement — the religious-studies side of Cooper's work.
Matt (Matthew) Till	Co-author AND endorser	Crises and the Church: Lessons from History (Ephesiology imprint; ASIN B088TMKZZQ)	Lead Pastor, Restoration Church; Adjunct, Trinity International University. Both a collaborator and an Ephesiology endorser — a double-tie.
Bill Couchenour	Co-author (per book listing)	Make Disciples (2023; 9798867429942)	Discipleship-multiplication book. See bridges table — Couchenour reportedly also chairs the Tampa Underground board, a potential cross-network tie. Cooper↔Couchenour collaboration listed on the book but treat the wider biographical claim as needing confirmation.
William J. Moulder	Co-editor	Social Injustice: What Evangelicals Need to Know About the World (9781973232384)	Professor of Biblical Studies, Trinity International University — a TIU-era colleague. Also endorsed When Evangelicals Sneeze.
Ronald P. Hesselgrave	Co-editor	Social Injustice (Vol. I)	Co-editor; detail otherwise thin. (Note the surname proximity to missiologist David Hesselgrave / TEDS — relationship UNKNOWN.)
Kathryn (Kathy) Richards Bhatia	Co-author / co-editor	Social Injustice, Vol. II	MDiv, BCC. Also an endorser of When Evangelicals Sneeze.
Clifford Williams	Co-author	The Peaceable Christian	"Five evangelicals reflect on peace."
Gary Fujino	Co-author AND endorser	Missiology Made Simple	Professor of Diaspora Studies, Missional University. Both collaborator and Ephesiology endorser.
Gailyn Van Rheenen	Volume editor (Cooper contributor)	Contextualization and Syncretism (EMS 13, 2022)	Missiology textbook author in his own right; the EMS editorial relationship places Cooper inside the EMS mainstream.
Mark Townsend	Foreword contributor	Contemporary Druidry (2010)	Foreword to the Druidry ethnography; a tie back to his NRM-research period rather than his movement work.

Primary collaborators — podcast & ongoing platform

Person	Show / surface	Relationship
Andrew Johnson	The Ephesiology Podcast (227 eps)	Co-host. Pastor, West Village Church, Victoria BC (also assoc. Neartown Church); DMin student at Kairos. The single most sustained working relationship — a weekly co-teaching surface since the feed began. Not a book co-author.

Contributors he has convened (edited-volume authors)

Perspectives on Post-Christendom Spiritualities (2022, ed. Cooper) gathered a notable evangelical-academic roster — useful as second-hop contacts:

J. Gordon Melton, Gerald McDermott, Ross Clifford, James Chancellor, Craig Blomberg, Michael Yoder, Terry Muck, Stephen Kennedy.

Intellectual / theological influences (read, taught, or positioned against)

Person	Relationship	Significance
Roland Allen	Strongest confirmed lineage	Missionary Methods: St Paul's or Ours? Multiple endorsers (Newell, Stamoolis) explicitly compare Cooper to Allen — the recurring comparison in his blurbs. The clearest intellectual ancestor for the "Pauline movement method" core.
Harold A. Netland	Confirmed connection (mentor-adjacent)	TEDS professor; Ephesiology endorser and shared institution. Likely formative on the religious-studies / theology-of-religions side.
(NRM / Druidry research roots)	Formational method	His PhD-era ethnographic work on contemporary Druidry / new religious movements (publishing in Nova Religio, Pomegranate, Sacred Tribes Journal) explains his sociology-of-religion lens — he reads early Christianity as a movement an ethnographer would study.
Rodney Stark / Wayne Meeks	UNVERIFIED	Sociology of early Christianity — terrain-consistent with his method, but direct citation NOT confirmed.
Eckhard Schnabel	UNVERIFIED	New Testament missiology / Pauline mission; nearest academic neighbor on Ephesus, but direct citation NOT confirmed.
David Bosch / Lesslie Newbigin	UNVERIFIED	Plausible given the missiology canon, but NOT confirmed as cited influences pending the Ephesiology bibliography. TEDS doktorvater UNKNOWN.

Direct bridges to other Movemental-targeted movement leaders

Target leader	Bridge through Cooper	Confidence
Alan Hirsch	Direct — Hirsch wrote the lead endorsement for Ephesiology (2020). Shared movemental-ecclesiology vocabulary. Strongest single bridge to the Movemental world.	High
Michael Frost	Listed as collaborator on Gods, Emperors, Philosophers, and a New Movement (2026) — but role (co-author vs. foreword) is UNCONFIRMED. If real, a direct second Frost↔Cooper edge.	UNVERIFIED — flag
Lucas Pulley / Tampa Underground network	Possible — via Bill Couchenour , Cooper's Make Disciples co-author, who reportedly also chairs the Tampa Underground board (where Couchenour appears as Board Chair and Governing Elder in the Lucas Pulley dossier). If confirmed, this is a real one-hop bridge from Cooper into the Underground / microchurch cluster.	UNVERIFIED — flag; cross-check Couchenour identity
Gailyn Van Rheen	Direct — EMS editorial relationship	High
John W. Morehead	Direct — most frequent co-author	High
Andrew Johnson	Direct — podcast co-host	High

Caution on the Couchenour bridge. The Lucas Pulley dossier lists a "Bill Couchenour" as Tampa Underground Board Chair and Governing Elder; the Cooper material lists a "Bill Couchenour" as Make Disciples co-author. These may be the same person (which would make Cooper a one-hop neighbor of Lucas Pulley and the entire Underground network) — but the identity match is **not verified**. Confirm before treating it as a live bridge. This is the highest-value unconfirmed lead in Cooper's network.

Collaborator-density observation

Cooper is **collaborator-rich but cluster-narrow**. He has a wide co-author roster (10+ named co-authors/editors across his self-imprint output), which signals a generous, convening temperament — he repeatedly gathers other evangelical academics into edited volumes. But almost all of those ties sit inside one cluster: conservative-evangelical / EFCA-adjacent / EMS / TEDS missiology. The roster builds depth within that world rather than reach beyond it.

Collaborator-density observation — the bridge version

His two highest-value external edges are **Alan Hirsch** (confirmed endorser; the clean bridge into the broader Movemental ecosystem) and the **unconfirmed Couchenour/Frost pair**. If either the Couchenour-Tampa-Underground identity or the Frost co-authorship is verified,

Cooper jumps from "adjacent academic the Movemental world quotes" to "one hop from the Underground/microchurch network and from Frost." Verifying those two facts is the single most leveraged research action on his network — and both are currently UNVERIFIED.

Misc · Network · Endorsements

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/michael-cooper/_misc/network/endorsements.md`

Endorsements: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-05-29

Skill: /author-collaboration-map

Endorsements received — Ephesiology (2020)

The full 13-name endorser ring from ephesiology.com/endorsements. Alan Hirsch leads.

#	Endorser	Affiliation	Significance
1	Alan Hirsch	Forge / 100 Movements; movement ecclesiology	Lead blurb. Highest significance for Movemental — direct bridge into the Movemental ecosystem and the strongest external credentialing signal Cooper holds.
2	Nate Vander Stelt	EVP, Global Alliance for Church Multiplication (GACX)	Church-multiplication network credibility.
3	Marvin J. Newell	Staff Missiologist, Missio Nexus	Likens Cooper to Roland Allen — one of the recurring Allen comparisons.
4	Dudley Brown	Intl Training Institute; Christ Community Church, Greeley CO	—
5	Rick Burke	Assoc. Dir. Global Equipping, ReachGlobal (EFCA)	EFCA mission-agency tie.
6	Kerry Doyal	District Superintendent, EFCA; Sr Pastor, Christ Community Fellowship	EFCA denominational tie.
7	Gary Fujino	Prof of Diaspora Studies, Missional University	Also a collaborator (Missiology Made Simple) — endorser + co-author.
8	Steve Gibson	Lead Pastor, Wellspring Church, Hudsonville MI	Practitioner-pastor voice.
9	Kurt Nelson	President/CEO, East-West Ministries International	Cooper's own org head — internal institutional endorsement.
10	Harold A. Netland	Professor, Trinity Evangelical Divinity School	Cooper's TEDS milieu; reportedly expects the book to be used "as a text in Bible colleges."
11	James Stamoolis	Missiologist / consultant	Compares Cooper to Roland Allen — the second explicit Allen comparison.
12	Matthew Till	Lead Pastor, Restoration Church; Adjunct, Trinity International University	Also a co-author (Crises and the Church) — endorser + collaborator.
13	Joe L. Wall	Prof of Systematic Theology, Grace School of Theology	Mixed blurb — endorses but notes the book "may have missed some important emphases and principles." The one non-uniform endorsement; worth quoting accurately rather than as unqualified praise.

Endorsements received — When Evangelicals Sneeze (2020, with John W. Morehead)

The full endorser list for the second book — a different, more NRM / interfaith-flavored ring:

Endorser	Affiliation / note
Scott Roley	—
Arman Sheffey	Unshackled Network
Kathy Richards Bhatia	MDiv, BCC — also a co-author of Social Injustice Vol. II
Phil Wyman	Wild Theology Podcast
David Thompson	—
Toni M. Daniels	LK10
John W. Morehead	Foundation for Religious Diplomacy — also the book's co-author
William J. Moulder	Prof of Biblical Studies, TIU — also a co-editor of Social Injustice
Markus Watson	Spiritual Life & Leadership (also hosted Cooper as a podcast guest, Ep. 69)
David Feiser	—
Steve Hoffman	—

Endorsements given to other authors

None surfaced. No public jacket endorsements written by Cooper for other authors' books were discovered during this audit. Given his convening posture (10+ co-authors, multiple edited volumes) it is plausible he has blurbed works in the EMS / William Carey / Ephesiology-imprint orbit, but none were located. Treat as UNKNOWN.

Recommended research action: check his Ephesiology-imprint co-authors' books (Till, Couchenour, Williams) and the William Carey / EMS catalog for Cooper blurbs; ask directly on next contact.

Quoted by others / academic reception

This is the quieter credentialing trail — where his ideas are engaged rather than blurbed:

- **Shane Priebe**, *Missiology: An International Review* (Sage; EMS flagship journal), Sep 2021, Vol 49(4) pp.419-420, DOI [10.1177/00918296211031694](https://doi.org/10.1177/00918296211031694) — **positive academic review:** praises the "wide array of additional material" and figures/graphs that "allow for implementation into one's own context."
- **Tim Keene**, *Global Missiology* (English), review #2330 — ojs.globalmissiology.org (verbatim text UNKNOWN — page would not render).
- **Warrick Farah**, *Circumpolar blog* (Feb 2020) — favorable ("invaluable resource"; notes the theology is "lengthy at times"). Farah leads the **Motus Dei** network, a CPM scholar-

practitioner network that **engages Cooper's work** — the most consequential "quoted by" tie, since it represents uptake inside an adjacent movement-research community. [Review](#).

- **Brad Vaughn ("Jackson Wu")**, Patheos (Jun/Oct 2020) — engages Ephesiology as a corrective/alternative to mainstream CPM thinking and effectively guest-platforms Cooper's "church planting is not the mandate" thesis. [Article](#).
 - **Catalyst Services 2020 "Best Mission Books" reader survey** — Ephesiology named best book in Missiology (1 of 3 William Carey titles in the top 14). missionbooks.org.
 - **Goodreads** — 4.13 avg (23 ratings, 1 text review by Patrick Allen, mixed: "a bit confusing"). Author profile 4.15 avg / 23 works / ~40 ratings.
-

Structural observations

1. **The Roland Allen comparison recurs across the endorsement ring.** At least two endorsers (Newell, Stamoolis) independently liken Cooper to Roland Allen. This is the consensus framing his endorsers reach for — confirming that the Missionary Methods lineage is how the field reads him, even though Cooper's own bibliography citations remain unverified.
2. **Endorsement gravity is evangelical/EFCA/missiology-academic.** The Ephesiology ring is dense with EFCA (Burke, Doyal), TEDS (Netland), Missio Nexus (Newell), and his own org (Nelson). The When Evangelicals Sneeze ring shifts toward NRM/interfaith voices (Morehead, Wyman, Sheffey). Two different audiences, two different rings.
3. **The Hirsch lead blurb is the asset to leverage.** Of 24 named endorsers across both books, Alan Hirsch is the only one already inside the Movemental target set, and he wrote the lead blurb for the flagship. This is the cleanest, highest-confidence bridge in Cooper's entire credentialing trail.
4. **The endorsement trail flows inward, not outward.** Cooper is endorsed by many and is quoted/reviewed in respected journals, but has no surfaced record of endorsing others. He is a receiver and a convener, not yet a public blurb-giver — the inverse of his collaborator profile, where he is unusually generous.

Events & Speaking History: Michael T. Cooper

Status: Partial (regular posts well-documented; dated conference sessions largely UNKNOWN)
Last updated: 2026-05-29
Skill: /author-event-history

Regular teaching posts (recurring institutional surfaces)

#	Institution	Role	Format	URL
1	East-West Ministries International	Missiologist-in-Residence	Ongoing internal teaching/ equipping	eastwest.org
2	Mission India Theological Seminary (Nagpur)	Professor of Missiological Theology; Program Director, MA Missiology of Movements	Ongoing degree teaching	—
3	Kairos University	Affiliate Professor; Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch partner	Ongoing	kairos.edu/faculty/michael-t-cooper
4	Torch Trinity Graduate University (Seoul)	Has taught	Guest / visiting teaching	ttgu.ac.kr
5	Asia Graduate School of Theology — Nepal	Has taught	Guest / visiting teaching	—
6	Trinity Evangelical Divinity School / Trinity International University	Former Director, School of Biblical & Religious Studies (~a decade)	Past faculty	tiu.edu

Guest lectures (academic venues — per kairos.edu bio)

#	Venue	Role	Date	Notes
7	London School of Economics (LSE)	Guest lecturer	UNKNOWN	Listed in faculty bio; specific date/topic UNKNOWN.
8	University of Bordeaux	Guest lecturer	UNKNOWN	—
9	Loyola University	Guest lecturer	UNKNOWN	—
10	Baylor University	Guest lecturer	UNKNOWN	—
11	University of Utah	Academic-paper venue	UNKNOWN	Likely from his NRM/Druidry research period.
12	University of Craiova (Romania)	Academic-paper venue	UNKNOWN	Ties to his decade of church-planting in Romania.

These are notable academic-platform appearances (LSE and a Jesuit/Catholic university for an evangelical missiologist is a real cross-tradition signal), but **none carry a confirmed date or session title**. They read as a career-spanning list, not a current speaking calendar.

His own recurring program / convening

#	Event / surface	Role	Cadence	Notes
13	Areopagus Symposium	Host / convener	Recurring (via Master Classes)	His own branded symposium, delivered through masterclasses.ephesiology.com. Dates/attendance UNKNOWN.
14	Ephesiology Master Classes / Seminary@YourChurch	Lead instructor	Cohort-based, ongoing	Delivered 3 ways (on-site professors / live web-stream / online async), set in local churches. Four certificate tracks; credits ladder into Kairos degrees. Enrollment UNKNOWN. seminary-yourchurch
15	The Ephesiology Podcast	Host (w/ Andrew Johnson)	Weekly, since 2019	227 episodes ; 4.8★ (12 Apple ratings). The single largest ongoing public-teaching surface — effectively a weekly lectureship. Organized in series ("Christ: The Foundation of Mission and Church," "Reimagining our Ecclesiology," "Faith and Politics") with a recurring "The 10-Minute Ephesiologist" segment. Apple id1457124552 .

External / affiliated speaking & podcast-guest appearances

Each guest appearance functions as a public speaking event:

Show / venue	Host	Episode / date	URL
Spiritual Life and Leadership	Markus Watson	Ep. 69, "Connecting Christ to Culture," Apr 13 2020	markuswatson.com
Shifting Culture	Joshua Johnson	Ep. 18, ~Aug 2020	shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-18-michaelcooper
Multifaith Matters	John W. Morehead	"Andrew Perriman & Michael Cooper... Narrative-History and Missiology," Oct 19 2021	johnwmorehead.podbean.com
Missio Nexus (author interview)	—	Jun 2 2020	missionexus.org/ai-ephesiology-cooper
The Laymen's Lounge (interview)	—	"Is Church Planting Biblical?", Nov 23 2021	thelaymenlounge.com
Kairos University Partnership Spotlight	—	Jun 6 2022	kairos.edu/2022/06/06/partnership-spotlight-ephesiology

Organizational / society affiliations relevant to speaking

- **Evangelical Missiological Society (EMS)** — contributor to EMS 13; the book is listed under EMS publications. Whether he presents at EMS regional/national meetings is UNKNOWN.
- **Missio Nexus** — engaged (author interview); conference participation UNKNOWN.

What is NOT documented

- **Dated, named conference sessions are largely UNKNOWN.** No confirmed plenary or breakout slots at EMS, Missio Nexus, Exponential, or similar are on record. The guest-lecture list (LSE, Bordeaux, Loyola, Baylor, Utah, Craiova) is undated. This is the single biggest gap in his event record.
- **Areopagus Symposium dates, format, and attendance** — UNKNOWN.
- **Master Classes enrollment / cohort sizes** — UNKNOWN.
- **Recording / distribution rights** for any of the above — UNKNOWN.

Assessment

- **His teaching cadence is institutional and digital, not conference-stage.** Cooper's "events" are overwhelmingly recurring teaching posts (East-West, Mission India, Kairos, Torch Trinity, AGST Nepal) plus his own owned surfaces (Master Classes, Areopagus Symposium, the 227-episode podcast) — not a circuit of named conference keynotes. He is a professor-podcaster more than a conference speaker.
- **The podcast is the flywheel.** With 227 weekly episodes since 2019 and a co-host (Andrew Johnson), the podcast is the most consistent, highest-volume public-teaching artifact he has — a far richer corpus than his thin conference record.
- **Academic-venue range is unusually broad but undated.** LSE, Bordeaux, Loyola (Jesuit), Baylor, Utah, Craiova span secular, Catholic, and evangelical institutions across three continents — a credibility signal, but not a live calendar Movemental can plug into.
- **Reach is niche but vertically deep.** Small public numbers, but each surface ladders toward accredited credentials — engagement runs deep (degree-seeking cohorts) rather than wide.

Recommended event strategy (for Movemental onboarding)

1. **Treat the podcast as the primary capture asset.** Negotiate distribution / re-cut rights to The Ephesiology Podcast back catalog (227 eps) and the "10-Minute Ephesiologist" segment — it is the densest, most onboarding-ready content he owns.
2. **Bundle the Master Classes into a Movemental learning path.** "Foundations for a Missiology of Movements," "Missiological Theology," and "Movemental Ecclesiology" map cleanly onto Movemental's framing; co-brand a pathway and route serious learners toward the Kairos/Mission India degree ladder.
3. **Capture the Areopagus Symposium.** Offer Movemental Studio as recording/distribution infrastructure for his own recurring symposium — converting an under-distributed live event into evergreen content.
4. **Fill the conference gap deliberately.** His weakest surface is named conference presence. A Movemental-hosted session or co-billing with Alan Hirsch (his lead endorser) would both fill that gap and activate the strongest confirmed bridge in his network.
5. **Verify before scheduling.** Confirm Areopagus Symposium dates, EMS/Missio Nexus participation, and the Couchenour/Frost ties (see collaborators.md) before building any co-event plan.